

Deacon Manual

Principles of Deaconship

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Most men will proclaim every one his own goodness: but a faithful man who can find? The just man walketh in his integrity: his children are blessed after him. Proverbs 20:6-7

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OPERATIONS OF CHURCH OFFICES

AS WERE RECOMMENDED

BY

REV. WILLIAM MARRION BRANHAM

FOR

THE BRANHAM TABERNACLE

PASTOR

Rev. William Branham

ASSOCIATE PASTOR

Rev. Armand Neville

AGREEMENT AND OPERATION OF OFFICES

The following agreements and the operations of the present offices in power at the Branham Tabernacle are compiled below. It is to enlighten the present members who now attend the worship services at the Branham Tabernacle; as to the proper function of each office. That we may agree as one united body, understanding each others position as we work together to forward the kingdom of God.

THE OFFICE OF THE PASTOR

The office of the pastor is to conduct and act upon any program of which he believes to be according to the plan of God, according to the Word of God, for the Branham Tabernacle. He shall assume supreme authority and meet promoting for the spiritual welfare of the church. He shall be head of the associate pastor, the deacon board, the trustee board, an the church body itself. Acting in wisdom to lead God's saints, manifesting love toward all the saints and their burdens. Conducting himself in perfect servitude, of which God has called and placed him to act upon.

THE OFFICE OF ASSOCIATE PASTOR

The associate pastor to the Branham Tabernacle, is to perform and carry out the duties of the pastor, in his absence. To conduct worship services according to the manner of doctrine believed and practiced by the Branham Tabernacle. He shall be invested with the same power as the pastor is, meeting all responsibility of the church, and acting in full authority to keep the church in order. He is to manifest deep concern to all the burdens of the saints and fulfill the commission of which God has called him to, as a shepherd. He shall account at various times the progress of the church, spiritual matters present, and problems that may be pressing, to the pastor. He shall not undertake any business transactions without first presenting it to the pastor, the exact transaction.

THE OFFICE OF THE TRUSTEES

The body of men, shall govern the welfare of the church as a business group. They are elected to protect the church in it's financial matters, it's business investments, the supervision of it's properties, and it's expenditures. They shall strongly consider every move of progress, step by step, which involves church funds. For they shall be responsible to keep the church from indebtedness, and the saints from burdens that are too great to bear financially. In the undertaking of any project, regardless what it is, they are to bring the matter to the pastor, consultation by the pastor, consultation by the pastor only for every financial project the church wishes to invest or engage itself therein is absolutely required.

THE OFFICE OF THE DEACONS

The office of deacons, as elected according to the Word of God and the manner of the Branham Tabernacle, is to act as an office of spiritual assistance to the pastors. They are to assist the pastors on all of his spiritual activities. They are given free speech in presenting to the pastors any program or benefits that would bless the general and spiritual welfare of the church. They must be apt to teach, and ready to assist the pastor or associate pastor on every duty if called to do so. They shall assist in serving communion. They shall be acting ushers in all services. They shall police the church, in keeping civil order and conduct. They shall assist in taking local offerings. They shall oversee the spiritual conduct of the church in working with the pastor and one another on spiritual problems and matters of the saints. They shall be ready at anytime to assist the need of every saint who is burdened and in need of spiritual consultation, or general welfare. They have not the right to act upon any program or promotion without agreement with one another, the pastors, or the

trustees if the program they are considering doing involves church funds. They will be responsible before God for their conduct and manner of service, according to the Word of God. They shall not have meeting among themselves without the pastor or associate pastor present.

THE OFFICE OF THE TREASURER

The responsibility of the treasurer is to provide an exact account of the financial status of the present funds in the treasury. This report is to be made available to the pastor or the board of trustees, upon their request of such a report. No other office in the church may have access to this information. He may obtain such information from the trustees report given to him by the treasurer. The treasurer shall sit in on every trustee meeting to take notes and minutes of actions taken by the board of trustees. He has not the authority to convey or acknowledge the financial status information to any acting office in the church but the pastor or board of trustees. He shall not be a consultant in spiritual matters, nor is it of need that he should attend meetings of the deacons. Unless asked to by the pastor.

THE OFFICE OF SUNDAY SCHOOL SUPERINTENDENT

The office of Sunday school superintendent is of vital importance to the church. Though his duties are not major, he is responsible to keep the childrens classes with teachers and supplies that pertain to teaching. He shall undertake to appoint teachers to their rooms assigned to them. He shall, in the absence of a Sunday school teacher, appoint another teacher to take the place of the one absent from duty. He shall watch carefully that the time element of the classes beginning and closing does not interfere with the worship service. He shall present the needs of Sunday school supplies to the board of trustees, who will advise him concerning the funds needed for supplies. He shall not direct the teachers themselves, only assigning them to their classes. He shall not undertake any program without consulting the pastor, for the Sunday school department solely. He is not required to sit in on deacon board meetings, nor on trustee meetings. He is free from any responsibility as that pertaining to a deacon or trustee, that all his time may be given to supervise the Sunday school, with devout interest.

THE OFFICE OF MUSIC PROGRAM

The music program and all order pertaining to the development of such a program is under the supervision of the pastor only, and the associate pastor. During regular - services, special meetings, or revivals, at all times, the pastors shall advise and conduct this program. The trustee board shall advise on the purchasing of any musical instruments and the pastor shall be consulted. Any suggestions for musical programs by the saints, deacons, or such parties interested should be presented to the pastor, who will welcome them, and advise on such suggestions. It is preferred the pastor shall control this program, as he is the leader of the worship service, and confidence is placed in his ability to lead the church in worship that is most pleasing to God. Music programs, testimony services, addresses by various parties, reports to the church by various offices, or any program that intervene the worship time should be under the pastors supervision.

MANUAL -- (a small handbook)

- **consuetudinary, consuetudinal** -- (a **manual** describing the customs of a particular group (especially the ceremonial practices of a monastic order))
- instruction manual, instructions, book of instructions, operating instructions -- (a manual usually accompanying a technical device and explaining how to install or operate it)
- reference manual -- (a manual containing information organized in a summary manner)
- handbook, enchiridion, vade mecum -- (a concise reference book providing specific information about a subject or location)
- manual -- (a small handbook)
- bible -- (a book regarded as authoritative in its field)
- guidebook, guide -- (something that offers basic information or instruction)

Source: WordNet 1.6 Vocabulary Helper: manual <http://www.notredame.ac.jp/cgi-bin/wn?manual#Overview> of noun manual

HAND·BOOK

Pronunciation: -"buk **Function:** noun **Date:** before 12th century

1 a : a book capable of being conveniently carried as a ready reference : MANUAL b : a concise reference book covering a particular subject 2 a : a bookmaker's book of bets b : a place where bookmaking is carried on © 1999 by

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MANUAL

1. a small book for handy use. *a.* In the mediaeval Church, a book containing the forms to be observed in administration of the sacraments. Late ME. *b.* A handbook 1533. 2. Nourishment; food divinely supplied, *esp.* The Holy Communion, late ME.

OXFORD Dictionary

ATTITUDE

The longer I live, the more I realize the impact of attitude on life. Attitude, to me is more important than facts. It is more important than the past, than education, than money, than circumstances, than failures, than successes, than what other people think or say or do. It is more important than appearance, giftedness, or skill. It will make or break a company, a church, a home. The remarkable thing is that we have a choice every day regarding the attitude we will embrace for that day. We cannot change our past..., we cannot change the fact that people will act in a certain way. We cannot change the inevitable. The only thing we can do is play on the one string we have, and that is our attitude. I'm convinced that life is 10 percent what happens to me and 90 percent how I react to it. And so it is with you...we are in charge of our attitude. 

Deacon

(*Diakonos*, *Diakoneō*, & *Diakonia* in Greek) means “service” and “to serve”. It is a service that an individual is called to perform. There are various translations in the Bible of the word Deacon: among them are administrator; one who cares for; minister and servant. The first example of this word is described in John 2:5, where *Diakonos* is used as “waiters” serving at the wedding of Cana (References: Luke 4:39, 10:40, 17:8, & John 12:2). Another form of the word Deacon describes him as a soldier and policeman who enforces justice (Romans 13:4). The fundamental idea behind deaconship is stated in John 12:26 when Jesus mentions that we cannot follow him unless we serve Him. Anything done in obedience to Him is spiritual service. Therefore, all Christians are deacons, for all are to be actively serving Christ and His church. Every Christian is to be involved in some form of spiritual service or ministry.

In Romans 12:6-8, we find that serving is listed as one of the spiritual gifts. Those possessing this gift are specially equipped for service, although they may not hold the office of deacon. I Corinthians 16:15 tells us about Stephanas, a deacon of the early Church, and his family who were gifted and devoted to the ministry of the saints.

The term *deacon* is not used in the Bible until the Holy Ghost, through Paul defined the qualifications of the office pertaining to a deacon. This took place approximately 30 years after the birth of the church on the Day of Pentecost. The Apostle Paul uses this word in only three scriptures in the New Testament. These include I Timothy 3:10, 13 & Philippians 1:1.

In one form or another every Christian is a deacon

We should understand that by being Christians and serving others we are “deacons” whether male or female. This would include those individuals who may not be assigned the title but are gifted of the Holy Ghost to serve, and also those deacons who are selected to hold the office. (You may review this distinction in Romans 12: 6-8 and I Timothy 3:10) Those who hold the office of deacon are to model spiritual virtue, service and lead others by example. They work under the leadership of the pastor and in unison with the Elders, to implement church order and what is being preached and taught.

The Scriptures tell us that after the resurrection of Jesus Christ, as the early church began to grow, it became negligent with the daily ministration. If we break this word down into its components we find the following:

MINISTER *vb* **1** : to perform the functions of a minister of religion **2** : to give aid or service

ADMINISTER *vb* **1** : manage, superintend **2** : to mete out : dispense **3** : to give ritually or remedially <~ quinine for malaria> **4** : to perform the office of administrator

ADMINISTRATION *n* **1** : the act or process of administering **2** : management **3** : the officials directing the government of a country **4** : the term of office of an administrative officer or body — © 1995 Zane Publishing, Inc. The Merriam-Webster Dictionary © 1994 by Merriam-Webster, Incorporated

Subsequently, seven men were chosen to oversee the daily ministration (Acts 6). These seven men performed the duties of a deacon according to the Apostle Paul's requisites mentioned in I Timothy although the word deacon does not appear in Acts 6, they served in the office of deacon. These seven, Holy Ghost-filled men included Stephen, Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas and Nicolas, all which happened to have Greek names. (See Strong's reference). Stephan was chief among them and preceded the Apostle Paul.

In Timothy 3:8-13, the Apostle Paul lists several qualifications for those elected into the office of deacon. These measures are based on spiritual character, not their duties. They are to assist to the needs of the Pastor, Elders and the needs of the congregation.

QUALIFICATIONS FOR DEACONS

I Timothy 3:8-12

8 ¶ Likewise must the deacons be grave, not double-tongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre; 9 Holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience. 10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found blameless. 11 Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things. 12 Let the deacons be the husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well.

There are five areas in which qualifies a person to be a deacon:

1. PERSONAL CHARACTER - *verse 8*
A deacon should be a sober and seasoned individual capable of discerning spiritual matters. The deacon should conduct themselves in a serious, yet warm and joyful manner.
2. SPIRITUAL LIFE - *verse 9*
A deacon must hold the faith with a clear conscience, that is, a conscience that does not accuse him or her.
3. CHRISTIAN SERVICE - *verse 10*
Deacons must undergo training and scrutiny before they officially serve as deacons. This testing should be periodic to encourage them to uphold God's standards.
4. MORAL PURITY - *verse 10 & 12*
Deacons should only have one spouse and should have an unmarred testimony. Their lives should be exemplary and lack cause of accusation, arraignment, and/or disqualification.
5. HOME LIFE - *verse 11 & 12*
Deacons should have every aspect of their lives and family in subjection to God's Word. This includes their finances, possessions, and family responsibilities.

8 ¶ Likewise must the deacons be grave, not double-tonqued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;

GRAVE - (Latin), heavy or weighty, dignified, solemn, or sedate.

Dignified - deserving respect, to give honor.

Respect - partiality or favour in regard of persons or things, to regard, consider, take into account, to pay attention to, to observe carefully, to be directed to, to esteem, prize, or value a thing, to refrain from interfering with, a fact or motive which assist, or leads to, the formation of a decision.

Solemn - according to strict rules.

Sedate - quiet, serious, and without strong feelings, to give and an amount of sedate (sedative). *Oxford Dictionary*

GRAVE (grāv) *adj.* **grav·er, grav·est.** **1.** Requiring serious thought; momentous: *a grave decision in a time of crisis.* **2.** Fraught with danger or harm: *a grave wound.* **3.** Dignified and somber in conduct or character: *a grave procession.* See Synonyms at **serious**. *American Heritage Dictionary*

NOT DOUBLE-TONGUED - duplicity of speech, deceitful or insincere in speech.

Duplicity - the action of being double in action or conduct. *Oxford Dictionary*

NOT GIVEN TO MUCH WINE - Something that intoxicates or exhilarates.

American Heritage Dictionary

NOT GREEDY OF FILTHY LUCRE - (Greek), to enjoy wages, gain, profit, pecuniary advantage, now only in bad sense..., gain viewed as a low motive for action.

Oxford Dictionary

WORD HISTORY: When William Tyndale translated *aiskhron kerdos*, "shameful gain" (Titus 1:11), as *filthy lucre* in his edition of the Bible, he was tarring the word *lucre* for the rest of its existence. But we cannot lay the pejorative sense of *lucre* completely at Tyndale's door. He was merely a link, albeit a strong one, in a process that had begun long before with respect to the ancestor of our word, the Latin word *lucrum*, "material gain, profit." This process was probably controlled by the inevitable conjunction of profit, especially monetary profit, with evils such as greed. In Latin *lucrum* also meant "avarice," and in Middle English *lucre*, besides meaning "monetary gain, profit," meant "illicit gain." Furthermore, many of the contexts in which the neutral sense of the word appeared were not that neutral, as in "It is a wofull thyng . . . ffor lucre of goode . . . A man to fals his othe [it is a sad thing for a man to betray his oath for monetary gain]." Tyndale thus merely helped the process along when he gave us the phrase *filthy lucre*. *American Heritage Dictionary*

9 Holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience.

PURE - free from admixture or adulteration. Free from corruption. *Oxford Dictionary*

CONSCIENCE - the internal recognition of the moral quality of the one's motives or actions. *Oxford Dictionary*

10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found blameless.

AND LET THESE ALSO FIRST BE PROVED -

"Now, you have said, "Let these first be tried, and see if they desire this office." Within a few weeks, God willing, I will return back to lay hands upon this group of men to make them the official trust--or the deacons of this church, and treasurer. Let us bow our heads just a moment:" *PLACING OF DEACONS JEFF. IN COD 58-0720E P/P 358-31*

BLAMELESS - Free of blame or guilt; innocent.

11 Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.

WIVES BE GRAVE - Same as husband (*verse 8*).

NOT SLANDERERS - the utterance of false statements or reports concerning a person or malicious misrepresentation of his/her action, in order to defame or injure him/her, etc. *Oxford Dictionary*

SOBER - of sober mind...self controlled...rational, sensible.

FAITHFUL IN ALL THINGS - full of faith.

THE REWARDS OF FAITHFUL SERVICE

I Timothy 3:13

13 For they that have used the office of a deacon well purchase to themselves a good degree, and great boldness in the faith which is in Christ Jesus.

Those who offer true service as deacons are rewarded with an honorable standing before God and man, and with "boldness in the faith". This offer, although simply stated has immense benefit, for what is a servant of God without a good testimony? A faithful deacon will gain the confidence and trust not only of the people, but the approval of God.

PLACING OF DEACONS by William Marrion Branham

July 20, 1958

358-30 I wish to say to the--the brethren who are standing at this present time, at the foot of this cross, that this church, with one hundred percent (no contrary at all), finds you all worthy in the sight of God for this office that God has called you. Now, you have said, "Let these first be tried, and see if they desire this office." Within a few weeks, God willing, I will return back to lay hands upon this group of men to make them the official trust--or the deacons of this church, and treasurer. Let us bow our heads just a moment:

358-32 Lord, we are happy tonight that there is men still living on the earth that can walk godly before the world, so godly that a Tabernacle, with strict rules as this one has, can vote five men into position as their leaders without one vote contrary. We are happy for them, and we feel that You were with us in making these decisions, the board and we pastors. God, bless these men. And may they serve this office with all their hearts, knowing that it is purchasing to them a great degree in heaven. Someday when the books of heaven shall be closed, may the Book of the celestial beings and the great Book of heaven be opened, may their names be one hundred percent before God and the Saviour and all the heavenly hosts to be the same in His Kingdom. Bless them, Lord, and may they serve this office well. In Jesus' Name we thank You for them. Amen.

DEACON'S MISSION STATEMENT

To serve God's children whole-heartedly and joyfully; wearing a genuine smile in full recognition that my self-sacrifice and service is an offering to my Lord Jesus Christ; being sober at all times, vigilant in protecting my testimony and not bringing reproach unto God's Word; to be a coal of fire burning with praise that I might create an atmosphere of worship. To uphold and defend the Word and to lead by my example.

Scripture Readings:(Sober: I Thessalonians 5:6, Titus 2:6, I Peter 1:13, 4:7, 5:8)

□ □ □ □ □

USHERS & DEACONS

Israel in Egypt

by William Marrion Branham

March 25, 1953

And I'm going to lay this really home. I used to be when I was here, I was the pastor, I was the song leader, I took up the offerings, I paid the debts, I was the janitor, and I was the carpenter, and I just cleaned the ashes out of the stove, and just done whatever come along to be done. Then worked at the Public Service Company on the side. Seventeen years of that, I was here. And I'm very happy for this little old structure tonight. And it's certainly like a birthplace to me. Not very elaborate, but it's a--and not so gigantic; but it's home, and I feel very comfortable. And I'm so happy for it.

Taking Sides with Jesus

by William Marrion Branham

June 1, 1962

Like you was a little boy, say, my business is just to chop the wood, not pack it in. Let John pack it in. I don't care if snow falls on it, rains ... let him get out and get it. No! it's your duty as a child of that home to see that that wood don't get wet for your mother. See. Pack it in. If they say, well, Frank should've went and got water, it ain't my business ... But if Frank didn't get the water, it's your business to take care of the water. That's all. Now. that's just the way it runs, and that's the way it runs in God's family too.

WHAT IS A MINISTER?

Why Cry? Speak!

by William Marrion Branham

October 4, 1959

I am a servant to the public, a public servant, is a minister, serve the public. To be the underdog, to take this knocks and drives of the public, whatever it is, stand there. And if you haven't got grace enough to smile and take it, then you ought to go back to Calvary and reconfirm your commission. That's what you are suppose to do.

The Kinsman Redeemer

by William Marrion Branham

October 2, 1960

The preacher is a public servant. He just holds himself there, like a lily of the field, the bumble bee flies in and gets his part, the honey bee flies and gets his, the by-passer gets his and everything. He tolls day and night to keep his radiance. And the Gospel minister does the same thing. Walks in the line of God. Holds his testimony true, that the world might partake of him, see, Mr. Pastor Lily. He is a

good one. Jesus said, consider him. Solomon is not like him.

PLACING OF DEACONS

Placing of Deacons by William Marrion Branham

July 20, 1958

353-1 And that is, that the first is the placing some deacons into the church. **And our little church here is sovereign. It doesn't have any denomination or anything to send its deacons; it elects its own deacons. It elects its pastor; it elects its trustees; it elects everything that comes in and out of the church. No one person has the say-so over anything; it's the church. And the church are those who come and support the church with their presence, with their tithe and offerings, are always the ones that has legal say-so in the placing of such.** And I want to thank the past board of deacons, and I say it from here for all the church. If any of those brethren are here, which was Brother Cox, Brother Fleeman, and Brother Higginbotham and Brother Deatsman, they have give us a good service, give the Lord, in this Tabernacle.

353-3 And ever so often, according to the bylaws of the church, every year, the

BY-LAW

a law or ordinance dealing with matters of local or internal regulation, made by a local authority, or by a corporation.

deacons or trustees automatically fill their time. And if they want to come back, all right. If they do not want to come back, then they can place some in their places, that this board has resigned. And the other night I called the trustee board, which there is a new board of trustees. Till I noticed Brother Luther McDowell here tonight; we're glad to see him in, which was formerly on the trustee board. I went down this week to find out and to check into having a photostatic copy made, which will be presented to the church also. That the trustees of the church now is Brother William Morgan, Brother Mike Egan, and Brother Banks Wood, and Brother Roy Roberson. And they're all of this city, except Brother Roberson that lives between the two cities. The Lord has seen fit in those men, and they have been honorable men, and they have now received the duty as trustees of this church.

353-5 And then while this meeting was going on, and was told by the assistant pastor that we--selecting of the new board of deacons, that these had served their time out and--and resigned, and it was to select some more deacons. Now, the church... **The way this is done is the board can appoint deacons, men that they have**

associated with and found to be honorable and just men. The office of a deacon is a very great office, and a great honor to the Lord to be a deacon in the church. And so in the meeting the other night, certain man was called out to me. And when meeting with the pastor, the following--this last Friday, which was agreed by this man that these were honorable and just men.

HONORABLE

Worthy of being honored; entitled to respect, reverence.

JUST

Upright, and impartial in one's dealings; appropriate, suitable, suitable, complete in amount or character. Exactly, precisely, in replies etc. in accordance with reason, truth or facts, rights true, correct, exact, accurate, exact as opposed to approximate.

354-7 One young man that they had found, was not exactly qualified (not because that he wasn't the right type of man), one that was suggested by one of the honorable men of our trustee board. But as the pastor and I came together, and I asked the age of the young man, he was in his early twenties: honorable, just, and a real man, but find out that he was a single man. The Bible requires a deacon to be a married man. He must be the husband of one wife. And then another man which was a very honorable man, very qualified for the job and would made a loyal man, as a brother suggested him. Then after investigating the case, that the brother had just recently come into this faith; his wife doesn't believe in it. Then that disqualified the man as the office, because he must have all his family in subjection. They must be also in the faith, because it would be a conflict.

354-9 And we're building now, and we wish to place this church. And as the **general overseer** of the church, I must see that it's kept Scripturally, everything right on the Word. **And so therefore, then it has been found favorable with the board and the pastor, and the overseer, to select in this group of people here some men who we think to be honorable and just men. We can only bring them. And it's then they are appointed by the church, by their own vote. And then these man shall serve, if they feel that they will accept this office. Then they will come for a short time to see if they feel that maybe that God has called them. And if later, if they feel that they are disqualified, then they have a right in the next few weeks to resign the office, that someone else could be appointed in their place.**

354-11 However, at the beginning of the revival that (if God willing) I want to hold here in this Tabernacle as soon as I get some rest, then I--then I'll... **We will**

ordain these deacons by laying on hands, deacons and treasurer in this church. But first they must be appointed and--and see how they like it and how the congregation likes it. Then if it's--then if it's all right on both sides, then we make these men ordained deacons, just like trustees are elected the same way. It's the sovereignty and the law of the church by the Word of God. Therefore, that--they just can't say that, "I think this man would be a right man." That isn't it. "Brother Neville thinks this man would be a right man," or "the trustee board thinks this man would be a right man," **it has to be by the church. No one does anything within himself here. It's the vote of the church.** It's a sovereign church. The old set of bylaws was destroyed in the 1937 flood. We have recopied those, and will be hung on the wall here soon, the duties of trustees, deacons, treasurer, and so forth, pastor, associates, and so forth.

355-14 By the grace of God, it has been said to me, and a one hundred percent vote through the board of this church, that they have found that Brother Hollin Hickerson to be a just, honorable man, and in line in this position to receive the--the great honor of being deacon of this said Tabernacle. Also, we have found, and by the vote of the board, that Brother Collins also has been found an honorable and just man. Being a minister himself; therefore, we would ask him to come and to be a--a deacon of the church; and not only deacon, but an associate to Brother Neville, and perhaps to a Sunday school class, or to take the place of Brother Neville, or whatever is being called on, he to be an associate to Brother Neville. That's Brother Collins. And also the church has found in favor, that Brother Tony Zabel, an honorable and just man, and he's been favored before the trustee board and the pastors, to ask him to receive the office of deacon in this said Tabernacle.

355-17 And it's also been asked, and found an honorable man among us... (Not... these not being the only honorable men now, but just has been selected by the board.) Brother Taylor from Henryville, or Memphis, I believe it is, Memphis, Indiana. He's been with us for some time, acting as usher and whatever could be. That the church has found favor with him, or the board and pastor, that he would accept the--the great office as being the deacon of this said Tabernacle. And it's also been asked that Brother Mike Egan's son-in-law, Brother--Brother Bob Harnard, has been selected by the board and by the pastor, to accept the office as treasurer of this said Tabernacle, which is an honorable job, and it requires justice and honor. In doing this, I think, my brethren, that calling you from here, that it would be a great honor to you. And not only that, but something to do.

356-20 At this time I will have Brother Neville, our associate, to read the

requirements of the deacon. Brother Neville, if you'll read it from the Word of God. [Brother Neville reads I Timothy 3:8-13--Ed.]:

Likewise must the deacons be grave, not double-tongued, not given to much wine and greedy of filthy lucre;

Holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience.

And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found blameless.

Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.

Let the deacons be the husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well.

For they that have used the office of a deacon well purchase to themselves a good degree, and great boldness in the faith which is in Christ Jesus.

356-21 Amen. I would at this time ask these brethren who has been called, if they would just walk forward here to the platform just a moment. And as we bow our heads just a moment for prayer, I want them... And the church knows what this is, that this is electing your deacon board and your treasurer. **Lord Jesus, it is with sober, godly thinking that we come to Thee now.** We come in respects of Thy most holy Word; we come believing that "Let every man's word be wrong, but God's be true." And we are grateful to Thee for this church which Jesus has purchased with His own precious Blood, and has given us this building to worship in...And as the overseers of this great flock, which the Holy Ghost has ordained us to be, we are trying now to present to this congregation a loyal, righteous bunch of men that we believe to be Spirit-filled and ready for the office. **As it is once said concerning the deacon board, "Go, look out yourself among you, men of good reports and with the Holy Spirit, that they might serve in this manner to take care of the widows and orphans, to distribute the money, and to care for the welfare of the church."** Later years we have just read the writing of that great, inspired, sainted Paul, who sets forth the declaration of the Scriptures of the **requirements of such position.** God, honor these men. And now it is the choice, Lord, as a sovereign church, as the body of the Lord Jesus, that they do the electing. And [Blank.spot.on.tape--Ed.]... and will direct this portion of the service in a special way, in that righteous and holy Name of Jesus.

357-25 Now with our heads bowed, not only our heads but our hearts, and as every member of this church, that comes here regular and supports it with your tithe and offerings, which is considered a member of this church... While, the pastor and I,

alone, the--the associate pastor, Brother Neville, and I look on, I would ask if this church finds Brother Taylor to be a just man and eligible, by the best of your thinking to be deacon over this group of people, you will signify the same by raising your hand. [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] All right. Now if there is any contrary, would you raise your hand. [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] Thank you.

357-26 Does any of this members of this church here find, and all, do you find Brother Hollin Hickerson to be a just and honorable man, and a man that's found in your sight worthy to become the deacon of this said church, would you signify by raising your right hand? [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] If it is contrary, then raise your hand. [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] Does this congregation find Brother Collins to be the same, a righteous and honorable man, and worthy of the job of being deacon of this church? Would you raise your hand? [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] All right. Contrary, would you raise your hand? [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.]

357-28 Does this congregation find Brother Tony Zabel to be an honorable man and worthy of this office, of being deacon over this flock in this said church? Would you raise your right hand. [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] Contrary, would you raise your hand? [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] Does this congregation feel that Brother Harnard is a just and righteous man, who has been with us for some time, to be the treasurer, secretary-treasurer of this church, to handle its finances and to pay its bills? If so, raise your right hand. [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.] Is there any contrary, raise your right hand. [Brother Branham pauses--Ed.]

358-30 I wish to say to the--the brethren who are standing at this present time, at the foot of this cross, that this church, with one hundred percent (no contrary at all), finds you all worthy in the sight of God for this office that God has called you. **Now, you have said, "Let these first be tried, and see if they desire this office." Within a few weeks, God willing, I will return back to lay hands upon this group of men to make them the official trust--or the deacons of this church, and treasurer.** Let us bow our heads just a moment:

358-32 Lord, we are happy tonight that there is men still living on the earth that can walk godly before the world, so godly that a Tabernacle, with strict rules as this one has, can vote five men into position as their leaders without one vote contrary. We are happy for them, and we feel that You were with us in making these decisions, the board and we pastors. God, bless these men. **And may they serve this office with all their hearts, knowing that it is purchasing to them a great degree in**

heaven. Someday when the books of heaven shall be closed, may the Book of the celestial beings and the great Book of heaven be opened, may their names be one hundred percent before God and the Saviour and all the heavenly hosts to be the same in His Kingdom. Bless them, Lord, and may they serve this office well. In Jesus' Name we thank You for them. Amen.

RULE

the code of discipline or body of regulation observed by a religious order; or congregation. A principle regulating practice or procedure.

REGULATION

A rule prescribed for the management of some matter, or regulating of conduct.

358-34 I just want to shake your hands: Brother Harnard, and Brother Zabel, and Brother Collins, Brother Hickerson, and Brother Taylor. So happy to know that we have fellowshiped all this time with such honorable men. God bless you now. And we will see you right away, as soon as I get a little rest and get back, and see how you like your office. All right, by their vote, I think was one hundred percent, no contrary at all. Oh, aren't you glad that you're associating with people today who can live before God, godly, and live before this present world in that condition? It is a wonderful thing.

359-36 And I'm so glad to know tonight that I have the privilege of--of having these men and this church to be my friends. I'm so glad that God let me associate myself with His church all over the world. Oh, they are despised and rejected and talked about, and as I said this morning in my message, maybe just mud daubers, the way the world looks at them, as a bunch of fanatics, but God looks at them as His children. I'm so happy for that. They might not be able to tell you how many miles it is to the moon. They might not be able to tell you all the solar systems and how it operates. But there's one thing they do know: they know the hour they were borned again. I'm so glad for them.

359-37 And as a little parable that I learned, and I'm going to associate it tonight with my two little girls to kind of make it come home to us, to make it real to us, that you'd understand the meaning of it. One morning, raising up out of bed... I got two little girls. One of them is Rebekah, and one of them is Sarah, and they're daddy's little girls. And I've got a little boy, Joseph. I was coming from Chattanooga, out of a meeting one night, while I was there in this last campaign. And I was in the--the car, going along with my oldest son, Billy. His wife and Meda was in the car, and the

girls. And as we were rolling along, nobody had said nothing for several city blocks. And I'd cut pretty hard on the people that night about the way they were doing. Nobody had said anything. And little Joseph come over and grabbed me by the shoulder, and he said, "Daddy, you sure did preach tonight."

359-39 And this morning, as I was leaving and going up to Eighth and Tenth Street, the--or Penn and Tenth, rather, nobody had said a thing, the wife and the two girls. And little Joseph took ahold of my shoulder again; he said, "Daddy, that, I sure liked that preaching this morning," he said.

I said, "Well, I've got one fan; that's my son."

And to our little saying... Up one morning and sitting in the room, little Becky come running out and say, she straddled my leg and put her arm around me, and she's daddy's little girl. And she was hugging me. And little Sarah jumped out of bed with her little pajamas and would, say, come running next. She's the little brown-eyed one. Little Becky would say, "Oh, Sarah, there's no need of you coming, because I've got all of daddy myself. Daddy's all mine." And little Sarah, her little lips dropped down; her little brown eyes colored up. I motioned like this and stuck out the other knee, and she come and straddled it.

360-42 Becky's got longer legs, so they would reach the floor. Little Sarah was toddling, so I put both arms around Sarah. Little Sarah looked over to Becky and said, "Becky, you may have all of daddy, but daddy's got all of me."

And I think that's the way it is here. We might not know all of the theology, all the great Greek words, this group of people might not know. But there's one thing sure: I believe Jesus has got all of us. Amen. All right, Brother Neville.

CHURCH ORDER

COD SUPPLEMENT

by William Marrion Branham

October 6, 1958

1191-1 We have just closed the big meeting, of five nights at the Tabernacle, where, by God's grace and by His help, I have tried hard by the Scripture, to set in order the Church of the Lord Jesus Christ, as we believe at the Branham Tabernacle. **The first thing I wish to say is that the pastor is always in full charge of the Tabernacle in my absence, and I only look to the pastor when I return.** So he is in full charge to change or to do whatsoever he thinks is best under the leadership of the Holy Spirit while I am away.

1191-3 We believe in an apostolic Church, teaching apostolic blessing for people of this day. We believe in the full Gospel, and believe that all of the signs and the wonders that was spoken of by our Lord Jesus Christ, would accompany His Church until He returned. We believe in those things, and believe that they are to be set in order, that the Church has its order. And each church has its doctrine, and order, and discipline. **Our church has no members as joiners. We believe that the whole universal Church of the living God is our brothers and sisters; and that all people are always welcome, regardless of what denomination they belong to, at the Branham Tabernacle, at 8th and Penn Street in Jeffersonville, Indiana.**

1191-5 We believe in justification by faith, Romans 5:1. We believe, that after a person being justified by faith, he has peace with the Lord Jesus Christ. But it's possible that this same person could have habits such as drinking, smoking, doing things that he should not do, filthy habits of the flesh. Then we believe that the Blood of Jesus Christ sanctifies this person for the service of the Lord. And that's... We believe in sanctification according to Hebrews 13:12 and 13, "Where Jesus also, that He might sanctify the people with His Own Blood, suffered without the gate." And we believe that sanctification is taught in the New Testament, and meant for the believers through the New Testament age, which we're now living. And we also believe that after the person has been sanctified, unclean habits has gone from the person. He is a believer on the Lord Jesus Christ, and his habits are gone; we believe that then he is a candidate for the baptism of the Holy Spirit, which comes as a filling of the believer. And then when the believer...It's just, as many times as I have taught it, like picking up a glass out in the chicken yard. Justification is picking it up, ready for--to use it, with a purpose in heart. That's what God does to the sinner. He is still filthy. Then he is cleansed by the Blood of Jesus Christ. And the word "sanctify" is a compound word, which means, "cleaned, and set aside for service." In the Old

Testament the altar sanctified the vessel, and it was set aside for service.

1192-10 We believe that the Holy Spirit is putting the same vessel in service. That the Holy Spirit is not another step of grace, but more of the same grace that fills the believer to the extent where that signs and wonders, such as the apostolic gifts spoken of in I Corinthians 12, manifest themselves through this believer, when the Holy Spirit comes in to take up the gifts. **I believe that the Scripture teaches that gifts and callings are without repentance, that when we are born in this world, we are sent here by one purpose, that is, of God. And that before we are even become adults, while we're yet children, the gifts that we have of God is in us then, and only the filling of the Holy Spirit puts these gifts into operation; but we have them in the beginning, such as teachers, and apostles, and--and prophets, and gifts of tongues, and the nine spiritual gifts according to I Corinthians 12. Now, we believe that these gifts are in operation today, and they should be in every local church. Although, in such we have found throughout the world, that there is much fanaticism hooked along with people who profess to be apostolic believers. Just as they are in other orders, and so forth, we have fanatics. That's been all along; we've had those through the ages, they had it in the apostolic days; and as Paul said there, that how that some had come and persuaded them away, after other doctrines, and so forth. But in his own teaching, he said if an Angel from heaven would teach anything else than what he had taught, let him be accursed.**

1192-13 So we, as the Branham Tabernacle, at 8th and Penn Street here, try to follow the teachings of the New Testament. For we believe that Jesus Christ, being the Son of God... And Paul the apostle was a called and chosen vessel by election of God, to be sent to the Gentile Church, to set it in order. Now, we believe in water baptism in the Branham Tabernacle, by immersing in the Name of the Lord Jesus Christ, which is the apostolic teaching of the Bible. And may all members of us, or comers to the Branham Tabernacle, who desire such, may at anytime (requesting to) be immersed, in the Name of the Lord Jesus. May he consult the pastor; if they have repented, and believed on the Lord Jesus Christ, the pastor will, as soon as possible, even at... then if he can, baptize them immediately. This does bring them into the fellowship of the believers. We believe that by water baptism we are brought into a fellowship. But by the baptism of the Holy Spirit, we are brought into the members, being members of the Body of Jesus Christ, which is all over the world.

1193-16 Now, another thing that we believe: that the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal. **Now, we believe that when these gifts, and so forth, are operating in the Church... Which we covet and desire that the people**

who are gifted by the Spirit, come and worship with us. Now, in most places we find that when these gifts in the people, the people does not understand how and when to use these gifts, and in doing so they only bring a reproach; which we believe would be just what Satan could do to make the outsiders, the unbelievers and so forth, afraid of this wonderful Blessing that God has given to the Church in these days. Paul said, "When there come a stranger among us, and would all speak with tongues, won't the man go away and say we were mad? But if one would prophesy, and make known the secret of the heart, then they would fall down and say, 'Truly, God is with you.'"

1193-19 Now, we believe that the spiritual gifts among the believers, is the order of the day. We cannot believe that a man can preach under inspiration and then--be an inspired teacher, and then deny the gift of healing, or the gift of prophecy, or speaking with tongues, or interpretation of tongues, or any of these other gifts. So therefore, here is my belief in God's Word, the way the Branham Tabernacle, at 8th and Penn Street here in Jeffersonville, should be operated. I think, the first thing, and believe that these things which I say is essential and must be carried out in this manner in the Branham Tabernacle, for it to prosper in the Lord. And if at anytime these--this, would be questioned, the person who is in question about it may consult me if they cannot get to the pastor, or they can consult the pastor. If I'm home, off of some of the trips, I'll be glad to--to help either the laity or the pastor at any time. And these things are Scripturally, and I believe it's the order of the Church.

1193-21 I think, first, that every member, or every worshipper, of the Branham Tabernacle, should be so much in Divine love with each other until it would--their hearts would long for each other when they have to go away, to leave each other at the service at night. I am a true believer in Divine love. The apostle Paul said that was the evidence of the Holy Spirit. "By this manner, all man will know you are My disciples," said Jesus, "when you have love one for the other." And we believe that it's the love of God that sent Jesus Christ to the earth to die for us all. "God so loved the world, He gave His only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in Him should not perish but will have Everlasting Life." And the Everlasting Life here is "God's Own Life," because **we become sons and daughters of God by the baptism of the Holy Spirit; which is the Seed of Abraham, and gives us the faith that Abraham had, when he believed God before he was even circumcised.**

1194-22 Now, the next thing, we believe that these worshippers should meet

together, these gifted people, such as tongues, and people who gets revelations and interpretations, and so forth. These members, or these believers, rather, should come together at least forty-five minutes or an hour before the services ever begin. The church should be opened early, and the believers come together on these nights, and at least forty-five minutes to an hour before the services begin.

1194-23 I believe the Branham Tabernacle at all times should have a Spirit-filled pianist, who would come early, filled with the Holy Spirit, and would play softly, very softly, spiritual music, such as, "Down at the cross where the Saviour died, down there for cleansing from sin I cried; there to my heart was the Blood applied, glory to His Name!" Something on that order, "Nearer, My God, To Thee", "Rock Of Ages, Cleft For Me." Or, "Near The Cross," or something on that order; softly, slowly, as he is meditating constantly on the Holy Spirit, he or she, whichever it may be. Then I believe that the worshippers, coming in, should be met, and there hang their coats and hats, shown to their seats, with hospitality that only ushers or deacons filled with the Holy Spirit can do, and in love, to see the Church of the living God go on.

1194-25 **These worshippers should not talk one with another, and be talking across, and making noise in the church. They should come together. First, slip up in silent prayer, perhaps at the altar for a few moments. No loud praying, you interrupt someone else; silent prayer, you are in worship. Let that soak in. Worshipping in your spirit, then return to your seat. Or you do not have to go to the altar. Just go in and get you a seat, sit down, listen to the music; close your eyes, bow your head; and, being silent, and worshipping God, all along.**

1194-28 Then if the Spirit should reveal something to another, or--or someone be filled with the Spirit to a place where they would speak with tongues, then this person should rise and give the message. **And everyone must hold their peace until the interpretation comes.** When the interpretation comes, it must not be just quoting a Scripture, or--or something that has no meaning. It must be a message directed to the Church, or we think that it would be in the flesh; we see so much of that. And now, as I believe, the--the Spirit was to speak only for the edifying of the Church.

1195-30 And now, it would be a message something on this order, perhaps. Perhaps the people are gathering by this time, some sick people has come in. Perhaps there is a man laying, paralyzed or something. You've never seen him before. But when the interpretation would come, it would be something in this order; when the

interpretation, or the one who has just spoke, would say, "Well, THUS SAITH THE LORD, the man who is in our midst has come from a certain-certain place," and describe the place. And would say that, "He is paralyzed, because three or four years ago," whatever it may, the case may be, "he did something evil," like, "left his wife and children, and run off from them. And he fell from a truck," or something like that order, "and has got hurt, and it's paralyzed him. THUS SAITH THE LORD. If he will repent of that, and will promise to go to his wife and reconcile himself to her, then he shall be healed now and return to his family."

1195-31 And then before anyone says anything, there must be at least two, or more, men or people in the building, who are spiritually solid in Gospel doctrine, who has a good discernment of spirit, shall rise up and say that it is of the Lord. And if this thing doesn't take place, then tongues should not be mentioned in the church. If the person speaks with tongues, Paul said, "If there be no interpreter," and so forth, "let them speak at home," or wherever they may be, "for they are only blessing themselves, and it's not for edification of the Church."

1195-33 And this person, after speaking, and the interpretation... And then two or three judges, according to Saint Paul's doctrine of the Bible, that it must be judged by two or three judges. Then let the person in whom it calls upon, to go. And maybe It might designate a certain person, or the pastor or someone, to go lay hands on this person, and that is sick or afflicted, and they will be healed. Then let the pastor or the other person, whoever it may be, that it was designated by the Holy Spirit to go pray the prayer of faith, let them go and minister to the person according to what the Spirit has said. Then at that time, the person upon... And whatever the Holy Spirit has said, it shall take place, immediately then, just as the Holy Spirit has give it. And then the people could rejoice, and be thankful, and praise and worship God, 'cause God wants to be worshipped.

1196-36 Then they must, then they must bow their heads and be in prayer again, to see if there be another message that the Holy Spirit would want these gifts to manifest, before. **And then if anytime that a person would speak in tongues, and interpret, and the--the judges would send the person to take, to do whatever it was said to be done, and it doesn't come to pass, then the whole group of them shall go to the altar and there pray God to take that spirit away from them, because there is no one would want a spirit like that.** We would know it would be false, and would be of the enemy and not of God, 'cause God can only tell truth. Let that be clearly understood by the church, before you start this, this new order.

1196-38 Then, perhaps, maybe it would be something like this, the message would say to a certain brother, maybe that, say, would... "Lived by a railroad track," or something, "to have him to move out, because there is going to be a wreck on the road," or something, or anything in that order. And let the judges, after they give the church permission to speak, or to exercise this message that just went forth, if their judgment is, "It's of God," then watch and see if it comes to pass. And if it comes to pass, thank God, and be very graceful, graceful in your heart towards Him. And give Him praise and worship, and be humble. Above all things, be humble.

1196-41 **Don't never get yourself puffed up to a place where you know more about it than your pastor or the church that you are worshipping in.** If you get to that place, then I would advise each one of you to get another place to worship with. Because, I am asking the pastor never to permit anything outside of the Bible order, the way we have seen it here in the church. **And then we want these gifts to be operated, and in place, and the worshippers. If it's carried on correctly, according to the Word, you'll see a mighty wonderful church in operation for our Lord Jesus Christ.**

1196-42 **Now, then the next thing shall take place, will be that if these people who have, that gets out of order during these times, that a deacon or some usher that's filled with the Holy Ghost and got lots of grace in their heart, shall go to the person, reverently, fatherly like, and shall correct them in this manner. Or the pastor, whoever it may be, which would be more essential for the deacons to do so; for the pastor, at this time, while these spiritual services are going on, should be in the prayer room, or somewhere, a-praying.** These messages, then if there is no messages going on, no revelations, then the people would be privileged, if they desired, to raise and give a testimony, a testimony only for the glory of God. They're not bound to do this, but testimonies should be given before the message or any song service starts, or anything, testimonies in these worship services. Do you understand, church, that, in doing this, you have the whole church in the spirit of worship, before the Word comes in to be taught. Then the Holy Spirit gets in the Word and manifests God through the Word, to be a confirmation of your worship.

1197-45 Now, then after this, a time for the pastor to come on. If messages are going on, say... The pastor should come out exactly, say, seven-thirty, and, or a quarter of eight. And if these messages are still going on, before the pastor comes to his... out of his study, or wherever he may, to take his place at the platform; some brother should instruct him, because the saints know that when the pastor comes on the platform, it's his time then for the service. And that gives plenty, ample time for

all the manifestations of the gifts, to bring the Spirit of God into the--the congregation.

1197-46 And if any unbeliever would happen to be there, be disorderly; a kindhearted person would go to them, such as an usher or a deacon, and would tell them that they would--they would... asked to be kept reverent, or be reverent while the service is in order. Because, the Spirit is in the building, and the gifts of God are being made manifest for the edifying of the Church. And this person must be told in love, and not harshly. Unless it would come to a place where they were drinking, or some disobedient, or something another that would be interfering with the worship of--of the Lord, which the gifts are then being manifest; then the person should, would, or should be led out to one side, to one of the back rooms, or somewhere, and be talked to, and dealt with, kindly.

1197-47 Now, while the pastor comes to the platform. As the pastor comes to the platform, I would suggest, at the Branham Tabernacle here, that the pastor lead the congregation in at least one or two good songs. For we have found it so, that when too many are trying to operate in the church, it brings on only trouble. I would suggest, as I did while I was pastoring at the church; I led the songs, myself. And I feel that it would be a good thing if the pastor did so, himself.

1197-48 And in all prayer meetings, where they're gathered together, groups, a prayer meeting, the pastor must be at each one. It should never be left to any individual to go lead such meetings. For we have found it so, that they get off the track, on doctrine, and then they cause--bring it right back into the church, and, many time, bring heresies, and so forth, which doesn't belong in the Church of the living God. **And the pastor should be at all prayer meetings, and so forth, where congregate--or gatherings are.**

1198-49 **And the pastor should never take sides in the meeting, by saying there is one group is this way and one that way. The pastor should stand between both of them, and go to them, and get them reconciled, immediately. And if he can't get them reconciled, let him take a deacon with him. And then if they're--they won't hear neither pastor nor deacon, then it should be told to the church, and, as Jesus said, "Let them be unto you as a heathen and a publican." "And whatever you bind on earth," said Jesus, "I will bind in Heaven, and what you loose on earth, I will loose in Heaven."**

1198-50 Now, when the pastor comes to the platform, let the pastor then lead, at least, one or two songs, and go straight to the Word. Not no time for these long testimony meetings, and everybody get up, and a word to say. That does not prosper in the Branham Tabernacle. If any people, if you are listening to this tape, and, you, it has prospered in your church, well, that's perfectly all right. And we are very glad of that, that it does prosper in your church. But in ours here, it does not, it only causes confusion. I've been pastoring here for twenty-some-odd years, and I have found that it only causes confusion. If you've got a testimony, give it before, in the congregation of the people, while the Spirit is a-blessing, and so forth.

1198-54 Or, the real way to testify, is not in the church, is out in dark places. Let your Light shine where it's dark. Go to roadhouses and different places, and where sin and thing is heaping, then let your Light shine. There is the place to do it. But, however, if the Lord has blessed you and give you some great special blessing, or something that you have to tell the people, do it in time of the other service, the pre-service, the preliminary, or when the Spirit is blessing and giving testimonies and revelations, and tongues and interpretations, and so forth, in the worship, of the saints, before the Word of God is being brought forth.

1198-56 Then the pastor, after leading this hymn, shall immediately lead the church in prayer, and a congregational prayer, himself, as he stands at the platform, asking the rest of them to bow their heads in prayer. This we have found to be a greater blessing, and a more ruly in operating in the church. And then, the next thing the pastor should do then, after. If they had a real spiritual meeting, with the gifts making manifest many secrets of the people's hearts, and things which should be done by the gifts in the meeting; then the Spirit of God is in the meeting, and it's very easy then for the pastor to find the Spirit of God (which is already in the meeting) on the Word of God, as he reads and starts preaching. The pastor then preach anything that the Holy Spirit would put on his heart, whatever he wishes to do, standing there.

1199-59 But the congregation is to only... They can rejoice, as he is preaching, of course, or say "amen" when the Word comes forth. But, as far as getting up and giving a--a messages in tongues and interpretation, while the--the Holy Spirit is working through the pastor, the Scripture condemns that, and said, "The spirit of the prophet is subject to the prophet." The pastor then must call this individual down, and ask them to be reverent and to keep their place. The pastor must be a man that has got a very humble way about him, but not too humble but what he could be like the Lord Jesus Christ when He seen wrong

going on in the church, He platted ropes and ran them out of the church. And now the Church of God is the highest of judgment, and the pastor is the highest order in the Church. The elder is the highest thing in the apostolic Church, outside of the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit brings His Message straight to the elder, and the elder gives it to the people.

1199-61 The saints and their gifts shall have their place, first, to worship and come together, which brings (as I have said before) the Spirit of the Lord, in the building, for the pastor. And it makes it much easier for the Holy Spirit to work through him then, when a great spiritual meeting has just preceded his teaching; and then the Holy Spirit gets into the Word and teaches the Word; has just been manifested by the gifts. And then the altar call is being made then, afterwards, and many then will see and know, according to the working of the Holy Spirit, and the Word of God which the pastor places It on, that you are the Church of the living God. And as Paul said, of old, "He will fall down and say, 'Truly, God is with you.'" It... Now, in these things, let it be done with reverence.

1199-63 And now to the pastor, to our Brother Neville, at this time. Remember, he is the full head of the church. Brother Neville has the right to exercise any authority that the Holy Spirit would, anything the Holy Spirit would tell him to say, in other words. **In the church, he has the right to anything that God would lead him to do. He also has the right over his deacon board. He can change the deacon board, the trustees, or--or pianist, or any other office in the church that he desires to change, feeling led by the Holy Spirit to do so. And whatever he does, I will recognize it, as he (I believe) to be a godly man.** I will recognize it to be of the Lord, and will sanction the same, therefore it gives him the authority then to operate the church the way he feels led to do it. Now, or, any office in the church, that he desires to--to--to switch positions of people, for he has the authority to do that. Which, I trust that this will always be lovely and never have to be used.

1200-64 Now, may the Lord bless you all. And I trust that this will be carried out to the very best of your knowledge. And may the Holy Spirit watch over each one of you. **And may every officer of the church fill his post of duty, knowing this, that God is going to hold you responsible for how you held your office in the church. Each one will have to give an account.** And to the laity, and the dear gifted saints that's in our church, those who--who prophesy, or speak with tongues, or interpret, or have revelations, we are just so happy to have you in the service. And we will give you full cooperation in everything that the Holy Spirit shall prove that He has said to you. And we love you. And we believe that these gifts are in you, and, if you have a

right opportunity, and a Scripturally presentation of it, that you will make great workers in our midst. And may the Lord bless you all, is my sincere prayer.

1200-67 Christians, since listening to this tape, I have one thing that I seen I left out, and that is this; that, while people are speaking with tongues, it must be in the courses of two or three, according to the Scripture. That is, **there is only two or three messages to be given in each single service.** After that according to the Scriptures, that, "These courses must be only two, or three." So may you carry these things out, accordingly, the way the Holy Spirit has dir--directed it in His Bible. And this is, the best of my knowledge, the way to do it. Paul said, "Let them be by courses, two or three, when they are speaking." The Lord bless you.

PASTOR'S ASSISTANTS

Total Deliverance

by William Marrion Branham

July 12, 1959

29 Now, each one of these has things in common. And I think that your meeting should not be together, but it should be as each office, cause the deacons has nothing to say to the trustees unless they got some business to present to them. And vice versa, the trustees is over the finance and things of the building; they have nothing with the deacons. **The deacons are the policemen of the church, and the assistants to the pastor.** And the trustees is the holding of all the property. **The trustees has nothing to do with the spiritual end of it, and the deacon has nothing to do with the financial end of it.** Therefore, it must be. And the Sunday school superintendent is over his Sunday school. So I've got it all wrote, typed out, to be on the bulletin board.

RESPONSIBILITIES OF A DEACON

Church Order

by William Marrion Branham

December 26, 1963

884-Q-222 **Now, is there any better way to keep order in the church than to keep reminding the people with a--a repeat from the deacons accordingly?** No, that, I just explained that. That's question number three.

884-56 The deacons, your duty is to keep order in the church with kindness and

friendliness. And then you are supposed to, if someone gets out of order in the church, or comes in here like a drunk, or somebody come in.

KINDNESS

Sympathize, considerate, generous, courteous. Exhibiting a friendly disposition by one's conduct. To a person or animal.

FRIENDLY

Having the qualities or disposition of a friend. Characteristics of or befitting a friend.

884-57 Like they shot that minister out of the platform the other night up there. You heard about that, that drunk coming in with a double-barreled shotgun. And he screamed for his wife, and--and wanted a...?... and went up towards the pastor. And the pastor showed him his wife setting there, but he was going to shoot her right in the church, and the pastor started to dealing with him. And instead of--instead of the... The man with the shotgun turned around and shot the pastor out of the pulpit, and then shot his wife, and then shot himself.

884-58 **Now, if there'd been a bunch of deacons there when that man entered that door with that shotgun, they'd have had their arms around him and the shotgun out of his hand. See? See, that's--that's orderly deacons. And now, these things have gone the way they're doing now, and you might just expect anything. But, remember, the deacons are God's policemen in the house of God, no matter what anybody else thinks. Sometimes a policeman want not to have to go up and make an arrest on somebody, maybe one of his friends, but he's sworn to an office; he's got to do it anyhow. That's his duty to his city. See?**

884-59 That's the duty of a deacon to the church. And if someone jumps up and starts interrupting the pastor, or something other like that, and the pastor in his message, the deacons supposed to walk up to them people, two or three of them, say, "Could we speak to you, brother?" See? Bring him from the church, out into the office, in here or some other office, and speak to him about it, saying, "You're not to interrupt." You know, it's a--it's a great fine by the law to interrupt a service anyhow. See? But some people, such as a delinquent person or something, come among you, you know, and--and some religious fanatic, and--and start carrying on, then the deacons... And if--and if the deacons don't seem to be able to control it, then the trustee board or anyone else in the church can step up and give help to such a person, you know, that...

DELINQUENT

To fail or be negligent in a duty, or obligation. Someone who fails in his duty or obligation.

RELIGIOUS FANATIC

Affected by false enthusiasm, by action, or the result of being possessed by a deity or demon

885-60 And--and now let me ask the question again here.

Is there any better way to keep order in the church than to remind the people with a repeat from the deacons, now, occasionally?

885-61 Now, I think that the--the pastor, ever so often... Or play this tape; let that stand for a witness. **Deacons are policemen, and their word is law and order.** See? And they have the authority from the church and even from the laws of the nation to make that house of God be the right place. And anyone to contrary a deacon like that, is subject to--to two to ten years in federal prison. If you tell them to go and they don't do it, or something like that, somebody with disorderly conduct, he just don't know what he's doing to... He's subjecting himself, allowing himself to all kinds of fines, anything.

DISORDERLY CONDUCT

Violating moral law, or constituted authority, or recognize law. Lawless; violating public order or morality.

885-62 And then if it comes to the spot that somebody... Now, like... And if somebody jumps up and gets disorderly... Just maybe speak in tongues or something, I wouldn't go in on that. See, let them go, 'cause that they're a stranger. If they're our own people, then just let... The next night, you deacons just get this tape, and say, "Now, we're going to play the order of the church before we start the service, I want everybody to understand it." And you pastors and you all can work together like that.

900-Q-231 **How far, Brother Branham, can or should a deacon go to keep order in the church? Should we keep the order or wait until Brother Neville tells us what we should do?**

900-128 That isn't Brother Neville's job; that's your job. See? You don't tell Brother Neville what to preach on, how to preach it. See, that's your job, you deacons; you're supposed to do that. You take care of that. That's nothing to Brother Neville that's your job. See?

900-129 Now, if a policeman's out here on the street and he sees a man stealing property out of a back of a car, should he call the mayor and say, "Now, Mayor, your Honor, sir, I am working for you here on this police force. Now, I find a man up the street here, he's--he was stealing some tires off of a car last night. Now, I just wonder, what's your opinion of that?" See? See, that wouldn't be sensible. Would it? No, sir, If he's doing something wrong, arrest him.

900-130 And if a man's doing something wrong here in the church, or anybody, stop them, talk to them. Don't be arrogant; but if they won't listen, speak in a way that they know what you're saying. See? See, like you tell a child, say, "Walk back there," and he's misbehaving. Deacons, stay at your place. Put... There's four of you; stay two in front and two in the back, on these corners or somewhere like that. **And watch real close for renegades and everything else come in like this. You see? And you be on the guard, and you get to your post of duty and stay there; that's your seat; or stand right beside a wall and watch everybody come in.**

ARROGANT

Making or implying unwarrantable claims to dignity, authority, or knowledge.

RENEGADE

An apostate from any form of religious faith, especially a Christian. One who deserts a party, person, or principle, in favor of another.

900-131 A deacon takes care of the house of God. Someone come in, speak to them; be there to greet them, shake their hand. That's... You're the policeman, "Could we show you the cloak room?" or "Would you be seated?" "Could we hand you a song book or something?" or "Now, we would like for you to enjoy yourself here, and--and pray, and--and we're happy you're here with us tonight." Lead them right down to a place, and say, "Would you like to be closer or would you like to be back here?" or wherever more. That's hospitality.

HOSPITALITY *The act on practice of being hospitable; the reception and entertainment of guests or strangers with liberality and goodwill*

COURT (1) *A court of Judicature of law or administration. An assembly of judges or other persons legally appointed and acting as a tribunal to hear and determine any cause*

COURT (2) *To pay courteous attention to, to pay amorous attention to, to woo; with a view to marriage.)*

COURTEOUS *Graciously attentive and respectful in treatment of others.*

901-132 A policeman (or the deacon) is a military police to the army, courtesy, but yet with authority. See? You know what a military police is, is actually, if he carries out his rights, I think he's just like a chaplain. You see? It's courtesy and everything, but yet he has an authority. See, you must mind him. See, he puts... These rookies get out there and get drunk, why, he puts them in their place. And so is the deacon to put them in their place.

901-133 **Now, remember, the deacon is a policeman, and a deacon's office is actually more strict than most any office in the church. I don't know of an office any more stricter than the deacon's office.** That's right. Because he's got a--he's got a real job, and he's God's man. **He's God's man just as much as the pastor's God's man. Certainly, he is. He's God's servant.**

901-134 Now the trustees, only thing, they're under duty by God to watch that finances and take care of that, the things that goes on like that. I told you about them tapes, and--and about other things here that goes on, about the building and repairs, and taking up the finances and things, that's--that's what they're trustee of: the property, finances, and things. The deacons has nothing to do in that. And neither does the--the trustee have anything to do with the deacons' office.

901-135 Now, if the deacons wants to ask the trustee's help on anything, or the--or the trustees the deacon's, and you're all working together... But that's your duties, is singling out. See? All right.

901-136 Now, no, don't ask Brother Neville. If Brother Neville asks you to do something, then that's--that's your pastor, with courtesy and love and everything... If he'd say, "Brother Collins, Brother Hickerson, Brother Tony, or somebody, would

you see what's wrong back there in the corner." At the post of duty like that, you know, as a real man of God.

901-137 Remember, you are not working for Branham Tabernacle, neither are you working for Brother Neville or me; you're working for Jesus Christ. See? You... That's who you do... And He--He's respecting your loyalty just the same as He is to that pastor or to anybody else; He's expecting your loyalty. And we want to show our loyalty.

902-138 Now, sometimes it gets hard. It's hard for me in the field. A minister setting there I love with all my heart, just have to really tell him (See?), but in a way of love, I've got a hand out to help him. So see? And they come to me and say, "Brother Branham, you're just a wonderful person, why can't you just compromise a little on that baptism, and on this, that, and the other, that security, and the serpent's seed?" I say, "Brother, I love you, but now, let's us take--just take the Scripture and see who's right or wrong. See, I've got to be able to..." "Oh, no. Now, Brother Branham, I tell you, you're all wrong." See, goes flying up. "Oh," I say, "well, perhaps I am. Then if I am, surely you'd tell me, you're... You know where I'm wrong at, then you show me where I'm wrong. And I'm willing to take. See?" Same thing, "Hey, you ain't got no business telling that child to set down." Now, the deacon is the--is the custodian at the house of God. See? Now, if you... He takes care of the house of God and keeps it in order. Now, that's what the Scripture says, and if you got anything else that a deacon should do, you come tell me. See, there's the same thing, but that--that's your duty to do that, yeah, just back up. And you should ask nobody; that's--that's just your duty. Brother Neville don't ask nobody; the church don't have to ask... I mean, the--the--the trustees don't have to go ask Brother Neville if--if he wants the roof put on the Tabernacle. See? No, no, that's not nothing to Brother Neville; it's not nothing to me; that's to you. The deacons don't have to...

902-144 The same way to the pastor. "What are you going to preach on? I don't want you to do this." They ain't got no business saying that; he's under God (See?), their pastor. And then if--if--if Brother Neville, he preaches a message that the Lord has give us, and we're all together in this. And if I tell Brother Neville something wrong, God holds me responsible for it. That's right. See? So God is the Boss of all of it. See? And we're just working as His ambassadors (You see?), down here in these offices.

903-Q-234 Please explain just how we are to--how we deacons can keep the people... just in the sanctuary before or after... Please explain. [Billy Paul reads the question to Brother Branham, "How do we keep the people quiet in the sanctuary before and after church?"--Ed.] Oh, all right.

I would suggest this, brethren. Now, there's a great thing; wish we had more time to put on it, for it's--it's... It means something to us. See? Now, the church is not a... If he wants to... If you want to run this tape down some night and play it before the meetings, that the people will understand it, let this be played; just this part of the tape if no more, just this. Any part of this that you want played for a certain thing, just keep running it till you find it, and then play it. See, 'cause it's questions. **Now, deacons of the church, and as I--as I said, are the police of the church. But the church is not a general meeting-house for--for fellowship, and friendship, and frolic. The church is a sanctuary of God. We come here... Now, if we want to meet one another, let me come to your house or you come to my house, or you go to one another's house and meet one another. But just to frolic around through the church, and talking and things like that, it's not right, brethren; we come here; we get the whole thing off of our mind. If we would come here...**

904-150 Look the way we used to do it years ago. Sister Gertie was the pianist. When I pastored here, I was--I had to be pastor, deacon, trustee, and everything else at once (See?), but I--I had to do it. Now you don't have to do it that way (See?), because you got men to carry this out. But when the... I had ushers, Brother Seward and all of them at the door. They had books piled around there at the door, setting in a chair, or something or another. And when someone come in, you showed them a place to hang your coat or helped them to their seat, give them a song book, and asked them to be in prayer. And then everybody set in their seat and silently prayed until starting time. See? And then at starting time, Sister Gertie, the pianist, got up there and started the music before--when the people are--are coming together. I would suggest to have your organist to get up there with some real nice music. And if she can't be here, put it on tape and then play it, or something another, and have music, real sweet sacred music going on. So... And ask people... **And if people goes to talking and carrying on like that, let one of the deacons get up at the microphone up there at the desk and say, "sh, sh, sh," like that. Say, "At the Tabernacle here we--we want you to come to worship. Let's not make noise now; listen to the music. Get your seat, set down, be reverent (See?), pray or**

read the Bible. This in the sanctuary here is where the Lord dwells. And we want everybody to be real reverent and worship, not to be running around, talking before the services. Congregate yourself, and you've come here to talk to the Lord. See? Either be in silent prayer (See?), or read your Bible."

905-152 When I went into the Marble church up there at--at the... Norman Vincent Peale, you've heard of him. You see? And I went into... A great psychology, he's a teacher, you know. And I went into his church, I just thought that, "I wished my Tabernacle would do that again." Them deacons standing right there at the door just as soon as you come in. They, of course, they hand you a Sunday school slip, taken you right down. You had to empty three times, you know, it only hold about four or five hundred, you know; and New York's a big place, and he's a popular man. And I think they had to have one class at ten o'clock and one at eleven, same sermon right over again, same service exactly, same sheet of paper. But when they dismissed, and they had (I believe) five minutes for the church to be exactly... Nobody else could come in till they got out, then the deacons opened the way and the other church filled up. They had those old box seats, you know, they go in like that, and set down in the pews where you open the door. And old fashion, it's been standing there for--for around two hundred years, I guess, the old Marble church has.

905-153 And you could have heard a pin drop anywhere in that church, and everybody in prayer for at least thirty minutes before the first note was ever hit on the organ, the prelude. And just everybody in prayer. I thought, "How wonderful it is." Then when that minister... That prelude, about... I think they played one prelude for about three to five minutes, How Great Thou Art, or something like that, and on like that. And then when they did, everybody stopped praying and was listening to the prelude. See, it give a change from prayer to the prelude. And then when they played that, then the choir leader directed the choir. Then they had a congregational song and the choir. And then they were ready for their Sunday school class. See? And then--and then when it was over, there was nothing went on except divine worship, all the time, and that's what we come there for.

905-154 And I think it would be a good thing if our church... And I'm just saying this; we're going to do it. See? Let's do it. If somebody does anything, the thing... And I think it'd be a good thing. If it's a good thing, then let's do it. See? We don't want to put off any good thing; we'll do it anyhow. See? And just go ahead and--and stand up there, and if they start on a morning, or something like that, people visiting, just let some or one--one of the one of the deacons, or somebody walk up there and say, "It's been made a rule in the Tabernacle here..." I don't know if they do it, they

may--they may. I'm never here (You see?); I don't know. I'm never here before services. And when they come in and they start talking, let somebody get up there and say, "Sh-sh-sh, just a moment." See? Let the--let the... Get a little sister, get her up there and get her playing that music. If you don't, put it on tape and get it out there (See?), of the organ music. And say, "Now, we're... **There's a new rule in the Tabernacle. When people enter here, we're not to whisper or talk, but to worship. See?** Now, just a few minutes the service will be starting. Until then, just either read your Bible or bow your head and silently pray." And a few times like that, they'll all learn. See, see?

906-157 You hear somebody talking, and then it gets down for--after a few times like that, after a while you hit a place where somebody say... See somebody talking, nobody else talking (You see?), well, then one of the deacons walk up and say, "We--we want you to worship during the time of the service (You see?)?" See? See, it's not a house of talk, it's a house of worship. Understand? **I think that was it: Please explain... (Yeah. Let's see. Yeah)... Please explain how to... the deacons should... in the sanctuary. Yeah, that's all. That's right. That's it.**

911-177 Now I say this, say if your services begin at seven-thirty, if that's the time, open your church half hour beforehand, seven o'clock. Let the pianist... Tell the organist... You pay her? You all pay the organist? Is she paid, or the pianist? She does it free-will. Ask her with gentleness. Even if she wants to have pay for it, to give her something for it, tell her we want her a half hour before service. And if she says, "Well, I can't do it," or something, complaint, then just have her come here and make a tape of some sweet organ music. You see? And let... put that on the... Don't have to be here every time, set your tape up. See? Let one of the deacons, trustees, or ever who opens, the janitor, put it on up there, the tape on, and let it be playing while the people come. See? 'Cause if the deacons are not here, or somebody, let a trustee or somebody be here to do it, then let them play for a half hour. But exactly seven-thirty, let that bell toll on top the building. See? You still have your bell out there? Yeah. All right, let your bell toll at seven-thirty, and that means that we're not going to walk up and down the church and shake hands with Joneses and all that. Let the song leader be on the job. If there's no song leader there, let the deacons see that there--or the--see that there is somebody to start leading songs when that bell starts tolling. "Turn to your hymn-book, number so-and-so." See? Let it be right on the dot at--at seven-thirty.

889-Q-228 043 Now, on the next one, is:

228. Brother Branham, in respect to the order of the

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church we have tried to go accordingly to the way we understand the orders given in the dedication of the new church. And by doing so, some have gotten mad and left the church. And others will not listen to anything we say, especially the children. We have talked to the parents about their children, and they won't take care of them. Now, have we misunderstood? Or, are we going about it in the wrong way? Thanks.

889-78 Now, let me answer this as they come down:

In respect to the order of the church, we have tried to go accordingly to the way we understood it given in the dedication of the new church.

Now, that's correct; you're doing right. Now, this is supposed to be deacons, I suppose, 'cause it's right here at the deacon's job. All right.

And by doing so, we have often... people has often gotten mad at us.

889-79 They do at me too! They'll do it any man. See? A person that does that, there's something wrong with that person. They're not right with God, for the Spirit of Christ is subject to Christ's teaching, Christ's house, Christ's order. See? And any man that, or any woman, or any persons, children, that would get angry with a godly deacon, that would tell them to be... And, or any parent would get angry with a deacon... Really, we want everybody in this church that we can get; but if that would only cause trouble somewhere else, there's a thorn or, "a rabbit in the woodpile," as we used to say it. That person isn't right.

890-80 If they leave, there's only one thing to do: let them go, and pray for them. See? Then maybe some of the deacons go to their church--or go to their house sometime, and find out why they left, and ask them what was wrong. Then, and if they... See if you can reconcile them. If you can't, then take two or three witnesses with him, that they might be understood. Then if they can't be understood, then it's told before the church if they are a member here of the church. Then they are...

890-81 And then if they're not members of the church, 'course they're not members

of this congregation, they should be made to be ruly. See, they--they've got to listen to our orders here, because this is the orders of the church. **This is things we don't want to do, things that I don't like to do, but it's things that must be doing. And I'm exposing myself and telling here by this tape; it's me;** they can hear me talking and know that it's me, not you men. You've asked me these questions, and I'm giving it to you the best that I know how from the Word of God.

890-82 "Now, if those people get angry and go out from you, what does the Scripture say about it, Brother Branham?"

890-83 "They went out from us because they wasn't of us." That settles it. "Left the church," that's what they did. All right.

890-84 Others will not listen to anything we say, especially the children.

The children are supposed to know discipline; they should get it at home. But even if it's mine, my kids get in here at anytime, they get disorderly, I don't want you to draw one string; Sarah, Rebekah, Joseph, Billy, or whoever it might be. You tell me; I'll see to it. If they can't behave, then they'll stay away from church till they do learn to behave. This is not an arena; this is a house of God. This is not a place to play, and skate, and write notes, and laugh, and cut up; this is the house of God, and is to be carried out godly.

890-85 You come here to worship, not even to visit. This is not a--this is not a picnic ground; this is not a visitation place; this is the visitation place of the Holy Spirit, listen to what He has to say, not to one another. We don't come here to--to fellowship with one another; we come here to fellowship with Christ. This is the house of worship. And children must be disciplined, and if they are of their parents. Let it be known, that if these deacons... If these parents of the children will not listen to what these deacons said, then this parent should be corrected themselves.

891-86 We have talked to the parents about their children, and they won't take care of them.

If they are members of this church, then you should take two or three with you and call that parent into a private meeting, into one of the offices. I don't care who it is, if it's me, if it's Brother Neville, if it's Billy Paul and his little boy, if it's Brother Collins

and one of his children, or any of the rest of you. We're... We love one another, but we're duty bound to God and this Word. If it's Doc, no matter who it is, we're to call one another in and be honest with one another. How can God ever deal with us, if we're not honest with one another? How we going to be honest with Him? See?

891-87 **This is an order; we must keep the house of God. And deacons are supposed to know how to do that. See? And that's why I'm telling you now to keep them things caught up.** And if this, you tell the parents and they won't listen to this--won't listen to it, then you get you another deacon or one of the trustees, or some good person of this church, and call--take your trus... Take your deacon board, all your deacons together, say, "Brother Jones, Brother Henderson, Brother Jackson," or whoever it might be, "their children are dis-behaving, and we've told them two or three times about their children and they won't listen."

891-88 Then call Brother Jones in, or Brother Whoever-it-is, and say, "Brother Jones, we've called you in here for a meeting. We love you, and we... You're a part of us; you're one of us. Let me just set this certain tape and listen what Brother Branham said about it. See? Now, we've asked you to make those children behave. See? If they won't behave, and you can't make them behave in church, leave them with someone while you come to church until they learn how to behave themself in the house of God." See? But this is an order; it's got to be carried out. See?

892-89 Now the other question goes on:

Now, have we misunderstood?

No, sir. You haven't misunderstood; that's correct. I'm saying it again, the orders. In the army they don't ask you, "Will you go do a certain thing?" If you're in the army, you're compelled to do it. See? And that's the way it is in the... I'm compelled to preach the Gospel. I'm compelled to stand for this regardless of what my other men and brethren and so forth say about it; I'm compelled to do this. I have to hurt feelings and cut men to pieces, but if I...

892-90 You don't want to get like Oswald. See? If you can't disagree with a man and things, then shake his hand and still have the same feelings towards him, then there's something wrong with you. **If I can't disagree with a man, bitterly, from one side to the other, and still think as much of him as--as Christ would, then there's something wrong with my spirit; I haven't the Spirit of Christ. See?**

892-91 If he says, "Well, Brother Branham, I--I believe that your teaching is this,

that."

892-92 "All right, Brother, let's come together to reason, you and I. We'll take it ourselves. We'll go over here in the room to ourself; we'll reason it out." And he just cuts me to pieces, and I have to say things back to him. If in my heart I can't feel the same about him, that he's still my Brother and I'm trying to help him, then I'll never help him; there's no way for me to help him. If I don't love him, what's the use in going over there? Tell him, "The first place first, brother, I don't love you, and let me get that out of my heart right here before we go in there, because I can't help you until I love you."

892-93 And that's right, and that's the way. See, carry it on; you've done it exactly right; that's the way it should be. You never misunderstood it.

892-94 **Are we going about it the wrong way?**

No, it is the right way to carry that. Let order be kept. Because it's constantly... Now, little children and mothers, little babies and things, they--they'll cry, and if they get crying too much and interrupting your pastor up there, remember, you are his bodyguards; you're his Gospel bodyguards. See? And if it's interrupting the message of the Lord, then you are deacons, what are you to do? Just like a man speaking in tongues, he's duty bound. And a man preaching, he's duty bound to the Word, he's duty bound to these things. Each one of you is duty bound to an office, and that's--and that's just what we're--we're here to do.

893-95 Now, we don't want to wait too long, and I know I got an appointment in a few minutes, so I'll--I'll just try to hurry as quick as I can.

893-Q-229 Brother Branham... There's three, two questions on this card here. Brother Branham, what should be the policy of taking up offerings in the church for people? How should this be done?

I think taking up offerings in the church for people should not be done unless it's for your pastor. And I think if someone comes in for charity, or something like that that... Or someone in--in bad need, like one of our members here or congregation, say if one of our brothers, and they had some trouble; well, I think then that should be announced at the platform, and let the pastor do that, I think it's his duty to do that; some brother that's in need of something, let him present it to the church, if it wants

to be taken that way. If it's someone in need and--and then you don't want to take the offering up for the person that's in need, then let the boards meet together and agree upon certain sums that they want to give to this person out of the treasury. But if the treasury's low at that time and they can't afford to do it, then it has to be taken up, well, let--let the--let it be talked with the board, giving orders to the pastor, and let the pastor ask for this certain thing. Say, "Now, tonight, our Brother Jones, he had a--a horrible accident, his house burned down. And tonight, as Christians, we're going together, to each one of us make a pledge of what we can do to help Brother Jones back with his house again." See, or--or whatever it is. See, we--we do that. Let that be said from the platform, that's the way to do that. And then let the pledges be give in, and then give it over to the treasurer of the church. And these pledges be paid through the treasurer of the church, and give to them. And--and give the person a receipt for it, 'cause I don't know whether that's tax redemption or not; I guess it is for something like that.

894-98 Now, but when it comes to like a--a stranger come in, a stranger come in like he's... A man comes in and says, "Well, you know what? I--I--I'm on a journey, and I--I blew out a tire, and I want a new tire. Take me up an offering tonight for a new tire." Now, that shouldn't be done. No, that should not be done. And if it seems to--if it seems to be a worthy thing, of somebody that you know, the board could meet and designate a certain amount of money from the treasurer to buy that man a tire or whatever it was. Or either if the church treasury is low, and it's decided by the board that these... The pastor shouldn't have nothing to do in this, the--the deacons is supposed to do this (See?), or the boards. And now if this... If it's agreed, then give to the pastor, the pastor can take the offering. But, notice, if it's a stranger, and it's in an emergency, a fellow needs a little money and you feel that it's for a just cause (now this is my opinion), if it's for a real just cause and you know it is for a just cause...

894-99 Now, first, if you go up there and look on my books at the house of people coming by and say, "I'm Reverend So-and-so from this certain-certain church, and I--I had some trouble down the road here, and I--I need a set of tires," and knowed that I just come in from the meeting and had an offering, or something another like that, I'd give it to him nearly to go get a set of tires. And look in the minutes, there never was such a minister as that, never lived in such a place. And there is ten or twenty thousand dollars on the books from these years that I've give out like that, never know nothing about them where they was. Come to find out, other ministers say, "Why, he made me for so-and-so and so-and-such. Now, the church is not responsible, only for their own. That's right. Their own, they're responsible.

894-101 But if there seems to be a worthy cause, and then if you--if you trustees might say, "Well now, wait a minute. This man, there he is, his car down there, that's his did happen, and this. It's not of our congregation (See?), but it is." Then if they want to do it like that, and would say something special about an outsider... Not our own, now (See?), not our own people, our own people be taken up right here amongst their--their own, their brothers here. See? But if it's somebody on the outside, and a fellow says he's hungry or--and somebody wants to reach down in his pocket and give him some charity, that's up to you; but I'm talking about from the church. And then if the church people are asked to donate, then...

895-104 Now, if you got an evangelist, of course, in here preaching, then you take... you... That's understood before he comes, you know, that you'll give him an offering, or pay him salary, or whatever he wants to do. But then if this person is here, and it's for a just cause, and the pastor, and the board would want to agree and tell the pastor upon it, then let the pastor say, "A certain-certain person is setting here; we don't know the man; he come in and he asked us for... He says his children are hungry. We haven't got the time... We haven't had the time to investigate the--the--the--the--the claim." See?

895-106 If there's anything like that, then our--our... If there's anything among our own, our--our own deacons go investigate those claims. See? And then if it's worthy, then do it. If it isn't worthy, don't do it: don't have to. But now if it's a man here, you--you--you let the pastor say, "Now, the trustee board told me they did not know this person. But the man is setting here; he says his name is Jim Jones," or whatever it might be, "and he's setting right here. Would you stand up, Mr. Jones? Now, Mr. Jones, at the end of the service, you stand just at the back door there, as you go out. And if any people feel in your heart, or anything that you want to do for this man, give it to him as you go out." Is that understood now? Did you get that on your... To those who are on the tape... And one of the... Brother Collins missed it on his tape. I want to reinstate that quotation again if... 'cause he's one of the deacons.

895-108 If--if there be any of the--one man comes in that you--and is in emergency, and he wants an offering from the church, let the trustees or deacons meet together, and let the--meet together, and make this decision, then tell the pastor that it might be done like this. Let them... Let the pastor say that this certain man, call him by name, "we know him not. And our policy here is to--to investigate before we take offerings for people, and, that is, of our own. But this man here, he says he's broke down; he's had an emergency; he's got sick children; he's trying to get medicine for his children," or whatever it might be, the emergency. "Now, he's standing right

here, Would you stand up, sir?" See, and let him stand up. And say, "Now you people see what--who he is. Now, at the close of this service this man shall stand there at the front door, and people going out, that feel that you want to contribute to this, you're at liberty; we only announced it in the church." You're not sanctioning it; you're only announcing it. See, that's hospitality to a stranger. See? Understand now? All right. I think that settles that question.

876-23 Now, on this, as **I have noticed your church growing, and noticed it.** And in the church, here's the way we had it first, and this is the way we--we want it again. Now, if you don't watch, when babies... The first thing a baby does is try to talk when he can't talk. See? He makes a lot of bubble, and noise, and--and so forth, but he thinks he's just--he can out-talk the preacher at that time. Well, we find that not only in the natural life, but we find that in the spiritual life also. It's a little one. And if you try to correct that baby and spank him a little bit because he's "gooing" and trying to talk, you'll ruin the child (See?) and you'll hurt him. And it's best to let that baby grow a little while until he actually can speak his words right, and then tell him when. Not when papa's talking or when mama's talking. But when it's appropriate time, let him have his say. Do you understand me? Now, let him talk when his time comes to talk.

876-25 Now, if I've ever had anything that's been a thorn in my flesh out in the meeting, it's someone to rise up when I'm speaking and then give a message in tongues and break the Spirit. I just come out of a meeting in New York and different places to where ministers let that go on time after time, and it's nothing but--but a confusion. See, when God is dealing in one line of thought, He... It would be--it would... He would be defeating His own purpose, if He's trying to get a line of thought to you, to the congregation, to make an altar call and something butt in. For instance, like this. We're setting at the table, talking, and we're talking about the Lord. And junior runs in to the table real quick, takes all the attention away from what we're doing, and he hollers, scream out, "Dad, mom. My, my. I just hit a home run down at the team. And we done all this, that, and the other." And when we were right on a real right-down sacred subject... Now, him hitting a home run, that's all right. At the baseball game, that's all right. But he's out of order when he breaks in on the message that we're talking about. Let him wait till his time comes and then tell us what he did at the baseball game.

877-27 Now, that's just the same thing we find with gifts today. That's the reason God cannot trust too many spiritual gifts with people; they don't know how to control them. That's what's the matter today, the reason we don't have no more than we do.

And we do find there's a lot of impersonation of spiritual gifts. But I don't believe that's so here in our church. I'm thankful for that. I don't believe it's an impersonation at all. I believe we have genuine gifts, but we must know how to control those gifts.

877-29 And then when you go to doing something good... Just like you was working for a boss and you started out on the first of your job and you're willing to take orders, then the boss has confidence in you and he will keep raising you up to a higher office all the time. Now, I believe that time has struck the Branham Tabernacle, to know what--to take the gifts that God gives us, that God can trust us with something even greater than what we have got. But we cannot go along... And you see a man that's always have to be telling him and everything... And remember, "The spirit of the prophets is subject to the prophet," says the Scripture. When you see a man that you have to correct, or a woman, and that person gets out of order, and then you're telling him the Scriptural truth, then it shows that the spirit that's on them isn't of God. Because the Bible said, "The spirit of the prophets," or, "prophesying," that's, testifying, preaching, speaking in tongues, or whatever it is, 'cause tongues interpreted is prophecy. So it's subject to the prophet, and the Word is the Prophet. So we--we see that it's out of order for a man or a woman to jump up and give a message, no matter how much they want to do it, while the preacher is in the pulpit.

QUESTIONS & ANSWERS by William Marrion Branham January 12, 1961

584-Q-127 **How should a brother be condemned whose weakness is to take a place in church without being asked to do so?**

Oh, my. Well, suffer with him, I guess. See? How should a brother be condemned... He shouldn't be condemned... whose--whose weakness is to take place in a church without being asked to do so? For instance, if he wanted to--to be a deacon (See?), and he's not asked to do so, yet he wants to be a deacon anyhow. See? Well, if a person's like that, you know there's a little something, you know, weak somewhere anyhow, and so I'd just kind of deal with him in love. And 'course, you never want to--to do a thing like that unless you really know. Put your very best men you can on your board (You see?) like that. Brother, don't never get nothing in there that's... **Test that man, first. A deacon's got more responsibility than the pastor has. He's to be blameless, a deacon is. See?**

A PLACE OF WORSHIP, HOLY, CONSECRATED

GOD IN SIMPLICITY

by William Marrion Branham

March 17, 1963

4-4 So now, now in the building I think that we ought to have in this, if it's been dedicated (or going to be dedicated in a few minutes to the worship of God), we should keep it that way. We should never buy or sell in the building. We should never do any business in this auditorium here; it should never be done in here. That is, such as permitting ministers to come in and sell books and everything. No matter what it is, there's other places to do that...?... We--we shouldn't buy and sell in the house of our Lord. It should be a place of--of worship, holy, consecrated for that purpose. See? Now, He's give us a nice place; let's dedicate it to Him and dedicate ourselves with it to Him.

5-1 And now, this may seem a little rude, but it's not a place to visit; it's a place of worship. We should never even murmur a word inside of here, outside of worship, to one another unless it's absolutely necessary. See? We should never rally around; we should never run through the building or let our children run through the building. And so doing this, feeling not long ago that--of doing this, we constructed it so we could take care of all of it. Now, we have this set here... 'Course many people are strangers. The Tabernacle folks know this, that the building is going to be dedicated to the service of the Almighty.

5-3 Therefore, dedicating ourselves, let's remember when we enter that sanctuary, keep still to one another and worship God. If we want to visit each other, there's places we may visit each other like that but never walking around where you can't hear yourself think, and some person come in, and they just don't know what to do. See? It's so much noise and things, it's just humanly... And I've seen it in churches until it has made me feel real bad, because we do not come into the sanctuary of the Lord to meet each other; we come here to worship God, then go to our homes. This sanctuary's dedicated to worship. When... Stand outside; talk anything you wish to as long as it's right and holy; go to one another's homes; visit one another in places; but when you enter that door, be quiet. You come here to talk to Him (See?) and let Him talk back to you. The trouble of it is, we do too much talking and don't listen enough. Then when we come in here, wait on Him.

5-6 Now, in the old Tabernacle, there might not be one person present this morning that was there the day of the dedication, when Major Ulrich played the

music, and I stood behind three crosses here to dedicate the place. I would not permit anybody... The ushers stood at the door to see that nobody talked. When you done your talking outside, you come in. If you desired to, silently you come to the altar and prayed silently. You walked back to your seat, opened up the Bible. What your neighbor done, that was up to him. You had nothing to say. If you want to talk to him, say, "I'll see him outside. I'm in here to worship the Lord." You read His Word or set quietly.

6-1 And then the music--Sister Gertie, I don't know whether she's here this morning or not, Sister Gibbs. The old piano, I believe, set back in this corner the best of my remembrance. And she would play softly, "Down at the cross where my Saviour died," some real sweet soft music, and--and then until it come time for the service, and the song leader got up and led a couple of congregational songs, and then if they had some outstanding solo, they sang it, but never just a bunch of carrying on. And then the music continually played, and then when I heard that, I knowed it was my time to come out. When a minister walks into a congregation of people praying in the anointing of the Spirit, you're bound to hear from heaven. That's just all. There's no way to keep from it. But if you walk into confusion, then you--you're--you're so confused, the Spirit's grieved. And...We don't want that, no. We want to come here to worship. We have lovely homes that I'm going to speak about just in a minute and so forth at home, where we visit our friends and take them. This is the house of the Lord.

6-4 Now, there's little children, now, little babies. Now, they don't know no different. They... The only way they can get what they want is cry for it. And sometimes it's a drink of water, and sometimes they need attention. And so we have by the grace of God dedicated a room; it was called on the list a "cry room," but it's right straight in front of me. It's, other words, where the mothers can take their baby. Now, it's never bothers maybe me here at the pulpit; maybe I won't even notice it, being anointed, but there's other people setting near, and it bothers them. See? And they come here to hear the service. So the mothers, if your little baby starts whimpering, you can't help that. Why, sure it's a... You should, you ought to bring it. A real mother wants to take her baby to church, and that's the thing you should do. And we've got a room there to where you can see every corner of the building, all the auditorium, and a speaker there to where you can control the volume any way you want to, with a--a little toilet in the end, and water basin, and everything just exactly for the mother's convenience. With chairs and things you can set down, a place to change your baby if it needs to be changed and everything setting there. It's all fixed.

7-1 And then, many times teen-age children and sometimes adults will get to, you know, young people will pass notes or cut up or something in church. Now, you're old enough to know better than that. See? You should know better than that. See? You shouldn't come here... If you expect to be a real man someday and raise a family to the Kingdom of God, then start it off in the beginning (You see?), and--and act right and do right. And now, 'course... Now, the ushers stands at the corners of the buildings and so forth and if any carrying on, they are--they're ordained as their duty (and trustees set here in the front) that in a case of someone getting misbehaving, they are--are commissioned to ask the person to keep quiet.

7-3 Then if they don't have that respect, it would be better that someone else had the seat, because there's somebody that wants to hear. There's somebody come for that purpose to hear and that's what we're here for, is to hear the Word of the Lord. And so everybody wants to hear, and we want it just as quiet as they can be--just as quiet as they can be. That is, not a bunch of talking and carrying on. Of course, somebody worshipping the Lord; that's expected. That's what it should be; that's what you're here for, is to worship the Lord. And just if you feel like praising God or shouting, just go right on (See?), 'cause that's what you're here for (See?), but--is to worship the Lord in your own way of worshipping. But there's nobody worships the Lord while you're talking and passing notes, and you're helping somebody else to get away from the worship of the Lord. See?

7-5 So we feel that that would be wrong, and we want to make that a ruling in our church, that in--in our congregation, that to this building, this church will be dedicated to the Kingdom of God and to the preaching of the Word. Pray; worship; that's the reason you should come here, to worship. Then... And then another thing, when service is over usually the people in churches... I don't--I don't think it's here 'cause I'm always gone (See?), 'cause I get away usually even in preaching other services, the anointing comes, and visions happen, and I'm wore out, and I step off into the room, and maybe Billy or some of the men there take me on to home and let me rest awhile till I get out of it, 'cause it's a very much of a strain. And then, I have seen churches though, to where the children were permitted to run all over the sanctuary, and--and the adults stand and holler across the room to one another. That's a good way to ruin the service coming that night or whatever time it is, See?

8-2 As soon as the service is dismissed leave the auditorium. You're through in the worship then. Then go out and talk to one another and whatever you want to do. If you've got something you want to talk to somebody, to see them, why, you go with them or to their home or whatever it is, but don't do it in the auditorium. Let's

dedicate this to God. See? This is His meeting place where we meet with Him. See? And the law goes forth from the sanctuary, of course. And I--I believe that that would be pleasing to our heavenly Father.

8-3 And then when you come and you get to find out that gifts are beginning to fall among you... Now, usually it... I'll trust it'll never be here. But when people have a new church, the first thing you know, the congregation begin to get starchy. You never want that to be. After all, this is a place of worship. This is the house of the Lord. And if spiritual gifts begin to come among you... I understand that since I've been gone that people have moved in here from different parts of the country to make this their home. I'm thankful, grateful to God that I believe that the morning when I dedicated and laid that cornerstone there as a young man, I prayed for its standing to see the coming of Jesus Christ. And when I did, owing thousands of dollars--and they... You could take up an offering in a congregation of this size and get thirty or forty cents, and our obligation was somewhat a hundred an fifty, two hundred dollars a month. How could I ever do it? And I knowed that I was working, and I would pay it off. I... Seventeen years of pastoral without taking one cent, but giving everything that I had myself, outside of my living, and all that come into the little box on the back to the Kingdom of God... And people prophesied and predicted that within a year's time, it would be turned into a garage.

9-1 Satan tried to take it away from us one time in a flaw, in a fraud of a lawsuit: some man claimed he hurt his foot while he was working on it, and then let it go, and then--and he sued and wanted to take the Tabernacle. And for weeks I stood at the post, but in spite of all the misunderstandings and the predictions and what they said, she stands today as one of the prettiest auditoriums and the finest churches there is in the United States. That's right.

9-2 From here has went the Word of the living God around the world (See?), around the world, and it's constantly taken its circle around the globe from every nation under heaven as far as we know, around and around the world. Let us be thankful for this. Let us be grateful for this. And now that we have a place to dwell in, a roof under our heads, a clean nice church to set in; let's dedicate ourselves newly to the task and consecrate ourselves to Christ. And...

9-3 Brother Neville, our noble brother and real pastor, servant of the living God, as far as that man knows the message, he holds with it with all he's got. That's right. He's a gentle person; he's a little afraid to--or not afraid, I don't mean that, but he's so--so awful gentle; he just will--doesn't speak out. You know, like to--to say a thing

that's sharp and cutting or "set down," or "keep still." I--I've noticed that and listened to the tapes behind it. But it so happens that I can do that, so I--I--I want you to remember my words. You see? And this is all being taped (See?); everything is taped. And please let every deacon stand to his post of duty and remember that you're under a commission from God to hold that post sacred (See?), every trustee the same.

9-5 Pastor is to bring forth... It isn't the pastor's place to have to say that; it's the trustees--or I mean the deacons, for they are the police of the church. That is, if young couples come on the outside and blow horns, and you know how they usually do, or something like that at meetings or--or get out there... And mother sends her girl down here, and she takes off out with some renegade kid and runs out there in the car, and her mother thinks she's in church like that, the deacon ought to see to that. "You either come in here and set down, or I'm going to take you in my car and take you home to your mother." See? You--you must do that.

10-1 Remember, love is corrective (See?), always. Genuine love is corrective. So you must be able to stand the correction. And mothers know now that there's a place there for your babies. You young kids know different than to run around over the building. See? And you adults know different than to talk and carry on your conversations in the auditorium. See? Don't do that; it's wrong. It isn't pleasing to God. Jesus said, "It is written: My house shall be made a house of worship, prayer, called the house of prayer by all nations." And they were buying and selling, and He plaited ropes and ran the people out of the auditorium. And we certainly don't want that to happen in this sanctuary here. So let's dedicate our lives, our church, our tasks, our service, and everything we have to the Kingdom of God.

FASTING

1. To abstain from food. **2.** To eat very little or abstain from certain foods, especially as a religious discipline. --**fast** *n.* **1.** The act or practice of abstaining from or eating very little food. **2.** A period of such abstention or self-denial. [Middle English *fasten*, from Old English *fæstan*. See **past**-below.] *American Heritage Dictionary*

FAST, FASTING - going without food or drink voluntarily, generally for religious purposes. Fasting, however, could also be done for other reasons. It was sometimes done as a sign of distress, grief, or repentance. The law of Moses specifically required fasting for only one occasion-the DAY OF ATONEMENT. This custom resulted in calling this day "the day of fasting" (Jer. 36:6) or "the Fast" (Acts 27:9).

Moses did not eat bread or drink water during the 40 days and 40 nights he was on Mount Sinai receiving the law (Ex. 34:28). Voluntary group fasts (not specified in the law) were engaged in during time of war, such as when the Benjamites defeated the other Israelites (Judg. 20:26), and when Samuel gathered the people to Mizpah during the Philistine wars (1 Sam. 7:6). It was at a called fast that witnesses accused Naboth, setting the stage for his death (1 Kin. 21:9, 12).

Jehoshaphat called for a fast in all Israel when opposed by the Moabites and Ammonites (2 Chr. 20:3). Reacting to Jonah's preaching, the men of Nineveh, at the king's order, fasted and put on sackcloth (Jon. 3:5). Those about to return with Ezra from the Captivity fasted at the river of Ahava because of the dangers faced on the journey (Ezra 8:21, 23). Esther and the Jews of Shushan (or Susa) fasted when faced with the destruction planned by Haman (Esth. 4:3, 16; 9:31).

In times of grief, people fasted. A seven-day fast was held when the bones of Saul and his sons were buried (1 Sam. 31:13; 1 Chr. 10:12). Fasting was practiced during the 70 years of the exilic period on the fifth and the seventh months, the date the siege of Jerusalem began and the date when Jerusalem fell to the Babylonians (Zech. 7:5).

Fasting was practiced by individuals in times of distress. David fasted after hearing that Saul and Jonathan were dead (2 Sam. 1:12). Nehemiah fasted and prayed upon learning that Jerusalem had remained in ruins since its destruction (Neh. 1:4). Darius, the king of Persia, fasted all night after placing Daniel in the lions' den (Dan. 6:18).

Going without food or water was not automatically effective in accomplishing the desires of those who fasted. In the prophet Isaiah's time, people complained that they had fasted and that God had not responded favorably (Is. 58:3-4). The prophet declared that the external show was futile. The fast that the Lord requires is to loose the bonds of wickedness, undo the heavy burdens, feed the hungry, shelter the poor, and clothe the naked (Is. 58:5-7).

Fasting also occurs in the New Testament. Anna at the Temple "served God with fastings and prayers night and day" (Luke 2:37). John the Baptist led his disciples to fast (Mark 2:18). Jesus fasted 40 days and 40 nights before His temptation (Matt. 4:2). Using a marriage-feast comparison, however, Jesus insisted that fasting was not suitable for His disciples as long as He, the Bridegroom, was with them (Matt. 9:14-15; Mark 2:18-20; Luke 5:33-35).

Cornelius was fasting at the time of his vision (Acts 10:30). The church in Antioch fasted (Acts 13:2) and sent Paul and Barnabas off on the first missionary journey with fasting and prayer (Acts 13:3). Paul and Barnabas prayed with fasting at the appointment of elders in the churches (Acts 14:23). Paul suggested that husbands and wives might abstain from sexual intercourse for a while to give themselves to fasting and prayer (1 Cor. 7:5). Ronald F. Youngblood, general editor; F.F. Bruce and R.K. Harrison, consulting editors, *Nelson's new illustrated Bible dictionary: An authoritative one-volume reference work on the Bible with full color illustrations [computer file], electronic edition of the revised edition of Nelson's illustrated Bible dictionary, Logos Library System, (Nashville: Thomas Nelson) 1997, c1995.*

Matthew 6:1-18 Jesus gave three areas in the practice of righteousness, wherein the Pharisees, by overt display, perverted true worship and turned it into an effort to gain public approval: (1) almsgiving (vv. 2-4), (2) prayer (vv. 5-15), and (3) fasting (vv. 16-18). Verse 1 states the general principle regarding the motive of righteousness, which is then developed by these three examples. Motives that underlie deeds or words give to them their true moral quality. W.A. Criswell, *Believer's study Bible [computer file], electronic ed., Logos Library System, (Nashville: Thomas Nelson) 1997, c1991 by the Criswell Center for Biblical Studies.*

BE NOT AFRAID

by William Marrion Branham

June 9, 1960

E-14 Someone said to me (I believe it was last evening) said, "Brother Branham, where does this come from? How are you able to go meeting after meeting, staying under the anointing, and... Even one sign made Jesus weak when the woman touched His garment." Said, "I see you stand for a hour under that." I said, "I'd like to tell you. Here's where it lays: he don't want me to say this, but my brother setting here, Gene Goad, that boy don't touch bread or water for days, fasting and praying. Here sets Pat Tyler, this other brother setting here by him. Them men lay on their faces without food and water when I'm in a meeting, praying for me. That's where it comes from. If there wasn't something like that, I'd go down." That's the men behind the curtain. The man who prays for strength for a message, that they lay down everything. Maybe they haven't got the gifts to do those things, but they're putting every effort they can to support it. And the only way they can do it they know, is prayer before God and fasting. There's where power lays: let someone pray for you.

ATTITUDE AND WHO IS GOD? by William Marrion Branham August 8, 1950

E-10 The nights grow on. Of course, I tire, and tire more. It is a truth that I believe, as a physical man tears down, the spiritual man has a chance. That's what fasting and things are for. He can have a chance to work upon these five senses of ours, to bring us to believe and have faith in Him. I like the attitude of this centurion tonight, that we've just read of. He--he was a man that felt unworthy. As long as you're feeling unworthy of the blessing you're asking, you're pretty apt to get it. But when you get to a place where you think that God just owes it to you, that's when you're--you're mistaken. We're in debt to God, not God in debt to us. We're indebted to God.

ENTICING SPIRITS by William Marrion Branham

July 24, 1955

111f There's nothing in the Word tells you to have a forty day fast, not a thing. Nothing in the world telling you to fast 'less God would tell you. And if you fast, you ain't going to get hungry and go all these things. After your fasting, brother, you'll be joy and happy all the time. Said, "Don't appear before men like hypocrites do with a long sad face. I'm on a forty day fast; my plates won't fit me anymore. I've lost thirty pounds, and they told me I looked better after this is over." Oh, nonsense. It's enticing spirits of the devil.

INTER VEIL

by William Marrion Branham

January 21, 1956

E-26 Christianity is not something, God's not One you have to beg, and cry, and plead, and fast, and starve, and everything like that to get to. Certainly not. I'm not degrading a fast. But here not long ago, a man wrote a book on fasting. My, women come into the meeting, and men, who'd went on those fasts that were insane. They went just because the book said to fast forty days. Some of them with false plates, and their teeth would drop out. And their eyes would sink back. And mothers-to-be to... women to be mothers, their little ones as you understand, they would completely go mentally out, and be taken to the institutions. Many, many of them, come in that condition. I believe in fasting. Certainly. But when you fast, you don't hunger. Jesus after He had got through fasting, the Bible said, He was hungry. God puts a fast on you. You don't put it on yourself. He certainly captured the women, the man did that wrote the book, when he said, put a picture of a woman there, she looked twenty years younger, said, after the fast. You ought to seen her then, just about a year later what she looked like, after that. See? Certainly. You don't do that. You don't do things by works. It's by grace. God in sovereign grace...

RESURRECTION OF LAZARUS by William Marrion Branham August 13, 1950

E-5 And many times that way, I hold myself on the gift. Now, it's not around me now, 'cause I haven't been praying. I got up, had just a little bite of breakfast, and I won't eat any more, probably, till after the services, and so forth. I have to keep empty. If you're--if you keep stomach empty, the blood is at your brain, and you must be ready. And if you're all full when you're... That's the power of fasting. When you're--when you're full, the blood goes into your stomach to digest your food. You see? And then when you're empty, it's in your--in your brain. So you can be just... 'Cause them two spirit is so close it could deceive the very elect, if possible. And

many pe--many times you hear It cry. I've heard people shout. Now, as I told you, I hope I--God that has let me find favor with you that you believe me. I've heard people shout when it wasn't God. I've heard people cry when it wasn't God. See? And their sympathy sometimes, the devil wants to be petted. And it--it takes a real sheep raiser to know the difference between the bleat of a goat and a lamb; they're so close together. You see? And so therefore, on this platform, you must be very careful. Can be just one thing is all that Satan wants to--wants to throw out before the public. So therefore, I have to be fasting, prayerful, every minute on the guard, watching for something.

NOTES

TWO OPINIONS

At Kadesh Barnea

by William Marrion Branham

May 27, 1956

E-62 You've got a decision to make. Your Kadesh, you see it stand much longer; why you halt between two opinions? Why isn't the church on fire; why isn't the place packed out with people; why isn't great signs and wonders done? Don't lay it on to the pastor; it's you. We got a mixed multitude; one pulling one way and one the other. You've got to come to a time of decision. If it's the pastor, fire him, get him out and put somebody else in who will take his place. If it's a deacon, take him off the board and put somebody else in his place that'll take the place. What are you going to do, brother? God put the responsibility upon you. That's it. And we've each one got to give an account for our own sins and answer at the day of judgment.

GOD'S COMMISSION

God in Simplicity

by William Marrion Branham

March 17, 1963

9-3 Brother Neville, our noble brother and real pastor, servant of the living God, as far as that man knows the message, he holds with it with all he's got. That's right. He's a gentle person; he's a little a--afraid to--or not afraid, I don't mean that, but he's so--so awful gentle; he just will--doesn't speak out. You know, like to--to say a thing that's sharp and cutting or "set down," or "keep still." I--I've noticed that and listened to the tapes behind it. But it so happens that I can do that, so I--I--I want you to remember my words. You see? And this is all being taped (See?); everything is taped. **And please let every deacon stand to his post of duty and remember that you're under a commission from God to hold that post sacred (See?), every trustee the same.**

9-5 Pastor is to bring forth... **It isn't the pastor's place to have to say that; it's the trustees--or I mean the deacons, for they are the police of the church.** That is, if young couples come on the outside and blow horns, and you know how they usually do, or something like that at meetings or--or get out there... And mother sends her girl down here, and she takes off out with some renegade kid and runs out there in the car, and her mother thinks she's in church like that, the deacon ought to see to that. "You either come in here and set down, or I'm going to take you in my car and take you home to your mother." See? You--you must do that.

10-1 Remember, love is corrective (See?), always. Genuine love is corrective. So you must be able to stand the correction. And mothers know now that there's a place there for your babies. You young kids know different than to run around over the building. See? And you adults know different than to talk and carry on your conversations in the auditorium. See? Don't do that; it's wrong. It isn't pleasing to God. Jesus said, "It is written: My house shall be made a house of worship, prayer, called the house of prayer by all nations." And they were buying and selling, and He plaited ropes and ran the people out of the auditorium. And we certainly don't want that to happen in this sanctuary here. So let's dedicate our lives, our church, our tasks, our service, and everything we have to the Kingdom of God.

IN THE LINE OF DUTY

Questions & Answers

by William Marrion Branham

January 12, 1961

585-465 What if they had come to the altar and Brother Neville was still in his sermon, and he was preaching? I'd have went to the altar with the man, if he'd have got up out of the meeting while he was preaching, went up to the altar. I'd have seen my brother was--that he had the anointing of the Spirit. He was ministering. He was a minister in the... He was in the line of duty, a minister in the line of duty. And you should never let them speak with tongues, interrupt, or any way, a minister in the line of duty. Yes, if the Holy Spirit's speaking to somebody and they run to the altar to get saved, let the minister continue on with his line of duty; let a pastor, deacon, associate, if there's an associate or any other minister, let him take to that person right quick. And don't bother the minister in the line of duty. See?

589-Q-131 Question: Is it ruling, r-u-l-i... Is it ruling that a deacon or a trustee must abide in the doctrine of their church? (Yes. That's right.) Is it lawful for them to add to or take away of the teachings because of their own personal opinion or revelation? (No, sir. No.)

A deacon or a trustee should be perfectly in harmony with the--with the doctrine of their church. They should stay perfectly with the interpretation of the Scriptures of their church, because, if they don't, they're fighting against the very thing... They're--they're hurting themselves. See? You're battling...It's, other words, like if--if--if I say I love my family and try to feed them poison. See, same thing. See, you can't do that, you...A--a trustee or a deacon in taking their office, or

any officer of a church that represents a certain church body (See?) that represents a church...That's the reason I walked out of the Baptist church (See?) for the very first time. I'd just been in there a little bit and they--they asked me to ordain some woman preachers. Well, I couldn't actually stay in it. I said, "I--I--I refuse to do it." And the pastor jerked me up. "What's this? You're an elder." I said, "Doctor Davis, in all due respects to the Baptist faith, and everything that I have been ordained to, I did not know that it was in the doctrine of the Baptist church to ordain women. That was one thing that was left out of it." And he said, "That is the doctrine of this church." I said, "Sir, could I be excused for tonight, or would you answer some questions for me?" See? He said, "I'll answer your questions." Said, "It's your duty to be there." I said, "It is, sir. That's right. I'm supposed to anticipate in anything that this church does. I'm in the line of duty, one of the local elders." And he said... I said, "Could you explain to me why that in I Corinthians 14 or 15 there, where Paul said, 'Let your women keep silent in the churches; it's not permitted them to speak.'"

And he said, "Why, certainly." He said, "If... I can answer that." He said, "You see, what it was," said, "Paul said... All--all the women was setting back in the corners, popping off like they do a lot of the other time. He said, 'Don't let them do that.' See?" I said, "Then explain II Timothy to me, where Paul said also, the same scribe, the same apostle, said, 'I suffer not a woman to teach or to usurp any authority (See?), but to--to be in obedience. For Adam was first formed and then Eve, and Adam was not deceived but the woman being deceived... She's deceived. Now, I don't say she wants to do anything wrong, but she's actually deceived in it. She shouldn't be a teacher.'" He said, "Is that your personal opinion?" I said, "That's the Scripture's opinion to my way of seeing it. That's what the Bible said." He said, "Young man, you could have your license taken from you for that." I said, "I'll just save them the trouble. I'll just give it, Doctor Davis." I said, "Not to any disregard to you..." And he wouldn't do it though. He let it go, let it go by like that. Then he told me he'd hold an open debate with me with it. And I said, "All right, just anytime." But he--he didn't do that. So then a--a little later on then when the Lord spoke to me, and about the--the Angel of the Lord came, then--then he just made fun of That. You see? And then I--I just told him; I said, "Well, Doctor Davis, it's best that I get rid of this right now (See?)," I said, "'cause it's going to be a burden. I'm just been ordained a little bit, anyhow, so it's going to be a burden to me, so I just might as well get rid of it right now." So therefore, if I could not stay in the Baptist church and teach Baptist doctrine and take up for Baptist belief... If I did it--if I did it just because it was a church, then I'm wrong (See?); I'm hiding something back. And if I--if I--if I'm honest with myself, I'll go to the Baptist people (my pastor or whoever can explain it to me) and ask them for a--a word of Life; if he can correctly show me where it's

right in the Scripture, and satisfies my feeling, then I'll speak it just the way they speak it (See?), and I'll be a Baptist.

That's the reason I am an independent. That's the reason that I do not belong to the organizations, because I do not believe in organizations. And I believe it's unscriptural for an organization. Therefore, I could not belong to any organization and feel justified by doing it. See? Therefore, I do not take people in and make them members and so forth like that, because I believe we're born to be members; we are borned into the Church of the living God. See? We don't take people's names off the book, and excommunicate them, and everything like that, because I believe that's not in our--our duties to do that. I believe it's God does the excommunicating. See? But I believe that the church, if there would be a brother that was doing something wrong...

For instance, if--if they caught Brother Neville, or Brother Junior, or Brother, some brother here, one of the deacons or trustees, or something another, doing something wrong, I believe the thing to do is for the church to get together and pray for this brother. If he still don't straighten up, then let a couple go with him, go to the brother to be reconciled. And if then if he don't receive it, then tell it before the church. Then if they don't receive it then, that's the time for the whole church then (See?); that's for pastor, elders, and everything else to do it. **I don't believe that any deacon board has a right to throw anybody out of church, or any trustee board, or any pastor has a right to do it. I think if anybody was to be disfellowshipped, would be because of immoral living, or something like that, that he wasn't a fit person,** like a man coming in here defiling our girls or--or insulting our women, and things like that, and still professing to be one of us here... See? Now, if he's out somewhere else coming in, why, we have to do something about it, but, when it comes to a person like that, a immoral person trying to make love to our wives, or--or insult our daughters, or, you know, something another like that, or do something immorally around her, or taking our little boys out and making perverts out of them, or something, those things should be taken up, and then that fellow should be excommunicated from the fellowship and not permitted to take communion with it; because we're not supposed to do that. We're not. "If any eats unworthily, is guilty of the Blood and body of the Lord," on that person.

CONFRONTING SIN WITH LOVE

I Timothy 5:1-2

1 ¶ Rebuke not an elder, but intreat him as a father; and the younger men as brethren; 2 The elder women as mothers; the younger as sisters, with all purity.

GREEK LEXICON -- STRONG'S NUMBER

1969 **EPIPLESSO** AV -- **REBUKE**: to strike upon, beat upon 1b) to chastise with words, to chide, upbraid, rebuke

3870 **PARAKALEO** AV -- **INTREAT** (3) -- beseech (43) -- comfort(23) exhort (21) -- desire (8) -- pray (6) -- misc (4)

I) to call to one's side, call for, summon II) to address, speak to, (call to, call upon), which may be done in the way of exhortation, entreaty, comfort, instruction, etc. 1) to admonish, exhort 2) to beg, entreat, beseech; to strive to appease by entreaty 3) to console, to encourage and strengthen by consolation, to comfort; to receive consolation, be comforted 4) to encourage, strengthen 5) exhorting and comforting and encouraging 6) to instruct, teach

The main focus of this passage lies within two verbs. The first, *epiplesso* (rebuke), is a strong term that refers to a serve or formal reprimand. It implies that verbal rather than physical violence is prohibited. A fallen Christian is not to be hammered with harsh words. Rather, the Christian should be *parakaleo* (intreated) which means to make an earnest implore. In other words strengthen the fallen Christian by holding them up in their fallen state. Romans 15:4 states that scriptures are a source of strength. As the Word and the Spirit of God strengthens believers, so must the Christian come to the aid of the fallen individual. Galatians 6:1-2, addresses this duty by saying,

1 Brethren, if a man be overtaken in a fault, ye which are spiritual, restore such an one in the spirit of meekness; considering thyself, lest thou also be tempted. 2 Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.

Confronting sin in the church is not to be done by violently attacking (verbally or physically) fallen brothers and sisters. The sinning person must be lovingly confronted, strengthened, and encouraged toward holy living. It is to be a restorative, redemptive, remedial confrontation, one that must be done with an attitude of gentleness. Consider II Timothy 2:24-26 as a point of reference,

And the servant of the Lord must not strive; but be gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient, 25 In meekness instructing those that oppose themselves; if God peradventure will give them repentance to the acknowledging of the truth; 26 And that they may recover themselves out of the snare of the devil, who are taken captive by him at his will.

The apostle Paul applies these principles for dealing with sin in the family of God to four groups.

CONFRONTING OLDER MEN

*Rebuke not an **elder**, but intreat him as a **father**;*

An older man is to be treated with respect by being appealed to as a father. The context indicates that Paul has in mind the general category of older men not necessarily the office of Elder according to the Greek word *Presbuteros* (older man / elder). As a young man, Timothy was instructed to confront older sinning men with the same respect and deference he would show to his own father.

RESPECT *n* 1 : high or special regard : esteem 2 *pl* : an expression of respect or deference.

DEFERENCE *n* : courteous, respectful, or ingratiating regard for another's wishes
syn honor, homage, obeisance, reverence .

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The Bible proves to us that older men are to be treated with respect according to Leviticus 19:32, Proverbs 4:1-4, 16:31, 20:29, 30:17, Job 32:4 & 6, Exodus 21:17. Daniel's appeal to Nebuchadnezzar is a model of how to approach a sinning older man. In Daniel 4:27, Daniel showed great respect when confronting

Nebuchadnezzar's sin:

Wherefore, O king, let my counsel be acceptable unto thee, and break off thy sins by righteousness, and thine iniquities by shewing mercy to the poor; if it may be a lengthening of thy tranquillity.

Another example is found in Paul's counsel of Peter in Galatians 2:11-14:

¶ But when Peter was come to Antioch, I withstood him to the face, because he was to be blamed. 12 For before that certain came from James, he did eat with the Gentiles: but when they were come, he withdrew and separated himself, fearing them which were of the circumcision. 13 And the other Jews dissembled likewise with him; insomuch that Barnabas also was carried away with their dissimulation. 14 But when I saw that they walked not uprightly according to the truth of the gospel, I said unto Peter before them all, If thou, being a Jew, livest after the manner of Gentiles, and not as do the Jews, why compellest thou the Gentiles to live as do the Jews?

A great lesson can be learned in these two passages of scripture. The key is that although Paul and Daniel confronted the sin, they never lost respect and deference when correcting the sinner. They never made an accusatory declaration, but gently counseled with them. Confronting anyone in sin with gentleness is our responsibility as believers especially when the sinner is an older man. Correction must be done with reverence and respect.

CONFRONTING YOUNG MEN

***“...the younger men as brethren;*”**

The scripture also give us instruction in approaching our young men. The individual doing the correction must approach the younger man as a brother in a manner demonstrating equality and not superiority. The believer should see a younger believer as being of the same family and show love as one would show to family and relatives. The interaction should reflect the absence of any hierarchy or self righteousness. Consider the apostle John's command to believers to love each other as brothers:

He that saith he is in the light, and hateth his brother, is in darkness even until now. 10 He that loveth his brother abideth in the light, and there is none occasion of stumbling in him. 11 But he that hateth his brother is in darkness, and walketh in darkness, and knoweth not whither he goeth, because that darkness hath blinded his eyes (I John 2:9-11).

¶ For this is the message that ye heard from the beginning, that we should love one another. 12 Not as Cain, [who] was of that wicked one, and slew his brother. And wherefore slew he him? Because his own works were evil, and his brother's righteous. 13 Marvel not, my brethren, if the world hate you. 14 ¶ We know that we have passed from death unto life, because we love the brethren. He that loveth not his brother abideth in death. 15 Whosoever hateth his brother is a murderer: and ye know that no murderer hath eternal life abiding in him (I John 3:11-15).

Another example is exhibited in Joseph's attitude toward his brothers despite their evil treatment of him (cf. Gen. 45:4, 50:15). Peter exhorted believers to "love the brotherhood" (I Peter 2:17), as did Paul: "Be devoted to one another in brotherly love" (Romans 12:10, Heb. 13:1).

Such love does not preclude confrontation of sin for love is corrective. But our approach, demeanor and disposition should be in love. Paul's instructions to the Thessalonians are one of many guides in confronting Christian brothers caught in transgression:

II THESSALONIANS 3:6, 14-15

¶ Now we command you, brethren, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that ye withdraw yourselves from every brother that walketh disorderly, and not after the tradition which he received of us. 14 And if any man obey not our word by this epistle, note that man, and have no company with him, that he may be ashamed. 15 Yet count him not as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother.

Brotherly confrontations are to be done in humility and love. Scripturally, this is the

correct spirit needed when confronting a younger man.

CONFRONTING OLDER WOMEN

“The elder women as mothers;”

Mothers should always be treated gently with honor and respect regardless of the circumstances. The Bible commands respect for mothers. Exodus 20:12 states, *“Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be prolonged in the land which the Lord your God gives you”* (Reference: Deut. 5:16). Proverbs goes to great length to show us the importance of honoring mothers: *“Hear, my son, your father’s instruction, and do not forsake your mother’s teaching”* (1:18); *“My son, observe the commandment of your father, and do not forsake the teaching of your mother”* (6:20); *“Listen to your father who begot you, and do not despise your mother when she is old”* (23:22).

The scripture gives a good example of how to treat older women in the writings of Paul. In Philippians 4:1-3, he gave advice on how to deal with two women who were causing trouble in Philippi:

*¶ Therefore, my brethren dearly beloved and longed for, my joy and crown, so stand fast in the Lord, my dearly beloved. 2 I beseech **Euodias**, and beseech **Syntychē**, that they be of the same mind in the Lord. 3 And I intreat thee also, true comrade, help those women which laboured with me in the gospel, with Clement also, and with other my fellowlabourers, whose names are in the book of life.*

Even though those two women were hindering the cause of Christ in Philippi, Paul nevertheless responded to their harm in a gracious, gentle manner. Although he rebuked them, he included them among the brethren that he loved. He also noted their service to him in the cause of the Gospel. Paul lovingly treated them as he would his own mother.

CONFRONTING YOUNGER WOMEN

“...the younger women as sisters, in all purity.”

If you notice very closely, Paul is setting two criteria that we must adhere to when dealing with younger women: treat them as sisters and in all purity. The purity of younger women is to be protected. Incest was strictly forbidden by the Old Testament law (References: Lev. 18:9-18, 20:17-19; Deut 27:22). Paul is stressing that we must be indifferent to them in terms of lust. There are very few things a evil as a elected official who sins mentally or physically with a young woman he is helping spiritually. This is nothing short of incest in the spiritual realm. For this reason, Paul adds this phrase *“in all purity.”*

Nothing so easily makes or breaks an official as his conduct with women. Thoughtlessness or indiscretion, as well as outright immorality, violate his calling to lead the flock in all purity. Younger women must be confronted with their sin and encourage to godliness. They must, however, never be led into sin, but be treated as beloved spiritual sisters whose purity is the highest consideration.

The book of Proverbs gives us six ways to maintain purity in relationships with younger women:

1. AVOID THE LOOK - (6:25) *“...neither let her take thee with her eyelids.”*
(Job 31:1) *“ I made a covenant with mine eyes; why then should I think upon a virgin?”*
2. AVOID FLATTERY - (5:3) *“For the lips of a strange woman drop as an honeycomb, and her mouth is smoother than oil:”* (Ref.: 2:16, 6:24, 22:14).
3. AVOID THE THOUGHTS - (6:25) *“Lust not after her beauty in thine heart...”*
4. AVOID THE RENDEZVOUS - (7:7-12) *“And beheld among the simple ones, I discerned among the youths, a young man void of understanding, passing through the street near her corner; and he went the way to her house, in the twilight, in the evening, in the black and dark night: and, behold, there met him a woman with the attire of an harlot, and subtil of heart. She is loud and stubborn; her feet abide not in her house: now is she without, now in the streets, and lieth in wait at every corner.”*
AVOID THE HOUSE - (7:25-27) *“Let not thine heart decline to her ways, go not astray in her paths. For she hath cast down many wounded: yea, many strong [men] have been slain by her. Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death”* (Ref.: 5:8).

5. AVOID THE TOUCH - (7:13) "So she caught him, and kissed him..."

This was the final step in a process that culminated in immorality.

As a solemn warning, never be alone with a woman. A man should always obey the Word and never think himself above immoral violation of the Word when he puts himself in this precarious situation. The Bible says, "*Abstain from all appearance of evil*" (I Thessalonians 5:22). Therefore, if the situation appears questionable, it is best if avoided in the first place.

Paul's instruction to Timothy and the related passages send a clear message to all believers on how to confront sin in the spiritual family. It is therefore of great importance that we have a solid foundation in the Scriptures that God may reveal what He brought through His prophet in our day.

HANDLING A COMPLAINT

Hebrews

by William Marrion Branham

September 9, 1957

337-278 But if there's any complaint against any member, if a member has a complaint against one another, or something wrong, you're supposed to go to that brother yourself and talk to him, you and he alone. Then if they won't receive it, then the next thing takes place; you take one of the deacons or somebody, and go with you to that brother. Then if he won't receive you, then you come, tell it to the church. Then if the church... Then if he won't receive the church, then the Bible said, "Let them be as a heathen and a Publican." That's right. And any persons that knows a guilty person, and you don't go to them and talk, then you're the part of the Church of God that's going to answer for that sin. That's right.

337-280 And if any persons then has a--a complaint against a deacon, or against the deacon, or somebody in the church, it takes three people. Three people would come and say--witness at the mouth of two or three witnesses. Come tell the pastor that there's a grievance against a deacon. Then if there's a grievance against a deacon, the deacon isn't a just man, a perfect man... He must hold the office of a deacon blameless, and then found blameless. And if that congregation finds out that that deacon's not holding that office, he gets three with him and takes it to the pastor. That deacon's asked to stay home over the night, and then the pastor from--comes and brings the congregation together, gives the grievance. And if the congregation votes

for the deacon to continue on, the deacon continues on. If he con--votes for the deacon to be dismissed, they elect a new deacon that very night. See?

337-281 Therefore, no one person has nothing to do in this; it's the majority of the people. Yes, sir. If twenty votes for him, and twenty-one votes against him, he goes, or vice versa. See? That is, it's the sovereignty of the local church, and then each one of the members has a say-so in the church. Anything goes on wrong, then they can come right around, and the only thing they have to do is to be before God that they are absolutely see that nothing hinders the moving of the church.

338-282 **But the full and complete authority of the church is the pastor.** Read that in the Bible; see if that's not Bible order. That's exactly right. There's no one above the elder. I have nothing to do with what Brother Neville does here. That's up to you and Brother Neville. If Brother Neville wanted to preach Jehovah Witness doctrine, that's up to him and you. See? If he wanted to preach anything he wanted to, that's between you and him. That's all. If the congregation votes for him in there to preach that, that's all right. That's up to him.

DO NOT SEND THE PASTOR

Hebrews

by William Marrion Branham

September 9, 1957

302-78 In this Tabernacle here, when things go wrong and you men and you women will run and go over somewhere else, or lay out till the little fuss or the stew is over, there's something wrong with your experience. That's right. We have a custom here. We have a--we have a order here; this church is based upon the principles of the Bible. If there's somebody in here not doing right, and you think they're not, you go to him and talk to him. If you can't reconcile him, then take some brother with you, one or two more. If he won't be reconciled then, then tell it to the church; and the church will dismiss him, have no more fellowship with him. And Jesus said, "Whatever you loose on earth, I'll loose in heaven." That's the reason you have so much troubles, because you don't follow the Bible principles. If somebody in the church is causing a disturbance, or something going wrong, it's not your duty to go talk about that man or that woman. It's your duty to go to that man or woman and tell him his error. And if he won't hear you, take some other one with you. If he won't hear that, then the church looses him. Jesus said, "What you loose on earth, I'll loose in heaven. What you bind on earth, I'll bind in heaven." That's the power of the church.

302-81 Here not long ago, a good, preacher friend of mine, he had a boy. And that boy had been going to church, his own church. He got to a place where he started running around with a little old girl who smoked and drank and carried on. Preacher said, "Of course, that's his business." A very bosom friend of mine, and a nice boy... But he got all infatuated with the--some young woman. And she'd been married, had some children; her husband was living. He was afraid they was going to have--that boy would marry her. So the brother was all tore up, and he said to me, "Brother Branham, I want you to go to this certain-certain boy of mine; I want you to talk to him."

302-82 I said, "Brother,..." I almost called his name. "You have a better way; don't send me. If the boy's not living up, and the church has saw him doing wrong, then it's the thing for the church to do this business. That's left with the church, and the church goes over and tells him." So he took a brother, and went over and told him. And he got back at the brother, let him know that he was attending to his own business, for him to do the same. He took another brother, two more (two deacons), went over and told the boy. He wouldn't listen to it. They told it to the church. And he never come for several nights to be reconciled to the church after his sin was told before the church, then the church loosed him. And about a month from then he was stricken down with pneumonia, and the doctor said, "There's not a chance in the world for him to live." Then he crawled back. God knows how to do it. We try to do it in ourselves, "Oh, you ought to kick so-and-so out of church. You ought to do this, that, or the other." Have you done your part as a church towards it? There you are. That's the way to make them crawl back: turn them over to the Devil one time.

303-86 What'd Paul say about this man down there was living with his stepmother? They couldn't get him reconciled, said, "Turn him over to the Devil." Watch what happens then in the next letter Paul wrote; this man had got straightened out. Sure, God has a way of doing these things, if we'll just follow His rules. If something goes wrong in the church, if it's amongst the congregation, each one of you brothers that's on the deacon board... One of you deacons don't behave, the other deacons come and have a meeting, try to reconcile the brother; tell him what he's doing, or one of you members, whatever you are. Then it's to be brought before him. If he won't do it, then come tell the pastor. Then he's loosed from the church, and then let him be as a heathen and a Publican. Then watch the Lord go to work on him (See?); that's when he comes back to himself; that's when he goes to crawling in. But we try and do it ourself, you know, try to do the--everything the way we should do it. Now, we never make a success.

KEEP YOUR EYES ON CHRIST

Hebrews

by William Marrion Branham

September 15, 1957

315-152 And you deacon, and you others here, that run out on the street here, and gawking your neck and looking at every one of them women, shame on you, and calling yourself sons of God. I know that's scorching, but you'd--rather be scorched than then burnt forever there. So if--if you do those things... Now, you can't help it if a woman walks down the street, half dressed. You, if you're looking, you're bound to see her, but you can turn your head. The Bible said, "Whosoever looketh upon a woman to lust after her, hath committed adultery with her already in your heart."

PHOENIX TABERNACLE CHURCH ORDER

1241 East Baseline, Phoenix, AZ 85040-8005

Here is a list of guidelines regarding the code of conduct that the Pastor is requesting we adhere to:

1. An attendance record will be kept. Your attendance at every service will be monitored very closely per the pastor's request.
2. Three unexcused absences will require the individual to speak to the pastor before he can serve again. Excessive tardiness (more than 5) will require the individual to speak to the pastor before he can serve again.
3. Deacons and ushers must give at least 24 hours notice for their absence or tardiness, unless an emergency arises. Your reason for your absence or tardiness will determine if it is excused or unexcused. Contact either the Church office, the Administrator, or the Pastor.
4. All deacons and ushers serving, must be at the Tabernacle a minimum of 15 minutes before the doors open (i.e. no later than 6:30 PM on Wednesdays, 8:45 AM Sunday morning, 2:15 PM Sunday PM). All deacons not serving and ushers on stand-by are required to be at the Tabernacle 30 minutes before service starts. A deacon should be at his post no later than 45 minutes before service starts. If you are not able to attend or will be late, call the office and / or the supervisor to inform them of your situation. You are expected to call because we are counting on you.
5. Deacons and ushers that are serving are required to have a good Christian hair cut, wear a white dress shirt, tie, slacks (dress pants not casual pants), dress shoes (no casual or tennis shoes) and a sport coat (preferably black, blue, brown, green). If you do not own a sport coat and do not have the money to buy one or two of them contact the Administrator. Always keep several breath mints with you for yourself and your colleagues during each service. Use them and share them when appropriate. It should go without saying, that breath mints are something you must always bring to service.

6. Name tags will be required when serving and it should read:

Phoenix Tabernacle, Inc.

your office

your name

Everyone that comes to the Tabernacle will be greeted with a smile (a good smile shows teeth), handshake, and a verbal welcome **in the vestibule area only**. **There should only be two individuals (deacon or ushers) greeting the people at all times in the vestibule. No more than the two deacons or ushers should be in the vestibule area once the doors are open. Once the individual enters the sanctuary there will be no verbal greetings inside the sanctuary.** If someone greets you inside the sanctuary and wants to shake your hand, just smile, shake their hand and direct them to their seat. **Do not verbally greet them in the sanctuary.** No greeting, talking and shaking hands in the sanctuary.

7. All serving deacons and ushers need to get their assignments from the Administrator (or the Administrator's assistant) for each service.
8. A deacon and usher's conduct will be according to I Timothy 3:10-13:

10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being [found] blameless. 11 Even so [must their] wives [be] grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things. 12 Let the deacons be the husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well. 13 For they that have used the office of a deacon well purchase to themselves a good degree, and great boldness in the faith which is in Christ Jesus.

The prescribe order is to enhance our service and worship to our Lord Jesus Christ.

BEFORE SERVICE:

1. The doors to the church are to be open to the public 30 minutes before the service starts unless extreme weather prevails or special circumstances approved by the pastor then we will open the doors as soon as the people get to the church.
2. Before the doors of the church open the deacons should gather together for a word of prayer.

3. Deacons need to have everything set-up before the doors open to the public. Deacons are to help set-up equipment, pick up trash in the sanctuary and grounds, put toilet paper, paper towels, etc. in the bathrooms.
4. Deacons for platform / altar area need to make sure that everything is set in order before service start. This includes arranging the chairs on the platform, washing and filling glasses with water for the pulpit, arrangement of microphones for specials and special activities, projector set-up, transparency machine, projector screen, anointing oil. Know the program by memory. The altar deacons are to assist with any activity involving the platform i.e.: baptisms, children songs, child presentations, altar calls, etc.
5. Make sure that all lights indoors and outside are operating before the doors open.

SEATING:

1. Seating those that attend our services is a very delicate issue. It requires insight of diversities of cultures and experience. Being bilingual is beneficial.
2. The maximum adult seating capacity per pew is 11.
3. The object of seating people is to fill the middle of a pew first and eliminate having individuals cross in front of others already seated. This can be especially embarrassing for the sisters passing in front of a man already seated.
4. Avoid seating men next to a lady who is not a relative or spouse and visa versa.
5. Use caution and wisdom when seating large individuals. Do not sit them where they have crossover many individuals or where many individuals have to cross through them to get to their seats.
6. All deacons must remember those seated in your area. If an individual temporary leaves their seat, make a note to yourself and by no means seat anyone else in that seat. If this requires you to carry a notepad to keep track, then please use one.
7. Platform seating is reserved for Elders, officers of the church, and exemplary youth.
8. In the first row, we want to sit clean cut men who are dressed properly.
9. The first pew on either side is reserved for the Garcia family. Bro Paul's family occupies the south pew and Bro Bernie's family sits in the north pew. The last two pews are for late comers.

10. The back row should be reserved for mothers with young children (ages 0-5). Three reasons to sit mothers and their children in the back pews include:

Minimize distraction

Frequent bathroom visits

Facilitate exiting of crying child.

Remember that the goal is to minimize disruption of the Holy Ghost.

OVERFLOW SEATING:

1. Seating - the use of folding chairs is permitted beside the pews only after the pews are filled. Begin putting folding chairs on the north and south sides of the church first, then put them in the center, next place more chairs in the altar area if needed. Then fill the aisle in between the last pew of the church only after we have filled the sides, pulpit, altar area, and center aisle. Place chairs in the cry room if we know that the vestibule seating will not be enough. Start seating people in the cry room first then the vestibule. Once we have filled all these areas then instruct individuals to stand along the north and south walls.
2. Chairs, pulpit, pews & equipment must be put back to their original position after each service/activity unless advised otherwise by the supervisor, administrator, or pastor

TEMPERATURE CONTROL:

1. If the A/C units are to be used, they should be set at 71-73 degrees. Remember that while the worship is in progress the temperature rises and during the sermon the temperature drops. During the summer months (late June, July, August, September and part of October) the A/C units should be set at 74 degrees on Saturday night, between Sunday morning and Sunday Afternoon service so that the church is cool before service. The deacons in positions 3,4,5, & 6 should manage the thermostat under the leadership of the Pastor. If you see people fanning themselves, it is a good indicator that we need to cool the building a little more. We must learn how to regulate the thermostats so that most of the people are comfortable. Deacons assigned to this duty must be especially vigilant and in tune with the environment.

ALTAR AREA:

1. About the time the minister is finishing his message, a deacon must be in position in the middle of the center aisle...If people start coming to the altar, we need the two altar deacons to instruct people to remain standing and direct them where to stand. In addition, we need the deacons on the north and south sides of the sanctuary closes to the altar to come to the altar and help the altar deacons. When needed, a female deacon (deaconess) should be assisting the sisters at the altar.

CRY-ROOM:

1. We will need a couple of deaconess helping us with the Cry-room such as Sis. Alvarado, Sis. O'Campo, Sis. Borunda and others. Sister Margarita O'Campo has been helping us monitor this area and the Ladies Restroom.
2. Adults must accompany all children that enter the Cry-room.
3. Deacons should not enter the Cry-room but contact the deaconess if problems arise.

QUESTIONS, PROBLEMS, CONCERNS:

1. All disputes should be sent to the supervisor & administrator.
2. Disruptive individuals will need to be exhorted outside of the sanctuary and spoken to about their behavior. Consult a supervisor about the situation before you take matters in your own hands. A disruptive person is one who is interrupting the minister and others from hearing the service.
3. A deacon must always use the "three strikes' you're out" rule when correcting someone in church: 1) Warn them with a smile on you face 2) warn them again nicely 3) Talk to the supervisor about the issue so that he may take care of the problem.
4. Step 3 will always be handled by the supervisor. He will instruct you in what to do.

RESTROOMS:

1. We need to be very watchful and maintain church order especially when children and teenagers go to the restroom and are not accompanied by an adult. A deacon should always be in the Men's restroom if an adult is not present with children and teenagers. If an incident occurs in the Ladies restroom, inform the deaconess

on duty or get a mature lady of the church to go in there. Deacons are not permitted in the Ladies restroom. The deaconess will monitor the Cry-Room and the Ladies' restroom.

DURING THE SERVICE:

1. All traffic needs to come to a stop during a prayer and the reading of the scripture in reverence to God's Word.
2. During the service a deacon should make frequent visits to the Toddler's room.
3. No loitering or fellowshiping in the parking lot before and during the service.
4. The north and south doors by the pulpit area are not to be used during the service except for the pastor, administrator, and in special circumstances. Anyone trying to use these doors should be instructed to go around.

CLOSING THE CHURCH:

1. Make sure the double doors are closed once the last person is dismissed from the sanctuary. No one other than the Pastor is permitted back into the sanctuary once the service is dismissed. Musician practice and special song practice after the service will need the Pastor's approval beforehand.
2. When the service has dismissed and there are people at the altar, deacons must be present to intercede to keep order in the House of the Lord. The number of deacons needed will depend on the number of persons at the altar and the amount of traffic in the sanctuary.
3. After each service the sanctuary is closed to individuals that want to loiter, talk, or use it as a means to get to the back office. Once the church has been dismissed no one should be inside the sanctuary unless they need prayer or want to pray at the altar. Individuals that worked during the service are permitted to be in the sanctuary. Absolutely no talking is permitted in the sanctuary once the service is dismissed.
4. Make sure all lights have been turned off and all exterior doors to the church are locked before you leave. The doors of the church should never be opened unless a deacon is present and/or the pastor has given special permission. Let the supervisor or administrator know of any unusual activity.

COURTYARD / PARKING LOT:

1. Our deacons are to maintain order outside in the courtyard area at all times before, during, and after services. Children should not be running or playing in the courtyard.
2. We need to protect our people from danger before, during and after service. It is extremely important that we have deacons on guard in the parking lot once service has dismissed. To monitor who is leaving and coming into the parking lot before and after service. If a deacon sees an individual or a group coming on church property who did not attend our services, the deacon should kindly approach them and find out why they are there after service. You should watch them closely until they leave the church grounds. Let the supervisor or administrator know ASAP. A full report must be filled out and given to the supervisor and the administrator regarding any suspicious activity or proselyting especially during the convention.
3. A deacon must be sober & vigilant at all times especially when people are fellowshiping after service. Watch for the traffic coming into the church from Baseline road, children playing, parking lot, suspicious activities, etc.
4. No one is permitted to sell or give literature / material away on the church ground much less set-up a table especially during the convention unless the Pastor or Administrator is aware and the office has been notified. The Pastor or Administrator should be notified of such activity. The same thing holds true for individuals videoing our services. The deacon must advise them of our policy. There is a letter to give to these individuals that are videoing during our services to which you can obtain from the office to give them.
5. No one is to be smoking, drinking and etc. on the church ground at any time. Special enforcement is imperative during funerals, fund raisers, weddings. Visitors must be made aware of our church policy while on the church property.

VISITORS / HOSPITALITY:

1. If a visitor is in our midst and is unaware of church order, we must be forbearing, but only to the point that we do not compromise on the Word of God. Allow the supervisor or the administrator to handle any situation involving visitors.
2. It is the duty of the deacons to befriend our visitors. Be courteous, introduce yourself, find out if they liked the service. Where did they hear about us?

Would they like to speak to a minister or like a minister to visit them, etc.?

3. Deacons should be on the look-out for families that live far from the church who do not have a place to go since they live far from their homes and will not be able to go home in between Sunday AM and PM service. Invite them to your house or find out where they are going out to eat and join them to have fellowship.

GREEK LEXICON -- STRONG'S NUMBER. WEBSTER DICTIONARY

SOBER

adj **so-ber-er**; **so-ber-est** **1** : temperate in the use of liquor **2** : not drunk
3 : serious or grave in mood or disposition **4** : having a quiet tone or color **syn** solemn, earnest, staid, sedate — *so-\ber-ly* *adv* — *so-ber-ness*
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3525 NEPHO {nay'-fo} of uncertain affinity;-- be sober -- watch. 1) to be sober, to be calm and collected in spirit; to be temperate, dispassionate, circumspect

4993 SOPHRONEO {so-fron-eh'-o} from 4998; -- be in right mind -- be sober -- be sober minded -- soberly 1) to be of sound mind 1a) to be in one's right mind 1b) to exercise self control; to put a moderate estimate upon one's self, think of one's self soberly; to curb one's passions.

4994 SOPHRONIZO {so-fron-id'-zo} from 4998; -- teach to be sober (1) 1) restore one to his senses; to moderate, control, curb, disciple; to hold one to his duty; to admonish, to exhort earnestly

4998 SOPHRON {so'-frone} from the base of 4982 and 5424; -- sober -- temperate -- discreet 1a) of a sound mind, sane, in one's senses 1b) curbing one's desires and impulses, self controlled, temperate.

DEACON

[ME *dekene*, fr. OE *dĒacon*, fr. LL *diaconus*, fr. Gk *diakonos*, lit., servant] : a subordinate officer in a Christian church.

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1247 DIAKONEO {dee-ak-on-eh'-o} from 1249; -- minister unto -- serve -- minister 1) to be a servant, attendant, domestic,; to serve, wait upon. 1) to minister to one; render ministering offices to, to be served, ministered unto. 2) to wait at a table and offer food and drink to the guests, used of women preparing food 3) to minister, i.e. supply food and necessities of life; to relieve one's necessities (e.g. by collecting alms), to provide take care of, distribute, the things necessary to sustain life; to take care of the poor and the sick, who administer the office of a deacon; in Christian churches to serve as deacons. 4) to minister, i.e. to attend to anything, that may serve another's interests

1248 DIAKONIA {dee-ak-on-ee'-ah} from 1249; -- ministry -- ministration -- ministering 1) service, ministering 2) of those who by the command of God proclaim and promote religion among men 2a) of the office of Moses 2b) of the office of the apostles and its administration 2c) of the office of prophets, evangelists, elders etc. 3) the ministration of those who render to others the offices of Christian affection especially those who help meet need by either collecting or distributing of charities 4) the office of the deacon in the church 5) the service of those who prepare and present food

1249 DIAKONOS {dee-ak'-on-os} probably from an obsolete diako (to run on errands, compare 1377); -- minister -- servant -- deacon 1) one who executes the commands of another, especially of a master; a servant, attendant, minister 1) the servant of a king 2) a deacon, one who, by virtue of the office assigned to him by the church, cares for the poor and has charge of and distributes the money collected for their use 3) a waiter, one who serves food and drink

SEVEN APPOINTED MEN AS DEACONS ACCORDING TO ACTS 6:

3527 NIKANOR {nik-an'-ore} probably from 3528; -- Nicanor 1) Nicanor meaning "conqueror" was one of the first seven deacons. Acts 6:5.

3532 NIKOLAOS {nik-ol'-ah-os} from 3534 and 2994; -- Nicolas. 1) Nicolas meaning "victor of the people", was a native of Antioch and a proselyte to the Jewish faith. When the church was still confined to Jerusalem, he became a convert; and being a man of honest report, full of the Holy Ghost and of wisdom, he was chosen by the whole multitude of the disciples to be one of the seven deacon, and was ordained by the apostles. There is no reason except the similarity of the name for identifying Nicolas with the sect of the Nicolaitans which our Lord denounces, for the traditions on the subject are of no value.

3937 PARMENAS {par-men-as'} probably by contraction for Parmenides (a derivative of a compound of 3844 and 3306); -- Parmenas 1) Parmenas meaning "abiding": was one of the seven deacons. Acts 6:5. There is a tradition that he suffered martyrdom at Philippi in the reign of Trajan.

5376 PHILIPPOS {fil'-ip-pos} from 5384 and 2462;-- Philip (the apostle) -- Philip (the evangelist) 1) Philip meaning "lover of horses" was a resident of Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter, John 1:44, and was among the Galilean peasants of that district who flocked to hear the preaching of John the Baptist. Aside from the what is written in the scriptures, little is known of him. Tradition states that he preached in Phrygia, and died at Hierapolis. 2) Philip the evangelist was one of the seven deacons appointed in the church. Acts 6. He is mentioned again in Acts 8 and 21. Tradition places the scene of his death at Hierapolis in Phrygia. According to another, he died bishop of Tralles. The house in which he and his daughters had lived was pointed out to travellers in the time of Jerome.

4402 PROCHOROS {prokh'-or-os} from 4253 and 5525;-- Prochorus 1) Prochorus meaning "leader of the chorus", was one of the seven deacons chosen by the church. Acts 6:5.

4736 STEPHANOS {stef'-an-os} -- Stephen 1) Stephen meaning "crowned" was the first Christian martyr, and **was chief among the seven men appointed to rectify the complaints made by the Hellenistic Jews against the Hebrews in the early church at Jerusalem.** Act 6, 7. The importance of Stephen's career may be summed briefly up under three heads: 1. He was the first great Christian ecclesiastic, "the Archdeacon", as he is called in the Greek Orthodox Church. 2. He is the first martyr -- protomartyr. To him the name "martyr" is first applied. Acts 22:20. 3. He is the forerunner of Paul. He was the anticipator, as, had he lived, he would have been the propagator, of a new phase of Christianity of which Paul became the main support.

5096 TIMON {tee'-mone} from 5092; -- Timon 1) Timon meaning "honourable" was one of the seven deacons. Acts 6:1-6. He was a Hellenist. (A.D. 34).

DEACONESS

n : a woman chosen to assist in the church ministry

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5402 PHOIBE {foy'-bay} feminine of phoibos (bright, probably akin to the base of 5457); -- Phebe 1) Phoebe meaning "radiant" was the first and one of the most important of the Christians in the list in Rom. 16. (A.D. 55). She was a deaconess in the church at Rome. The Greek uses the word "diakonos" which is elsewhere translated "deacon", but here in the AV is translated "servant".

ELDER

4245 PRESBUTEROS {pres-boo'-ter-os} comparative of presbus (elderly); presbus AV -- elder (64) -- old man (1) -- eldest (1) -- elder woman (1) [67] 1) elder, of age, 1a) the elder of two people 1b) advanced in life, an elder, a senior; forefathers; received from the fathers 2) a term of rank or office 2a) among the Jews; members of the great council or Sanhedrin (because in early times the rulers of the people, judges, etc., were selected from elderly men); of those who in separate cities managed public affairs and administered justice 2b) among the Christians, those who presided over the assemblies (or churches) The NT uses the term bishop, elders, and presbyters interchangeably 2c) the twenty four members of the heavenly Sanhedrin or court seated on thrones around the throne of God

The Man in the Arena

“It is not the critic who counts; not the man who points out how the strong man stumbles, or where the doer of deeds could have done them better. The credit belongs to the man who is actually in the arena, whose face is marred by dust and sweat and blood; who strives valiantly; who errs, who comes short again and again, because there is no effort without error and shortcoming; but who does actually strive to do the deeds; who knows great enthusiasms, the great devotions; who spends himself in a worthy cause; who at the best knows in the end the triumph of high achievement, and who at the worst, if he fails, at least fails while daring greatly, so that his place shall never be with those cold and timid souls who neither know victory nor defeat.”

“The Man in the Arena.” Citizenship in a Republic

President Theodore Roosevelt speech at the Sorbonne, Paris, France, April 23, 1910

CHURCH ORDER

JEFF IN COD THURSDAY 63-

1226

1 You'll scratch it. Hit the... [Someone says, "Let me turn it."--Ed.] Okay. And don't turn them on yet, so it just... Turn it on. And we'll... And you be ready to turn them off. And I'll motion my head to you, like that. See? See? I'll motion my head to you. You... All right, turn it, quick. [Brother Billy Paul says, "Where you want me, daddy?" Someone says, "He said, "Turn it on.""]

Brethren, we called this meeting together here tonight for the purpose of knowing how that to operate the Church of the living God, which, we believe to be a part of this Church.

2 I want to, first thing, I want to say that in my travels around the world, so far as I know, this is one of the most spiritual places where you feel the Spirit of God more than any other place I know. I had two other places in mind that used to be, but so far we--we don't seem to see those places; one of them has went into the organization, and the other has--has kind of fallen.

3 So I was called yesterday and was--was told me that you all wanted a meeting to ask me these questions concerning your duties in this church, and I... that's what I'm here for tonight, is... and to--to set the church, or to give to you the things that I think that--that is what's substantial to make this church to continue on.

4 Brethren, I'm sure that you do realize that, as I've made this remark about this being a spiritual place. It isn't the biggest place in the world, and it isn't what we have the most singing, the most screaming, and the most hollering, or the most speaking in tongues, and things, that isn't it, but it's the quality of the Spirit that operates here in this tabernacle. And, so far, I want to commend and thank Brother Neville, and--and you brethren here, trustees, and deacons, and Sunday school superintendent, and all, for--for what you have done in helping keeping this this way. It's been a long prayer of mine, and a desire since a boy, to see the church put in order and kept in order.

5 Now, when we dedicated the church, I told you, "A little later I had something to talk to you about," how to set this thing in order, the way it should be run. And you started off... after leaving here, we had ministers and so forth. But now, Brother Neville being just young among us, come among us, I thought it'd be better for Brother Neville to get better established in the Faith before I presented such things as I'm about to do now. But now, after I find out that he is getting well established in the Faith, and understands what the Doctrine is, and has played the part of a faithful witness to Christ and holding for what we believe to be the Truth, I think it's the hour now, would be a good time, to approach him in the... and among you elders and things here of the church, that you would take these orders and remember them,

they're the best of my knowledge before God. And then I'm looking to you to carry these things out the way that I'm saying them, because somebody has to be a head around here. You have to have...

6 Now, I'm not trying to usurp authority or something like that, but, you see, a man or anything with two heads to it, it--it doesn't know how to go. God never did have two heads to His Church, He never did, it's one head. He always dealt in every generation as we've studied through the Scriptures, there's always one individual that He deals with. Because you get two man, you got two opinions. It's got to come to one final absolute, and my absolute is the Word, the Bible. And as a pastor here of the church, my absolute is the Word, and I want... I know you are brothers, you kind of look to me to be your absolute to what... as long as I follow God as Paul said in the Scripture, "You follow me, as I follow Christ."

7 And then I'd expect you brethren, at any time that you see me to get away from this Scripture, to come to me privately and tell me where I'm wrong. I don't care if you're one of the trustees or the... or if you're the janitor, whoever you are, you're duty bound to me, as a brother in Christ, to tell me when I'm wrong scripturally. If there's a question, let's set down and solve it out, together.

8 And that's why you come, I suppose, to me tonight, brought me in here, is because that there's questions here that seems to be questioning you in your mind for the things I have--have here. Now remember, brethren, I don't know... there's no names signed to any of these tickets, but... and they're wrote, and I can't... don't know who wrote them, but they're questions that's on your mind, and I'm here to answer them the best of my knowledge.

9 And remember, God is looking to me to see that I stay in the Word. And I'm looking to you to see that you carry out the Word, see, see, in this church. And keep it spiritual, for, remember, all the forces of--of the dark kingdom of Satan will be turned against you as you begin to grow in the Lord. And you must be soldiers, not just fresh recruits. You're aged soldiers now, and been trained to fight. And Satan will come among you and cause you to dispute with one another if he can. Turn him down just immediately; you're brethren; and it's the enemy. And we're here to hold a standard in this evening Light time, that, when the world is darkened and the whole church kingdom is going into the Council of Churches. And pretty soon they'll try to tack a sign on this door here, "Closed!" And then we're going to have to meet other places, 'cause they'll certainly close these churches one of these days if we don't take the mark of the beast. And we're depending on staying true to God till death sets us free, and that's what we intend to do.

10 Now straight to the... And I would ask, that if ever a time that any of these things come into question, that this tape may be played before the members of this

church, see, at your meetings, or prior the meeting, just before the meeting start. Turn this tape on and play it! And may the congregation here understand that these man are duty bound to God, as their oath in this church, to help hold these principles. You may disagree with them; and if I let you run it, then I'll disagree with you. We've got to have some source somewhere where there's got to be an ultimate. And the best that I know, I'm giving it under the Holy Spirit, letting Him be my ultimate. And let this tape be your ultimate on these questions.

10a Now, the first one is:

How shall the church act towards calls for financial help of... for food and clothing? What--what act, what--what should the church do?

11 Now we realize that the church is responsible for its own, for our members here of the church, we are totally responsible as far as we have needs to supply them with. We are responsible for our own, that's, steady, constant members of the tabernacle that come here and worship with us. We are duty bound to them, as our brothers and sisters who have proven to be our members of this gathering.

12 Now, we realize that there is millions tonight without food, without clothing, and we would love to be able to help the whole group of them, to do everything we could; but financially we cannot do that, we can't support all the world. But we are duty bound to our own. And I think, in that, and then if we have anything left over that you would want to contribute to people who are not members here of this church, something that you'd want to give to them, it should be met between the board of the deacons.

13 The deacons is the one that--that has to meet this opposition, or this problem, rather; because that in the Bible when the dispute come up about food and clothing, and so forth, in the Book of Acts, they called the apostles in about it, and they said, "Go look out for yourself seven man of honest report and full of the Holy Ghost that they might attend to these things, because we will give ourself continually to the Word of God and in prayer."

14 And it isn't the pastor's duty to look out to the... for the food and so forth. That's supposed to be by the deacons. It isn't the trustees, it is the deacons office to do this. And then this should be... Remember in the Bible, they was contributing to their own, the Greeks and the--and the Jewish, where the argument come up that one was getting a little more than the other, but it was people who had sold all their goods and had give it into the church for its support, and then to--to be divided out among them equally. And there was a little dispute come up, and there's where we got our first deacons. And that's one of their duties, is to do that.

15 I think that, as our own, as our own people, we should take care of them. And it should be turned in, any complaint, to the chairman of the deacon board, and then it

should be met by the deacon board and see what they're able to do about it. And all of those things which is clothing, and food, and financial help, or whatever it is, should come through the deacons. Then the deacons, when they decide that they are--that they are... what they're going to do about it, then it should be presented then unto the--the treasurer, to see if the treasurer is able at this time to pay this certain amount of finance, or--or buy these clothing, or whatever it is to that. But the--the deacon board should meet on that, and it doesn't go to the trustees or to the pastor. It's a deacons' thing, altogether.

15a Now, then, question number two.

Is it sufficient to say openly from the pulpit that tongues and interpretations should be done in a meeting before the service?

That's the second question on this slip of paper that I have here, which is a little card.

16 Now, this would be pertaining to the pastor here, see. Because he--he, after all, over the spiritual part, he's the head of that. Deacons are policemen in the church, to keep order and to take care of these things, and feeding the poor, and so forth. The trustees are over the finance and the building, and that's what they are to look after. But the pastor is over the--the supervising of the spiritual part, and this would go to you, Brother Neville.

17 Now, there... sometime ago when the order was set, the church. I do believe in speaking in tongues, and interpretation, and all the fine spiritual gifts that's ordained of God to be in the church. But we are living in a day just like it was in the Bible time, where the churches... Now, you notice Paul, he founded the church at Ephesus, the Ephesian church, which was a well-established church. Did you notice? We believe that Paul, and did say so himself, that he spoke with many tongues, and we know that he had gifts of tongues. Not ones that he had learned, but those who were spiritually given to him, because how he speaks it in Corinthians there. And to save time, I'm not just turning in the Bible and reading it for you, because it would make our--our stay here too long tonight, as I don't have too much time. And now... but just so that you could openly see.

18 Now, Paul never one time had to speak to the Ephesian church or to the Roman church, or any of those other churches, about their spiritual gifts, about how to put them in order. But he did have to speak to the Corinthians continually about it, because they made it an issue all the time. And Paul said, when he come among them, if they found out if one had a tongue and one had a psalm, and he thanked the Lord for all their fine gifts and things like that. And if you'll notice in the first chapter or two of Corinthians, Paul was telling them, positionally, what they were in Christ, how he... they were positionally in Christ.

19 Then after he told them, then like a father he begin to let the whip down on

them, and say, "I hear there's contentions among you, and I hear that you get drunk at the Lord's table." He didn't unchristianize them; and don't you brethren do that, unchristianize them, but it's the way they're behaving themselves in the house of God. That's where it's at.

20 Now, I would say this, that as Paul of old said, that, "When you come together, if one speaks, let another one interpret. If there be no interpreter, then hold your peace. But if there be an interpreter..."

21 Now, I've watched the church here, and I've seen you grow up, and I've seen many spiritual gifts operating among you. Frankly, one I had to come to Brother Neville about with a Word from the Lord, to correct him on something that he was doing.

22 And if I... if the Lord has... The Holy Ghost has made me an overseer of the Flock, then it's my duty to tell you the Truth. And I'm very grateful to Brother Neville, he heeded to the Truth. I can only say It as He tells me.

23 Now, on this, as I have noticed your church growing, and noticed it. And in the church, here's the way we had it first, and this is the way we--we want it again.

24 Now, if you don't watch, when babies... The first thing a baby does is try to talk when he can't talk. See? He makes a lot of bubble, and noise, and--and so forth, but he thinks he's just... he can out-talk the preacher at that time. Well, we find that not only in the natural life, but we find that in the spiritual life also. It's a little one. And if you try to correct that baby and spank him a little bit because he's "gooing" and trying to talk, you'll ruin the child. See, and you'll hurt him. And it's best to let that baby grow a little while until he actually can speak his words right, and then tell him when. "Not when papa's talking or when mama's talking." But when it's appropriate time, let him have his say. Do you understand me? Now, let him talk when his time comes to talk.

25 Now, if I've ever had anything that's been a thorn in my flesh, out in the meeting, it's someone to rise up when I'm speaking and then give a message in tongues and break the Spirit. I just come out of a meeting in New York and different places to where ministers let that go on, time after time, and it's nothing but--but a confusion. See, when God is dealing in one line of thought, He... it would be--it would... He would be defeating His Own purpose, if He's trying to get a line of thought to you, to the congregation, to make an altar call and something butt in.

26 For instance, like this. We're setting at the table, talking, and we're talking about the Lord. And junior runs in to the table, real quick, takes all the attention away from what we're doing, and he hollers, scream out, "Dad! Mom! My! My! I just hit a home run down at the team! And we done all this, that, and the other!" And when we were right on a real right-down sacred subject. Now, him hitting a home run, that's all right

at the baseball game, that's all right. But he's out of order when he breaks in on the message that we're talking about. Let him wait till his time comes and then tell us what he did at the baseball game.

27 Now, that's just the same thing we find with gifts today. That's the reason God cannot trust too many spiritual gifts with people, they don't know how to control them. That's what's the matter today, the reason we don't have no more than we do.

28 Then we do find there's a lot of impersonation of spiritual gifts. But I don't believe that's so here in our church. I'm thankful for that. I don't believe it's an impersonation at all. I believe we have genuine gifts, but we must know how to control those gifts.

29 And then when you go to doing something good... Just like you was working for a boss and you started out on the first of your job and you're willing to take orders, then the boss has confidence in you and he will keep raising you up to a higher office all the time.

30 Now, I believe that time has struck the Branham Tabernacle, to know what... to take the gifts that God gives us, that God can trust us with something even greater than what we have got. But we cannot go along... and you see a man that's always have to be telling him and everything. And remember, "The spirit of the prophets is subject to the prophet," says the Scripture. When you see a man that you have to correct, or a woman, and that person gets out of order, and then you're telling him the Scriptural Truth, then it shows that the spirit that's on them isn't of God. Because the Bible said, "The spirit of the prophets," or, "prophesying," that's, testifying, preaching, speaking in tongues, or whatever it is, 'cause tongues interpreted is prophecy. So it's subject to the prophet, and the Word is the prophet. So we--we see that it's out of order for a man or a woman to jump up and give a message, no matter how much they want to do it, while the preacher is in the pulpit.

31 Now I suggest this for the Branham Tabernacle, that being that our--our gifts that we find... And we have some very fine gifted people here. Now, each one of those gifts are a ministry of their own. They are gifts, just like preaching is a gift, like healing is a gift, like other things are gifts, these are gifts, they are ministries of their own. And each man is commanded to wait on his own ministry.

32 Therefore let the Branham Tabernacle be operated like this, and in the day, especially this day when we've had so much, (I don't want to say this, but) so much make-belief. We don't want make-belief. No man, no honest person wants to have a make-belief. We... If we can't have the real, let's not have any at all, let's wait till we do get the real. Now, I believe you--you men would agree with that. We don't want nothing make-belief. Brethren, we can't start on make-belief something and leaving this world. We got to have what's real, and what's genuine. If we haven't got it, let's

wait till we do get it, and then say something about it. See?

33 Now, I would say, let all these men and women who speak in tongues, and prophesy, and give messages... And I'm--I'm believing with you men that they are genuine. Now, the Bible has said, "Prove all things, and hold fast to that what's good." "For with stammering lips and other tongues will I speak to this people, this is the rest that I said that they should enter into," and over in the Book of Isaiah.

34 Now, I would suggest this so that the sanctuary will only be ministered by one gift at a time, for it brings us straight back in order again of what I'm trying to say: if one's speaking, let the spirit of the prophets be subject to the prophet. Do you understand? Now, let those who have a ministry to the Body of Christ... And now It's being said, now let it be done. Let those who have a ministry to the Body of Christ wait on their ministry, because it is a ministry from Christ to the church. But you can't all minister the same time, there's got to be one at a time.

35 The Branham Tabernacle shall be like this. Let those who speak with tongues, and those who interpret tongues, and those have prophecy that's to be given to the church, let them come among themselves early in the... before the meeting starts, let them gather in an appointed room, and wait on the ministry of the Lord.

36 As the pastor has to do himself before he comes into the audience; he must take the Bible, study in the quietness of his room, in the Spirit, and be anointed to come out before the audience to speak. If he doesn't, he's going to be confused when he gets out there. (Let each man and each woman, with a spiritual gift, come before the Lord.) And

being that the pastor has a single ministry, he is a prophet; the English word, a preacher, means "a prophet," that's a forth-teller of the Word.

37 Let those who have ministries that has to be part of someone else, like one to speak with tongues and another to interpret, they wait together on their ministry. They cannot stay in a private study and speak in tongues and then come tell the other one what he said, because he'd have both tongues and interpretation. See? Now, if he has that, very well, we want to receive it like that. And we want the church to benefit by these gifts that's in our church. God sent them to us, and it's... we want our church to benefit by these spiritual gifts. So let the man who speaks with tongues, and the one who interprets, and the one who prophesies, let them come together before the--the church ever meets. Let them meet in a room to themselves, waiting on the ministry of the Lord to the church. Is it understood?

38 And then, like this, if Brother Neville say... Well, now let me... Pardon, let me say this. If Brother Collins speaks with tongues and Brother Hickerson gives the interpretation, then they have a ministry together for the church. Now, that isn't the ministry of Brother Neville; that's your ministry to the church. I'm giving this as

example. Then you brethren should be just as interested in getting your ministry in the place in the house of God as the pastor is interested in getting his, because it's just essential that you do it. But you can't do it in the privacy of your own room, if you speak and you interpret, you've got to come together. Now, come together in the church, off in a room to yourself, because you have a private ministry. It's not an openly ministry, it's one that's to help the church. See? It's something to help the church, but it isn't to be done in the main congregation, only the way I'm going to tell you it is to be done. See? Then, whatever Brother Collins speaks, and Brother Hickerson gives the interpretation, as example, then let Brother somebody write this down, what it is. And then if it's coming...

39 Now, we all know that the Lord is coming, we're aware of that. And if Brother Neville got up each night and said, "Behold, the Lord is coming! Behold, the Lord is coming!" that would be all right, see. But he's saying that (the pastor) at the platform, for he's got the Word for that. And if he be a pastor, prophet to the church... or a pastor, rather, he's to study the Word of the Lord and tell you what's written in the Word of the Lord about the coming of the Lord, and you're warned by That. A ministry otherwise (to the church) which he wouldn't have any connection with, is tongues, interpretation of tongues (which is prophecy), or a prophet speaking, that's something that's not written in the Word. What's written in the Word, he's to bring it; but what's not written in the Word, is what you're to tell him. Like, for instance, "Tell Brother Wheeler, THUS SAITH THE LORD, 'Tomorrow, in his sand pit, not to go to it, because there'll be a truck turn over,'" or something like that, and it's got to be done. And you've spoke it and he's interpreted it, and then lay that on the platform after your ministry is finished. The...?... night, after the church... the hymn, and start singing and so forth; if your ministry is finished then, let them come forth with what prophecy has been given. 40 And I do not think that we have... Or if you do, put this in there. When these people meet together, let them who have wisdom first come. Because, you see, if one speaks in tongues and gives an interpretation according to Scripture, that cannot be received unless it be witnessed by two or three people, two or three more witnesses, see, has to witness to that, that they believe it to be the Word of the Lord. Because... And sometimes in these minor ministries, just like in any other ministry, you get spirits that's wrong; see, they'll fly in there. And we don't want that. No. We want these ministries ready to be exposed if they're to be exposed, because anything of God can... you don't worry about exposing it, it'll--it'll stand the test if it's of God.

41 Just like the pastor, if somebody challenges him on the Word, he don't have to back up about it, he knows just exactly what he's talking to, "Come on up here." See? And same as these other ministries, got to be the same way.

42 Now, if--if one speaks in tongues and gives a message... Now, some people speak in tongues when they're just "edifying themselves," the Bible said, they're just have a good time. They'll speak in tongues, they feel. And they do speak in tongues, they actually speak with tongues, and it's the Spirit doing it. But if it's setting out there in the audience, speaking in tongues, just edifying themselves, then it isn't any profitable thing for the church; the man's edifying himself, or the woman, or whoever's doing it. See?

43 To speak in tongues is a gift of God to edification, as Paul says in the Scripture, that it's to edify the church. So it had to be some direct message from God to the church, outside of what's wrote here in the Bible. See? It's something that...

44 If you could ask me, "Brother Branham, how must I be baptized?" I can tell you right quick. You don't have to speak in tongues and tell me that, it's wrote right here in the Bible what to do about that. See? I don't have to... you don't have to ask no questions on that and have somebody speak in tongues and tell you. See, that's already written.

45 But if you say, "Brother Branham, what must I do, I've got a decision here I've got to make whether I should take this church or go to another church," or something like that. "Or should I do this, that?" Now, that'd have to come from God. See, God has to

tell us that. But that would have to come through another ministry, 'cause the Word don't say "Let Orman Neville leave Branham Tabernacle and go to the Fort Wayne Gospel Tabernacle." See, it don't say that in the Word here, see, so that's what these gifts are for.

46 Like a person coming up here and say, "Do you believe in Divine healing?" We preach that, we believe it, we believe in anointing, the oil.

47 But here's some man says he "Can't get through, what's the matter?" Then it takes God, through tongues, interpretation, through prophecy, or some way to go down in that man's life and pull out that thing that he's done, and tell him about it. That's a ministry that doesn't belong to the pastor, it belongs to these ministering gifts, but they're not to be done out there in the audience. See?

48 Now, Paul never one time had to tell those--tell those Ephesian church anything about that, they were in order, the Roman church, or none of those other churches; only the Corinthian church, and they never could get themselves... Now, Paul believed in speaking in tongues. He had speaking in tongues in the Ephesian church, the same as he did in the Corinthian church, see, but he could speak to the Ephesians greater things than what just speaking in tongues, interpreting of tongues.

49 Now, then if someone writes a message that's been given in tongues or given in prophecy, and lay it up on the platform, it must be read by the pastor before the

service starts, of "THUS SAITH THE LORD" from these people who spoke and interpreted. And if that comes to pass exactly the way the interpretation said, we'd raise our hands and give thanks to God for His Spirit among us. If it doesn't come to pass, then don't do it any more till that evil spirit's out of you. God don't lie, He's always truth.

50 Then, you see, you're old enough now to act like men, not children ("goo, goo, goo"), you got to have some meaning to something.

51 Let the church now, as it's coming in order, come to this order. If one prophesies... If one come among you, unlearned, and you speak in tongues, you'll be a Barbarian to him, he don't know what you're talking about. See? And really in this day where there's been so much confusion about it, it causes a stumbling block. But let one speak in tongues, and another interpret and give the message, and let it be read off right here at the platform, of what's going to take place, and then let it happen, you see what happens. Tell them that "Tomorrow at a certain time, or next week at a certain time, it's going to be a certain thing," and then let the unbeliever setting there listen to that and see it's foretold before it happens. Then they'll know what kind of spirit's among you, it'll be God's Spirit. That's what Paul said, "Then if one can prophesy and reveal the

secret things, won't the whole congregation fall down, or the unbeliever, and say, 'God is in the midst of you?'" See? Because it cannot be...

52 But now we don't want... "When we was a child," Paul said, "I acted like a child," he told the Corinthians there, "I spoke like a child." He had a child mind. "But when I become an adult, I put childish things away."

53 Now, I'm telling you all, see. Now, a few years ago, you were children with these gifts, playing back and forth. But you've been to a long school now, it's time to be men, not use these just to play with. These gifts are sacred, they're of God, and you don't play with them. Let's let God use them. That's what your ministry wants to be. That's the way to put the Branham Tabernacle into service. And--and if this is questioned, anytime, let this tape stand as a witness that that's the way it's to be done in the Branham Tabernacle.

54 If there would be a stranger come in, cause you have them all the time, because this being an interdenominational tabernacle, there's people come in that doesn't have this well training, they don't have it, they know no better. And their own pastor, they'll jump right up and break his message up, and tear a altar call up, and speak in tongues and everything like that. You're a better trained men than that. See? Then after the service, if he gets unruly, then it's the deacon's place to go to them. Don't let your pastor have to do it unless it comes to a spot where there's no deacon here, but a deacon is supposed to see to that. See?

55 Now, after the service... If the person just raises up and gives a message, the pastor if he wants to stop just a minute and go ahead, very well, see, that's up to the pastor. But then immediately let the deacon, before that person gets out of the building, take them to one side and talk to them about it. And if they question it, bring them to this tape and say, "This is what the bishop or the overseer of the church..." Which is bishop, the... any overseer. See, that's what it's called in the Bible, "bishopsric," see, so that's general overseer of the church. Let... "This is the orders and the way our church does it. Now, we love for you to come give your message. But if you've got a message from the Lord and it's... let it be given, come up here and lay it on the platform, and our minister will read it to the congregation, a message to this congregation." But it must not be just repeating Scriptures, and things like that. It must be a direct message to the people, of something that's fixing to take place, or something they should do. Is it understood? All right.

55a Now, is there any better way to keep order in the church than to keep reminding the people with a--a repeat from the deacons accordingly?

No, that, I just explained that. That's question number three.

56 The deacons, your duty is to keep order in the church, with kindness and friendliness. And then you are supposed to, if someone gets out of order in the church, or comes in here like a drunk, or somebody come in.

57 Like they shot that minister out of the platform the other night up there. You heard about that, that drunk coming in with a double-barreled shotgun. He screamed for his wife, and--and wanted his wife, and went up towards the pastor. And the pastor showed him his wife setting there, but he was going to shoot her right in the church, and the pastor started to dealing with him. And instead of--instead of... The--the man with the shotgun turned around and shot the pastor out of the pulpit, and then shot his wife, and then shot himself.

58 Now, if there'd been a bunch of deacons there when that man entered that door with that shotgun, they'd have had their arms around him and the shotgun out of his hand. See? See, that's--that's orderly deacons. And now, these things have gone the way they're doing now and you might just expect anything. But, remember, the deacons are God's policemen in the house of God, no matter what anybody else thinks. Sometimes a policeman want not to have to go up and make an arrest on somebody, maybe one of his friends, but he's sworn to an office, he's got to do it anyhow. That's his duty to his city. See?

59 That's the duty of a deacon to the church. And if someone jumps up and starts interrupting the pastor, or something other like that, and the pastor in his message, the deacons supposed to walk up to them people, two or three of them, say, "Could we speak to you, brother?" See? Bring him from the church, out into the office, in here

or some other office, and speak to him about it, saying, "You're not to interrupt." You know, it's a--it's a great fine by the law to interrupt a service anyhow. See? But some people, such as a delinquent person or something, come among you, you know, and--and some religious fanatic, and--and start carrying on, then the deacons... And if the deacons don't seem to be able to control it, then the trustee board or anyone else in the church can step up and give help to such a person. You know that.

60 And--and now let me ask the question again here.

Is there any better way to keep order in the church than to remind the people with a repeat from the deacons, now, occasionally?

61 Now I think that the--the pastor, ever so often... Or play this tape, let that stand for a witness. Deacons are policemen, and their word is law and order. See? And they have the authority from the church and even from the laws of the nation to make that house

of God be the right place. And anyone to contrary a deacon like that, is subject to--to two to ten years in federal prison. If you tell them to go and they don't do it, or something like that, somebody with disorderly conduct, he just don't know what he's doing to... He's subjecting himself, allotting himself to all kinds of fines, anything.

62 And then if it comes to the spot that somebody... Now, like... And if somebody jumps up and gets disorderly... Just maybe speak in tongues or something, I wouldn't go in on that. See, let them go, 'cause if they're a stranger. If they're our own people, then just let... The next night, you deacons just get this tape, and say, "Now, we're going to play the order of the church before we start the service, I want everybody to understand it." And you pastors and you all can work together like that.

62a Now, Brother Branham, what about the Sunday school? Brother Branham, about the Sunday school (all right), should it be before the preaching service?

63 Yes, we've always had it that way. Have the Sunday school before the preaching service. And that gives a chance for the little fellows who attend Sunday school, to dismiss their classes. And if--and if they want... and the little fellows don't understand it, and they have to set all the way through the preaching service and then have Sunday school, the little fellows are wore out. Let the Sunday school be first, have a set time, just at one set time that Sunday school goes to session. Sunday school superintendent is supposed to see to that, that that Sunday school goes to session at a certain time, set time. And it's dismissed at a certain time. All the Sunday school, allow so much time for that, and then dismiss.

63a Should the teacher for the adult class be someone other than the pastor?

64 If it's so agreed. If the pastor wants to teach the Sunday school and then bring the message later, that's fine and dandy if he wants to do the double service. But if he doesn't, then have your adult Sunday school teacher, see, for your adult class. And

then if--if the pastor has somebody else there in mind, and the person wants to do it, give yourself thirty minutes, or whatever you're going to allow your Sunday school for, thirty or thirty-five, forty minutes, whatever it is.

65 And there should be a bell set here. And when that bell is tapped, that means... or either the church bell, when it taps on the outside, that's dismissing Sunday school. And when that bell rings, that means everything come to order right there.

66 There be so much time then for a hymn or two, whatever you're going to sing. Not too much time, you'll wear the people out by keeping them too long, see. And just tap the bell, have a hymn and whatever you're going to do, and then send your classes to the place. And immediately when that time comes, say it's going to be at--at ten o'clock, or ten-thirty, or ten-fifteen, whatever it is, tap that bell and every teacher dismisses their class, come to the audience out here. And then... And give the report, Sunday school report, and then dismiss the whole thing, and let all that wants to stay for preaching service be next. See, then it's in order.

66a Question? How many... [Someone asks Brother Branham, "Then we have a split class, in other words?"--Ed.]

67 Oh, yes, you should have. A--a three-year-old can't understand what a fourteen-year-old would understand. I think I got that a little farther.

67a How many classes should there be?

68 You should put your classes in... Like a little bitty class that wants to have flannelgraph, that's too much for a fourteen-year-old boy or girl. See? You should have someone to take a class for those little babies, some old mother or something who knows how to take care of them. Other classes, I think, should be somebody who's more able to present the Word. See? And there should be classes. To say now, there'd be like a class of from... At least three classes.

69 There should be a little bitty baby class, there should be from about five years old. And all the others under that should be kept with the mother, and taken to the nursery if it's necessary during the time of--of the preaching, if they go to carrying on. That's what the nursery's out there for.

70 And I think that the--the classes should be arranged from like the little babies about five or six years old, up to eight or nine, ten, something like that. And then from ten years old on to fifteen should be in the--the teenage class. And then the adult class over the fifteen, 'cause they... if they're old enough to--to... nowadays they can get a job and they're wanting to vote at that age, almost; so they--they should be able to hear the Word, but come out in the main auditorium and have that.

70a Who should be the teachers?

71 There you are, that's up to you to vote your own teachers in. And you ought to do that, put them in there, get somebody. And meet with the church, and say,

"Who's... Who here feels led of the Lord?" And then get a qualified teacher. And then let it be done. It's got to be strictly business, brethren. If the teacher can't qualify to it, then change teachers.

72 When the time comes, as under God, if I feel like that Orman Neville can't no more qualify to be pastor here, I'm going to mention it to the church. When I'd see one thing here, think that you deacons couldn't qualify to be deacons, I'm going to mention it to the church, that, "I find out there's a certain deacon out here doing something he shouldn't do, and he doesn't keep his post of duty," and so forth like that, or a trustee or

whatever it is. I can't vote it in or out, the church has to do that, but I'm certainly going to present it before the church. See, because that's what it should do. That's what I'm supposed to be as overseer, I'm supposed to look and see what's going on. We're going to Heaven, not out here somewhere to a rally or something to have a lot of fun and run over one another, and play baseball. We're here handling the most gracious thing there is on earth, the Word of God, and it's to be carried on in godly order.

72a Who should be the teachers?

73 That's up to you to select them. But I would take, for the babies, I'd take an old woman, some that can do that. But for the teen-agers, I'd take some teacher that's strict, and not just going out here and having wiener roasts. That'd be all right if they want to go on a wiener roast, but just put all the thing to that... Put it to the Word, let somebody who is able to hold the Word. And it's going to be, this church stands not for... Wiener roast is all right, and--and little picnics that you want to go together and fellowship, that's fine, that--that's what you should do to entertain the children. But in this place in here, this is the Word of God. Wiener roast is when you get together, or something like that, but not in this house of God. And these know, of course we know we don't believe in this here foolishness of--of--of parties and everything like that around here, we--we... you know better than that.

73a Who should be over the Sunday school to keep it in order?

74 The Sunday school superintendent. And that's what his business is. He's not supposed to have anything to do with the deacons, trustees, pastors, or nobody else, he's got a office of his own. Whoever your Sunday school teacher is, I know not. But that Sunday school teacher is supposed to see that every class is in its place, and every teacher is present, or substitute another teacher for that teacher if they're not there on that day.

75 Then just before the Sunday... While the--the lessons are going on, the Sunday school superintendent is to go by and take up the offerings that they've had in there (the Sunday school collections), and the report of how many present, how many

Bibles they had in this class, and so forth, and make a report of it. And then stand before the audience just before the preaching service, when he's given a spot to do it, when they have the Sunday school report after the Sunday school is over, tell how many teachers, how many present, and how many of the whole Sunday school total, the whole--whole total of offerings, and so forth like that. Deacons, trustees, pastors, are not supposed to do that. They have nothing to do into it, that is the Sunday school superintendent's job.

76 And then if he sees that the Sunday school needs certain things, then he is to present that to the--to the trustee board, and the trustees has a meeting upon it, first. And then the trustees, if they find that there is sufficient funds and so forth, through the treasurer, then this can be purchased; if he wants something another for literature, or whatever it is, or some Bibles or something, they want to buy a Bible for the one, you know, that can find the most words and quote the most Scriptures, some prize or something they're going to give away like that, present, and they want to buy it through the church. Then let that be presented to the--to the--to the--the deacons... and then let them find out if it's--if it's--if it's in the treasury. See?

77 And then I think that takes care of them five questions on that.

77a Now on the next one, is:

Brother Branham, in respect to the order of the church, we have tried to go accordingly to the way we understand the orders given in the dedication of the new church. And by doing so, some have gotten mad and left the church. And others will not listen to anything we say, especially the children. We have talked to the parents about their children, and they won't take care of them. Now, have we misunderstood? Or, are we going about it in the wrong way? Thanks.

77b Now let me answer this as they come down.

In respect to the order of the church, we have tried to go accordingly to the way we understood it given in the dedication of the new church.

78 Now, that's correct, you're doing right. Now, this is supposed to be deacons, I suppose, 'cause it's right here at the deacon's job. All right.

78a And by doing so, we have often... people has often gotten mad at us.

79 They do at me, too! They'll do at any man. See? A person that does that, there's something wrong with that person. They're not right with God, for the Spirit of Christ is subject to Christ's teaching, Christ's house, Christ's order. See? And any man that... or any woman, or any persons, children, that would get angry with a godly deacon that would tell them to be... and, or any parent would get angry with a deacon... Really, we want everybody in this church that we can get; but if that would only cause trouble somewhere else, there's a thorn or "a rabbit in the woodpile," as we used to say. That person isn't right.

80 If they leave, there's only one thing to do: let them go, and pray for them. See? Then maybe some of the deacons go to their church... or go to their house sometime, and find out why they left, and ask them what was wrong. Then, and if they... See if he can reconcile them. If they can't, then take two or three witnesses with him, that they might be understood. Then if they can't be understood, then it's told before the church if they are a member here of the church. Then they are...

81 And then if they're not members of the church, course they're not members of this congregation, they should be made to be ruly. See, they--they've got to listen to our orders here, because this is the orders of the church. This is things we don't want to do, things that I don't like to do, but it's things that must be done. And I'm exposing myself in telling here by this tape, it's me, they can hear me talking and know that it's me, not you men. You've asked me these questions, and I'm giving it to you the best that I know how from the Word of God.

82 "Now, if those people get angry and go out from you, what does the Scripture say about it, Brother Branham?"

83 "They went out from us because they wasn't of us." And that settles it. "Left the church," that's what they did. All right.

83a Others will not listen to anything we say, especially the children.

84 The children are supposed to know discipline, they should get it at home. But even if it's mine, my kids get in here at anytime, they get disorderly, I don't want you to draw one string; Sarah, Rebekah, Joseph, Billy, or whoever it might be. You tell me, I'll see to it. If they can't behave, then they'll stay away from church till they do learn to behave. This is not an arena, this is the house of God. This is not a place to play, and skate, and write notes, and laugh, and cut up, this is the house of God, and is to be carried out godly.

85 You come here to worship, not even to visit. This is not a--this is not a picnic ground, this is not a visitation place; this is the visitation place of the Holy Spirit, listen to what He has to say, not to one another. We don't come here to--to fellowship with one another, we come here to fellowship with Christ. This is the house of worship. And children must be disciplined, and if they are... of by the parents. Let it be known! That if these deacons... If these parents of the children will not listen to what these deacons said, then this parent should be corrected themselves.

85a We have talked to the parents about their children, and they won't take care of them.

86 If they are members of this church, then you should take two or three with you and call that parent into a private meeting, into one of the offices. I don't care who it is, if it's me, if it's Brother Neville, if it's Billy Paul and his little boy, if it's Brother Collins and one of his children, or any of the rest of you. We are... We love one

another, but we're duty bound to God and this Word. If it's Doc, no matter who it is, we're to call one another in and be honest with one another. How can God ever deal with us, if we're not honest with one another? How we going to be honest with Him? See?

87 This is an order, we must keep the house of God! And deacons are supposed to know how to do that. See? And that's why I'm telling you now to keep them things caught up. And if this, you tell the parents and they won't listen to this, won't listen to it, then you get you another deacon or one of the trustees, or some good person of this church, and call... take your trus-... Take your deacon board, all your deacons together, say, "Brother Jones, Brother Henderson, Brother Jackson," or whoever it might be, "their children are disbehaving, and we've told them two or three times about their children and they won't listen."

88 Then call Brother Jones in, or Brother Whoever-it-is, and say, "Brother Jones, we've called you in here for a meeting. We love you, and we... you're a part of us, you're one of us. Let me just set this certain tape and listen what Brother Branham said about it, see. Now, we've asked you to make those children behave. See? If they won't behave, and you can't make them behave in church, leave them with someone while you come to church until they learn how to behave themselves in the house of God." See? But this is an order, it's got to be carried out! See?

88a Now, the other question goes on.

Now, have we misunderstood?

89 No, sir. You haven't misunderstood, that's correct. I'm saying it again, the orders. In the army, they don't ask you, "Will you go do a certain thing?" If you're in the army, you're compelled to do it. See? And that's the way it is in the... I'm compelled to preach the Gospel. I'm compelled to stand for This regardless of what my other men and brethren and so forth say about It, I'm compelled to do this. I have to hurt feelings and cut men to pieces, but if I...

90 You don't want to get like Oswald. See? If you can't disagree with a man and things, then shake his hand and still have the same feelings towards him, then there's something wrong with you. If I can't disagree with a man (bitterly, from one side to the other) and still think as much of him as--as Christ would, then there's something wrong with my spirit, I haven't the Spirit of Christ. See?

91 If he says, "Well, Brother Branham, I--I believe that your teaching is this, that."

92 "All right, brother, let's come together to reason, you and I. We'll take it ourselves. We'll go over here in the room to ourselves, we'll reason it out." And he just cuts me to pieces, and I have to say things back to him. If in my heart I can't feel the same about him, that "he's still my brother and I'm trying to help him," then I'll never help him, there's no way for me to help him. If I don't love him, what's the use of

going over

there? Tell him, "The first place first, Brother, I don't love you, and let me get that out of my heart right here before we go in there, because I can't help you until I love you."

93 And that's right, and that's the way. See, carry it on, you've done it exactly right, that's the way it should be. You never misunderstood it.

93a Are we going about it the wrong way?

94 No, it is the right way to carry that. Let order be kept! Because it's constantly... Now, little children and mothers, little babies and things, they--they'll cry, and if they get crying too much and interrupting your pastor up there, remember, you are his bodyguards, you're his Gospel bodyguards. See? And if it's interrupting the message of the Lord, then you are deacons, what are you to do? Just like a man speaking in tongues, he's duty bound. And a man preaching, he's duty bound to the Word, he's duty bound to these things. Each one of you is duty bound to an office, and that's--and that's just what we're--we're here to do.

95 Now, we don't want to wait too long, and I know I got an appointment in a few minutes, so I'll--I'll just try to hurry as quick as I can.

95a Brother Branham...

There's three, two questions on this card here.

Brother Branham, what should be the policy of taking up offerings in the church for people? How should this be done?

96 I think taking up offerings in the church for people should not be done unless it's for your pastor. And I think if someone comes in for charity, or something like that that... Or someone in--in bad need, like one of our members here or congregation, say if one of our brothers, and they had some trouble; well, I think then that should be announced at the platform, and let the pastor do that, I think it's his duty to do that; some brother that's in need of something, let him present it to the church, if it wants to be taken that way.

97 If it's someone in need and--and then you don't want to take the offering up for the person that's in need, then let the boards meet together and agree upon certain sums that they want to give to this person out of the treasury. But if the treasury is low at that time and they can't afford to do it, then it has to be taken up, well, let--let the... let it be talked with the board, giving orders to the pastor, and let the pastor ask for this certain thing. Say, "Now, tonight, our Brother Jones, he had a--a horrible accident, his house burned down. And tonight, as Christians, we're going together, to each one of us make a pledge of what we can do to help Brother Jones back with his house again." See, or--or whatever it is. See, we--we'll do that. Let that be said from the platform, that's the

way to do that. And then let the pledges be give in, and then give it over to the treasurer of the church. And these pledges be paid through the treasurer of the church, and give to them. And--and give the person a receipt for it, 'cause I don't know whether that's tax redemption or not; I guess it is for something like that.

98 Now, but when it comes to like a--a stranger come in, a stranger come in like he's... A man comes in and says, "Well, you know what? I--I--I'm on a journey and I--I blew out a tire, and I want a new tire. Take me up an offering tonight for a new tire." Now, that shouldn't be done. No, that should not be done. And if it seems to--if it seems to be a worthy thing, of somebody that you know, the board could meet and designate a certain amount of money from the treasurer to buy that man a tire or whatever it was. Or either if the church treasury is low, and it's decided by the board that these... The pastor shouldn't have nothing to do in this, the--the deacons is supposed to do this, see, or the boards. And now if this... If it's agreed, then give to the pastor, the pastor can take the offering. But, notice, if it's a stranger, it's in an emergency, a fellow needs a little money and you feel that it's for a just cause, (now this is my opinion), if it's for a real just cause and you know it is for a just cause...

99 Now, first, if you go up there and look on my books at the house, of people coming by and say, "I'm Reverend So-and-so from this certain-certain church, and I--I had some trouble down the road here, and I--I need a set of tires," and knowed that I just come in from the meeting and had an offering, or something another like that, I'd give it to him, nearly, to go get a set of tires. And look in the minutes, there never was such a minister as that, never lived in such a place. And there is ten or twenty thousand dollars on the books from these years that I've give out like that, never know nothing about them where they was. Come to find out, other ministers say, "Why, he made me for so-and-so and so-and-such."

100 Now, the church is not responsible, only for their own. That's right. Their own, they're responsible.

101 But if there seems to be a worthy cause, and then if you--if you trustees might say, "Well, now wait a minute. This man, there is his car down there, that's his (did happen), and this. It's not of our congregation, see, but it is." Then if they want to do it like that, and would say something special about an outsider...

102 Not our own, now, see, not our own people, our own people be taken up right here among their--their own, their brothers here, see.

103 But if it's somebody on the outside, and a fellow says he's hungry or... and somebody wants to reach down in his pocket and give him some charity, that's up to you, but I'm talking about from the church. And then if the church people are asked to donate, then...

104 Now, if you got an evangelist, of course, in here preaching, then you take...

you... that's understood before he comes, you know, that you'll give him an offering, or pay him salary, or whatever he wants to do.

105 But then if this person is here, and it's for a just cause, and the pastor... and the board would want to agree and tell the pastor upon it, then let the pastor say, "A certain-certain person is setting here, we don't know the man, he come in and he asked us for... he says his children are hungry. We haven't got the time... we haven't had the time to investigate the--the--the--the--the claim." See?

106 If there's anything like that, then our--our... If there's anything among our own, our--our own deacons go investigate those claims. See? And then if it's worthy, then do it. If it isn't worthy, don't do it, don't have to. But now if it's a man here, you--you--you let the pastor say, "Now, the trustee board told me they did not know this person. But the man is sitting here, he says his name is Jim Jones," or whatever it might be, "and he's sitting right here. 'Would you stand up, Mr. Jones? Now, Mr. Jones, at the end of the service, you stand just at the back door there, as you go out.' And if any people feel in your heart, or anything that you want to do for this man, give it to him as you go out." Is that understood, now?

107 Did you get that on your... To those who are on the tape... And one of the... Brother Collins missed it on his tape. I want to reinstate that quotation again if... 'cause he's one of the deacons.

108 If--if there be any of this, one man comes in that you... and is in emergency and he wants an offering from the church, let the trustees or deacons meet together, and let the... meet together, and make the decision, then tell the pastor that it might be done like this. Let them... Let the pastor say that "This certain man," call him by name, "and we know him not. And our policy here is to investigate before we take offerings for people, and, that is, of our own. But this man here, he says he's broke down, he's had an emergency, he's got sick children, he's trying to get medicine for his children," or whatever it might be, the emergency. "Now, he's standing right here, 'Would you stand up, sir?'" See, and let him stand up. And say, "Now you people see what... who he is.

Now, at the close of this service this man shall stand there at the front door, and people going out, that feel that you want to contribute to this, you're at liberty; we only announced it in the church." You're not sanctioning it, you're only announcing it. See, that's hospitality to a stranger. See? Understand now? All right.

109 I think that settles that question.

109a What about the tapes? Now has: What about the tapes? It's got a question mark. As, many are writing the office and blaming you for the action on the tapes. Also, about others around the church selling tapes, if Mr. Maguire has to pay royalties on them.

110 All right. The tapes is by a contract. And if I... I don't know just exactly when the contract is expired, but the trustees, this belongs to the trustees; not the deacons, the trustees; not the pastor, trustees. The trustees, ever so often, they--they write a contract, as I understand it. And if this--this is wrong, then the trustees correct. These trustees has an agreement with the person who is making the tapes, and the tapes are by franchise.

111 No one else can make tapes unless it be permitted by the person that has the franchise, and they cannot be sold unless permitted by the person that has the franchise, because that's the law, see, that the franchise holds it. See? And if the fran... the one who holds the franchise wants to let So-and-so make tapes, that's up to him. If he wants to let everybody make tapes, that's up to him; he wants everybody to sell tapes, that's up to the person who owns the franchise. He should have a--a little written note signed from the holder of the franchise, to make and sell tapes, because then he's clear of the law; 'cause if he don't, the man that has the franchise on it... You'd be liable-ing yourself to a... If there'd be a--a foul person that wanted to cause some trouble, he could really do it. You go over that franchise... 'cause that's just like a copyright, see, the same thing, you're not allowed to do it. It's a great fine to do that.

112 So if the people are making tapes, perhaps they have an agreement from Mr. Maguire who--who has... who--who draws royalties on the tapes. And now... and I don't know about that, 'cause I'm not here enough with you to know who these things are, and who it would be referring to. I suppose that Mr. Maguire still has it, because out there, I'm in California or Arizona, where I'm at, I understand they're still buying tapes from California. Brother Sothmann, the father-in-law of Mr. Maguire, which is our brother here in the church. I think that Mr. Maguire still has it, the--the franchise on it.

113 And now, there has been complaints all along on the making of the tapes. Now, when there is a complaint on anything pertaining to the finances of this church, it's duty bound to the trustees to see that thing is cleared. See? There should not, by any means, be anything.

113a Now you see here, it says on this card here, that. They're writing to the office and blaming you.

114 Frankly, I've had many letters on it, and want to know why they can't get their tapes. Now you know your contract with the one who has the franchise, as I understood... The tapes, I--I want nothing to do with them, myself, if anybody can use the tape for furthering the Gospel, "Amen!"

115 But, first, Brother Roberson and them started to make them, Brother Beeler and several of them started to make them; and then the two boys, Brother Mercier and Brother Goad, made them for years; and, of course, when each one of the man has

made them, there has been complaints on every one. But, it seemingly here lately, there's been a great complaint about not getting their tapes. People has called me up from across the country. And then another, being, re-tracked tapes. They'll be playing one thing one minute, and play back on another another thing, and then you can't even understand what they are.

116 Now, these people paying for these tapes should get a genuine tape. I don't care what they have to do to get it, we want to see our customers and our brothers (which they are our customers and our brothers), so forth, they must have an "A-number-1" tape. Now, you trustees see to that, that these people are satisfied. If not satisfied, their money must be returned to them immediately.

117 And someone's called me, and say they been waiting for months for tapes. Now, I don't know how Brother Maguire tends to this. I--I don't know about that, as I know nothing about it. And I... It's none of my business to know nothing about that, it's his business with them and the trustees. And I'm not trying to step in, but I'm just telling you what the law of it is. See? The law of it is that these tapes, from the time that they send for them, them tapes are supposed to be on their road within a day or two, three or four, five days; after they send for them tapes, it's got to be in the mail or the franchise can be cancelled at any time when these orders are disobeyed. See?

118 Now, and every six months or a year, this is supposed to be renewed, this agreement is supposed to be renewed. You're supposed to meet on this certain date that this franchise says that you've got to meet. And then it's supposed to be, that's, other people are supposed to come in at that time, and you're supposed to notify others who have been asking about the tapes, and come in with their agreement and set down and talk it over.

119 Now, these orders must be carried out! See? And it must be carried right, because it is complaining. They complained with Leo and Gene, they complained with every one, it's complain with Brother Maguire, and it'll be complain with somebody else, but let's find out what their complaining is.

120 Now, but when the tapes are begin to pile up, boxes of them, letters by the dozens pouring in, and they... See, it doesn't fall back to the tape maker, it falls on me. They're always bawling me out about it. Now, it's my duty as a Christian to see that the people get what they pay for, and I want you trustees to see that they get it. If they have to charge more, get a better tape, get a better machine, we want somebody to make that tape who makes it right. That's our interest. The tape must be made right! And the customer must be satisfied, or stop the whole tape thing altogether, we won't have no tapes, just let anybody make them that wants to. But if they're going to

charge for them, let them see that they get what they paid for, 'cause that's Christianity. That's no more than do...

121 And when they come here to listen to the Gospel, I want to give them the best that I know how to give them, see, and when they come here I want you to see that everybody and everything's carried on. That's the reason I'm telling you deacons, trustees, and pastors, here tonight, that you must carry this out to the letter, because the people are coming here to find God, and we got to have these things in order.

122 And also the tapes must be put into their place. If they have to charge more, if they got second-class tapes they're running, then get better tapes. If they have to charge more for them, charge more for them, let the person get what they charge for.

123 I'm not interested in one bit of royalty, not one penny, and neither is the tabernacle interested; I don't want you to be. Don't be interested in that, in--in royalties. If they'd pay some, I guess you'd have to take a little royalty on account of they're being made here. I think that's something that he said to Mr. Miller and them about the law, we have to take certain royalties or so forth. That's up to you all to see to that. I'm not have nothing to do with what... That's set together; you all take care of that. I can't take care of all of it, I'm just telling you the way it should be and must be run. That... And you understood, I said "must be run." So we want this run out right.

124 And if you have to have a better machine to take it, then get a better machine. If it has to be... Now, I said to them, I said, "Every meet-... mission that I go into the field, before I go, I'll notify you what sermons I'm going to preach on out there, something that I've already..." And I promised you all, which I'm going to retape back again Sunday night, that "Before I preach any new message, it would come from this tabernacle first, because they seem to get a better recording." You remember that? Then when I come here to preach my messages, then go back out and notify the tape man what services. They ask me, "What ones? What you going to preach?" I told him,

"this night I will on so-and-so, and this night on so-and-so," so they can have it made up and ready for the customer to get it right there; got it right with them, a better tape than they'd have out in the meeting, because it's made right here at the tabernacle where

the acoustics are good. See?

125 Now, now I'm going into this great evangelistic, what I'm going to do now in overseas and things, I can't promise that, you see, I can't promise that I'll preach my first message here. Because when you preach around, the messages, you've got to have something that... It--it gets stale in you, and it's bound to get stale to the ones that's listening at it. You've got to do something different, you see, and bring just as the Message is there. But let them put a machine in the field, or whatever it is, that'll

take these tapes perfectly.

126 And make a perfect tape, and each tape played back and checked before it goes, or just stop the whole thing; don't even have nothing to do with it, let every man make his own tape. See? But get it done right, see, so that this complaint will stop. We don't want no complaints at all. If there is a complaint, let's take care of it, then we'd have it over with.

127 Now, I'll hurry just as quick as I can. Billy got about two more questions here, or three, then we'll be finished.

127a How far, Brother Branham, can or should a deacon go to keep order in the church? Should we keep the order or wait until Brother Neville tells us what we should do?

128 That isn't Brother Neville's job, that's your job. See? You don't tell Brother Neville what to preach on, how to preach it. See, that's your job, you deacons, you're supposed to do that. You take care of that. That's nothing to Brother Neville, that's your job. See?

129 Now, if a policeman's out here on the street and he sees a man stealing property out of a back of a car, should he call the mayor and say, "Now, Mayor, your Honor, sir, I am working for you here on this police force. Now, I find a man up the street here, he's--he was stealing some tires off of a car last night. Now, I just wonder, what's your opinion of that?" Huh! See? See, that wouldn't be sensible. Would it? No, sir. If he was doing something wrong, arrest him.

130 And if a man's doing something wrong here in the church, or anybody, stop them, talk to them. Don't be arrogant; but if they won't listen, speak in a way that they know what you're saying. See? See, like you tell a child, say, "Walk back there," and he's misbehaving. Deacons, stay at your place! Put... There's four of you, stay two in front and two in the back, on these corners or somewhere like that. And watch real close, for renegades and everything else come in like this, you see. And you be on the guard, and you get to your post of duty and stay there, that's your seat; or stand right beside a wall and watch everybody come in.

131 A deacon takes care of the house of God. Someone come in, speak to them; be there to greet them, shake their hand. That's, you're the policeman, "Could we show you the cloak room?" or "Would you be seated?" "Could we hand you a songbook or something?" or "Now we would like for you to enjoy yourself here, and--and pray, and--and we're happy you're here with us tonight." Lead them right down to a place, and say, "Would you like to be closer or would you like to be back here?" or wherever more. That's hospitality.

132 A policeman (or the deacon) is a military police to the army, courtesy, but yet with authority. See? You know what a military police is, is actually, if he carries out

his rights, I think he's just like a chaplain. You see? It's courtesy and everything, but yet he has an authority. See, you must mind him. See, he puts... These rookies get out there and get drunk, why, he puts them in their place. And so is the deacon to put them in their place.

133 Now, remember, the deacon is a policeman, and a deacon's office is actually more strict than most any office in the church. I don't know of an office any more strict than the deacon's office. That's right, because he's got a--he's got a real job, and he's God's man. He's God's man just as much as the pastor is God's man. Certainly, he is. He is God's servant.

134 Now the trustees, only thing, they're under duty by God to watch that finances and take care of that, the things that goes on like that. I told you about them tapes, and--and about other things here that goes on, about the building and repairs, and taking up the finances and things, that's--that's what they're trustee of: the property, finances and things. The deacons has nothing to do in that. And neither does the--the trustee have anything to do with the deacons' office.

135 Now, if the deacons wants to ask the trustee's help on anything, or--or the trustees the deacon's, and you're all working together... But that's your duties, is singling out. See? All right.

136 Now, no, don't ask Brother Neville. If Brother Neville asks you to do something, then that's--that's your pastor, with courtesy and love and everything... If he'd say, "Brother Collins, Brother Hickerson, Brother Tony, or somebody, would you see what's wrong back there in the corner?" At the post of duty like that, you know, as a real man of God.

137 Remember, you are not working for Branham Tabernacle, neither are you working for Brother Neville or me, you're working for Jesus Christ. See? You... That's who you do it... And He--He's respecting your loyalty just the same as He is to that pastor or to anybody else, He's expecting your loyalty! And we want to show our loyalty.

138 Now, sometimes it gets hard. It's hard for me to see a minister setting there I love with all my heart, just have to really tell him; see, but in a way of love, I've got a hand out to help him. But, see, and they come to me and say, "Brother Branham, you're just a wonderful person, why can't you just compromise a little on that baptism, and on this, that, and the other, that security, and the serpent's seed?"

139 I say, "Brother, I love you, but now let's just take... let's take the Scripture and see who's right or wrong." See, I've got to be able to...

140 "Oh, now, Brother Branham, I tell you, you're all wrong." See, goes flying up.

141 "Oh," I say, "well, perhaps I am. Then, if I am, surely you'd tell me, you're..."

You know where I'm wrong at, then you show me where I'm wrong." And I'm willing to take, see.

142 Same thing, "Hey, you ain't got no business telling that child to set down." Now, the deacon is the--is the custodian at the house of God. See? Now if you... He takes care of the house of God and keeps it in order. Now, that's what the Scripture says, and if you got anything else that a deacon should do, you come tell me. See, there's the same thing, but that--that's your duty to do that, yeah, just back up.

143 And you should ask nobody, that's--that's just your duty. Brother Neville don't ask nobody, the church don't have to ask... I mean, the--the--the trustees don't have to go ask Brother Neville if--if he wants the roof put on the tabernacle. See? No, no, that's not nothing to Brother Neville, it's not nothing to me, that's to you. The deacons don't have to...

144 The same way to the pastor. "What are you going to preach on? I don't want you to do this." They ain't got no business saying that, he's under God, see, their pastor. And then if--if--if... Brother Neville, he preaches a message that the Lord has give us, and we're all together in this. And if I tell Brother Neville something wrong, God holds me responsible for it. That's right. See? So God is the Boss of all of it. See? And we're just working as His ambassadors, you see, down here in these offices.

144a Please...The next question, and then I think we got one more, and then we--we'll stop.

Please explain just how the gifts of tongues are to operate in our church. I have did that. When can the church be put in order as... or just where the gifts are to operate? We've just explained that.

144b Just how many c-h-r-i-s-t-m-a... Could you see what that is? [Brother Billy Paul says, "Instruments."--Ed.] Oh. Instruments. How many instruments are we to have in church besides organ and piano?

145 Well, it depends on if you had a string band or whatever you had, you see. I don't know what you got, what this means, I don't understand it. But the organ and the piano are property of the church. Now, if the song leader would take a notion to have trumpets and cornets and so forth like that, and somebody's come in the church and they play these instruments... And they're in a band, and--and then, course, then that's for your trustees, to take it up with the trustees and see if they got money to buy their instruments and so forth, or whatever like that. I guess that's what their question is.

146 But if they have their own instruments, wonderful. If they don't have their own instruments, and they're a member here of a band, not just a person running through here and plays once in a while, and runs out like that, it's got to be a band in the

church. The church wouldn't buy a--a--a trumpet for a man that plays it here and tomorrow night somewhere else, and somewhere else, and drop in once in a while and play a little bit. No, sir. It's got to be a band right here, organized band with the--the leader, and then the church, talk to them about buying the instruments.

146a Please explain just how we are to... how we deacons can keep the people just in the sanctuary before or after... Please explain. [Brother Billy Paul reads the question, "How do we keep the people quiet in the sanctuary before and after church?"--Ed.] Oh, all right.

147 I would suggest this, brethren. Now, there's a great thing. Wish we had more time to put on it, for it's--it's... it--it means something to us, see. Now, the church is not a...

148 If you was to... If you want to run this tape down some night and play it before the meetings, that the people will understand it, let this be played; just this part of the tape but no more, just this. Any part of this that you want played for a certain thing, just keep running it till you find it, and then play it. See, 'cause it's questions.

149 Now, deacons of the church, and as I--as I said, are the police of the church. But the church is not a general meetinghouse for--for fellowship and friendship and frolic. The church is a sanctuary of God! We come here... Now, if we want to meet one another, let me come to your house or you come to my house, or you go to one another's house and meet one another. But just to frolic around through the church, and talking and things like that, it's not right, brethren; we come here, we get the whole thing off of our mind. If we would come here...

150 Look the way we used to do it years ago. Sister Gertie was the pianist. When I pastored here, I--I had to be pastor, deacon, trustee, and everything else at once, see, but I--I had to do it. Now you don't have to do it that way, see, because you got men to carry this out. But when the... I had ushers, Brother Seward and all of them at the door. They had books piled around there at the door, setting in a chair, or something or another. And when someone come in, you showed them a place to hang your coat or helped them to their seat, give them a songbook and asked them to "be in prayer." And then everybody set in their seat and silently prayed until starting time. See? And then at starting time, Sister Gertie, the pianist, got up there and started the music before... when the people are--are coming together.

151 I would suggest to have your organist to get up there with some real nice music. And if she can't be here, put it on tape and then play it, or something another. And have music, real sweet sacred music going on. So... And ask people... And if people goes to talking and carrying on like that, let one of the deacons get up at the microphone up there at the desk and say, "sh, sh, sh," like that. Say, "At the tabernacle here, we--we want you to come to worship. Let's not make noise now,

listen to the music. Get your seat, set down, be reverent see, pray or read the Bible. This in the sanctuary here is where the Lord dwells. And we want everybody to be real reverent and worship, not to be running around, talking before the services. Congregate yourself, and you've come here to talk to the Lord. See? Either be in silent prayer, see, or read your Bible."

152 When I went into the Marble church up there at--at the... Norman Vincent Peale, you've heard of him, you see. And I went into... A great psychology, he's a teacher, you know. And I went into his church, I just thought that, "I wished my tabernacle would do that again." Them deacons standing right there at the door just as soon as you come in. They, of course, they hand you a Sunday school slip, taken you right down. You had to empty three times, you know, it only hold about four or five hundred, you know; and New York's a big place, and he's a popular man. And I think they had to have one class at ten o'clock and one at eleven, same sermon right over again, same service exactly, same sheet of paper. But when they dismissed, and they had (I believe) five minutes for the church to be exactly... Nobody else could come in till they got out, then the deacons opened the way and the other church filled up. They had those old box seats, you know, they go in like that, and set down in the pews where you open the door. Old fashion, it's been standing there for--for nearly two hundred years, I guess, the old Marble church has.

153 And you could have heard a pin drop anywhere in that church, and everybody in prayer for at least thirty minutes before the first note was ever hit on the organ, the prelude. And just everybody in prayer. I thought, "How wonderful it is!" Then when that minister... That prelude, about... I think they played one prelude for about three to five minutes, How Great Thou Art, or something like that, and on like that. And then when they did, everybody stopped praying and was listening to the prelude. See, it give a change, from prayer to the prelude. And then when they played that, then the choir leader directed the choir. Then they had a congregational song and the choir. And then they were ready for their Sunday school class. See? And then--and then when it was over, there was nothing went on except Divine worship, all the time, and that's what we come there for.

154 And I think it would be a good thing if our church... And I'm just saying this, we're going to do it. See? Let's do it. If somebody does anything, the thing... And I think it'd be a good thing. If it's a good thing, then let's do it. See? We don't want to put off any good thing, we'll do it, anyhow. See? And just go ahead and--and stand up there and if they start on a morning, or something like that, people visiting, just let someone, or one of the--one of the deacons, or somebody walk up there and say, "It's been made a rule in the tabernacle here..."

155 I don't know if they do it, they may--may. I'm never here, you see, I don't

know. I'm never here before services.

156 And when they come in and they start talking, let somebody get up there and say, "Sh-sh-sh, just a moment." See? Let the--let the... Get a little sister, get her up there and get her playing that music. If you don't, put it on tape and get it out there, see, of the organ music. And say, "Now we're... There's a new rule in the tabernacle. When people enter here, we're not to whisper, talk, but to worship. See? Now, just a few minutes the service will be starting. Until then, just either read your Bible or bow your head and silently pray." And a few times like that, they'll all learn. See? See?

157 You hear somebody talking, and then it gets down... for after a few times like that, after a while you hit a place where somebody say... See somebody talking, nobody else talking, you see, well, then one of the deacons walk up and say, "We--we want you to worship during the time of the service." You see? See? See, it's not a house of talk, it's a house of worship. Understand?

I think that was it. Please explain... Yeah. Let's see. Yeah. Please explain how to... the deacons should... in the sanctuary. Yeah, that's all. That's right. That's it.

157a All right, now, here's the last one.

Brother Branham, when we have had opportunities on the beginning of the service... I'm--I'm... the comp-... though we had complaints.

It's wrote real little. And a "had complaints," ain't it? [Brother Billy Paul says, "Uh-huh," and continues helping Brother Branham read the small writing--Ed.]

... had complaints in the beginning of the service. We have... Let's see. We--we--we have songs, testimonies, and prayers, and prayer requests, special singing, and m-a-... maybe get it... get into the message at eleven, to... or after, but don't have too much time for the Word. Some of the people get restless and have to leave before it is--is... before--before it's over. Is... Please explain how many songs, and what time to start the message. And some--sometime we have prayer--prayer requests and it ends up in a testimony meeting, some things that--that don't be... don't seem kind of right at the time.

158 Now, I hope I've got that. Billy is trying to help me here. Upon the tape, you have to... somebody in our midst may... meeting, in the service, listening to what this was, is Billy trying to help me read it because it's wrote very, very fine, and I couldn't make it out. I got the general idea, it is, "How many songs should we sing before starting the service, and what time should service start?"

159 Now, the first thing I want to make here is a confession. And when I'm wrong, I want to admit "I'm wrong." See? And I--and I--I'll make a confession here that "I am kind of the leader of that." Because it's been me holding these long services and things, is what got the church into this routine, see, of doing so, but it shouldn't be. And now, remember, I have... I am... Was telling you all, "Sunday night, if the Lord

willing, on Sunday night, that, I'm trying to allot my services from henceforth, if I have to stay a week extra, to about thirty or forty minutes at the longest for my services."

160 Because I have found this, that a service that's... It stands up, and the message is given in the power; if you go too far, you wear the people out and they don't get it. The reason I been giving... I knowed that all along. See? The most successful speakers are those who have exactly... Jesus was a man of few words, watch His sermons. Watch Paul's sermon on the Day of Pentecost, probably taken him fifteen minutes, and he punched the... there, something that--that--that sent three thousand souls into the Kingdom of God. See, just right straight to the spot. See?

161 And I--I am guilty. Because, the reason I have done this, not because I didn't know different, but I'm making tapes, see, and these tapes will be played in houses for hours after hours after hours. But as you will find out in the coming Sunday, the reason that I have done it, this coming Sunday, the reason I have done these things... I might say it right now on the tape. The reason that I have did this is because of this tremendous weight upon me for the Message of this hour, to get It out. Now the Message is out, now I'm taking a thirty minutes or something like that, after the first of the year, in my meetings out in the... everywhere I go, and try and even set my watch to a thirty minute, or not over forty at the most; punch to that Message, and make the altar call if I... or whatever I'm going to do, or call a prayer line; and not take that much time, because you do wear the people out. I know that.

162 But looky here. I guess, in the year, we haven't had a dozen people get up and walk out, and sometimes I keep them here for two and three hours. See? That's right. Because it's been making these tapes that goes all over the world, see. And the people out there, they'll set for hours and listen to That; and ministers, and so forth, Germany, Switzerland, Africa, Asia, and everywhere, see, listening to That.

163 But, see, for the sanctuary, for the church... And that's all right. If you're here making a tape, and you got a two-hour tape, put a two-hour message on it; but if you're not making a tape for something like that, then cut our message, see, cut our message down. I tell you why, there's some fill up easy, some fill up long, see, like that, and you got to be at a happy medium between that.

164 And now, many times that we ruin our services by a dragged out testimony meeting, which I know I'm guilty of doing it. And you get out when we used to have street meeting, and let some old brother stand out there, and he'll stand out... And ask him to offer a word of prayer, and he'll pray for the mayor of the city, and for the governor of the state, and for the President of the Union, and--and everybody like that, and all the pastors around, you know, each one by number, and Sister Jones that's in the hospital, and things like that; and the people standing, walking by on the

street meeting, just keep--just keep on walking. See? He just wore them out. Well, just a...

165 See, the main thing now, your prayer is to be in secret, your main, long prayer. Pray all... Enter into the secret closet, close the door. There's where you want to pray all day, all night, or two hours, pray there. But in here, when you've got the attention of the people, make your prayer short, quick, at it. Make all your service... And put the most of your service time into that Word. That's the main thing! Punch that Word just as hard as you can, see, get the Word to the people.

166 Now, here's my suggestion. Now, now remember, I've confessed that I'm guilty of leading this on. But then I've told you why I've led it on, I'm making two-hour tapes to be sent overseas and everywhere, of a Message, you see. But the church shouldn't pattern that (the message here at the tabernacle) after them tapes (two hours) to be gone places, see, and go out like that.

167 Now, here's what your order... Let me just give you an example. Would that be all right, a suggestion? I would say that the church should have its doors open at a certain time, let the congregation come in, let the songs be playing. And let everybody come in to worship, not to visit. And don't let them visit afterwards, tell them to "Dismiss and get out, not to visit. If you wanted to visit, there's the whole outside. But this is the sanctuary, let this be kept clean." Now, if the Spirit of the Lord is dealing here, let's keep it the Spirit of the Lord. See? And--and It'll keep moving. If you don't, you just mark my words, it's going to fall; it sure will. And let's keep it, it's our duty, that's why I'm here tonight. Just keep this thing lined up with these--with these orders.

168 Now look, I would say this. Ordinarily, unless we are giving out especially... and tell them you're going to tape a message. See? Now, if Brother Neville has a message here that he's going... he's got a message he wants to get out to the people, out on tape, or something, say, "Now, next Sunday night we're going to tape a two-hour tape," three-hour tape, or what--or whatmore. "We're going to give a two- or three-hour tape," or whatever it might be, "next Sunday night." And then the people know. And then when they come in, say, "Now, we are going to tape a message tonight. And I got a message here that it's one... I want it taped and sent out. I been... I feel led to send this message out. And it's going to be taped, it may be two hours, three hours, or whatever it is." Say that.

169 But, ordinarily, just as I do when I'm going into a place like one of them Business Man's meetings, or I'm out in my meetings out there for a prayer line. If I stood up there and give a three-hour message of a night before having the healing service, you see where it puts me? See? Why, the people, next night your congregation's half of what it was. See? Cause they just can't do it, they got to go to

work and everything.

170 I'd suggest this, that ordinarily... Now, I watched Brother Neville last night when he preached. Now, I know we all... That was a startling message. I took notes of him, got here in my pocket, to use it in other messages of my own. That's right. The Way of Escape, see, and that was a marvelous message. You see how quick he got that through? See, about thirty-five minutes, see, and he--he had it over. See? Now, that was fine. Now, and Brother Neville, usually his messages are like that. See, that's not long. See? But where you kill your meeting is all that drawn out stuff before you get to it. See?

171 Now, and--and where you do that... Now, I know, and now look, I'm not saying that dishonorly to you trustees, or deacons, or--or pastor, but I'm just telling you: see what's Truth, and this is what it must be. Now, you... What does it, now, everybody, you all, good-natured, every one of you men are good-natured. If it wasn't so, I'd say, "All but Brother So-and-so, he's not got a good nature, we're all praying for him." But you--you do have good natures, and you're long-suffering, gentle, quiet sort of men. That's fine, but don't be a sissy with that.

172 Jesus was good-natured, too, but when it come time to say things, "It's written, 'My Father's house is made a house of prayer,' and you are making it a den of thieves." See? He--He knowed when to speak and when not to. That--that--that's what we got to do. See? There never--never was a person like Jesus, He was God. And remember, He even... Talk about being a deacon in the church, He--He took over! He plaited some ropes together, and He didn't wait to gently walk them out, He beat them out, see, at the house of God. And He was playing the part of a deacon, for an example to you deacons. See, He was your example. "And now, it--it's written, 'My Father's house is made a house of prayer.'" Now, remember, Jesus was a deacon then, you know that Jesus was taking the part of a deacon.

173 When He come to the part of a pastor, what did He say? "You blind Pharisees, leaders of the blind!" See, He was taking the part of a pastor then.

174 And when He told them what was going to happen, He taken the part of a prophet. See?

175 And when they required that there must be tribute paid, He taken the part of a trustee, "Peter, go down and cast the hook into the river, and the first fish you take up has got a coin in his mouth. Pay them, see, pay your just debts." Said, too, "Give Ceasar what's Ceasar's, God's what is God's."

176 He was both pastor, prophet, trustee, and deacon. Sure was! So then you see what He did, let that be your example in the house here at this Branham Tabernacle, that we want to be a house that He'll be honored in with everything, every office, every place, that there be no taking back. There be gentleness, and sweetness, and

kindness, but just straight on the line, every man's at his post of duty. See? That's the way, that's the way He wants it. He never slagged. When it come time to say, call what was what, He called it. When it come time to show gentleness, then He showed gentleness. He was sweet, kind, understanding; but stern, and everything was right to the dot with Him, and He did that for your example. Now, the Holy Spirit just give me that. So I never thought about that, Him being a deacon, before, but He was. See? He--He acted as deacon.

177 Now I'd say this, say if your services began at seven-thirty, if that's the time, open your church half hour beforehand, seven o'clock. Let the pianist... Tell the organist... Do you pay her? You all pay the organist? Is she paid, or the pianist? She does it free-will. Ask her with gentleness. Even if she wants to have pay for it, to give her something for it, tell her we want her a half hour before service. And if she says, "Well, I can't do it," or something, complaint, then just have her come here and make a tape of some sweet organ music. You see? And let... put that on the... Don't have to be here every time, set your tape up. See? Let one of the deacons, trustees, or ever who opens, the janitor, put it on up there, the tape on, and let it be playing while the people come. See? Cause if the deacons are not here, or somebody, let a trustee or somebody be here to do it, then let them play for a half hour.

178 But exactly seven-thirty, let that bell toll on top the building. See? You still have your bell out there? Yeah. All right, let your bell toll at seven-thirty, and that means that we're not going to walk up and down the church and shake hands with Joneses and all that. Let the song leader be on the job! If there's no song leader there, let the deacons see that there... or the... see that there is somebody to start leading songs when that bell starts tolling. "Turn to your hymnbook, number so-and-so." See? Let it be right on the dot at--at seven-thirty.

179 All right, then have a congregation song, and then maybe a second congregational song, and then have somebody already spoke of, if you can, to lead in prayer. Let the--the pastor, ever... Well, the pastor shouldn't be there, the--the song leader should do that. It's Brother Capps, I think. See, he'd know what to do, let--let him have someone spoke... or either lead in prayer hisself. Have the congregation to stand in prayer, see, just stand up, and let somebody lead in prayer. Now, if you don't watch...

180 Now, we believe that everybody should come to the house of God and pray, that's the--that's the place of prayer. But when you're in that sanctuary, conserve your time. See? You call them all up around the altar, you'll find out there'll be somebody will be there for fifteen, twenty minutes, and your time's all run out.

181 Let your... see, your praying's at home. Jesus said, "When you pray, don't

stand like the hypocrites do, and--and for a long... maybe a long prayer, and say this, that, or the other, and--and all like that for a showing." See? He said, "When you prayer... pray, enter into the closet, secret closet, close the door behind you; pray your Father that seeth in secret, He shall reward thee openly." Now, that's the way to have secret

prayer, that's what He said do.

182 But when you, somebody, when they come in, like the song leader, say, "All right..." After the first song, then let somebody have prayer, ever who it is, just a short prayer. Don't stand up and pray for all the governors, and so forth like that. If there's any prayer requests, let it be known, let it be sent in, have them sent in. Write it, say, "Here." "For tonight, in having prayer, we're remembering Sister So-and-so, Brother So-and-so in the hospital, So-and-so, and So-and-so, and So-and-so. Remember them in your prayers as you pray. Brother Jones, will you lead us in prayer. Let's stand." See? Let it be laid on the platform. Tell them, let them get used to that, "If you got a request for prayer, lay it up here, up here." Don't be speaking, "Who has a request now, would you be let it known by..." And then, the first thing, somebody get up and say, "Glory to God!" And you know, start off like that, and the first thing you know, it's a half hour 'fore they set down sometimes. See?

183 We are responsible for this church, not others; this is our responsibility to God. These offices are your responsibility to God. See? The reason I'm standing here tonight, telling you all this, is because it's my responsibility to God; it's your responsibility to carry it out. See?

184 Now, and when something like that... let somebody lead in prayer, and when they do, that's fine, let them lead in prayer then set down.

185 And if you--you got a special... Now, I wouldn't say this, I wouldn't go along... And if anybody wants to sing a special, announce it in the church. Tell them that "Any specials, or anything that wants to be sang, let them see the song leader before the church ever starts." And have it... Say, "Well, I'm sorry brother, I'd like... sure like to do it, but I--I've got my special for tonight. Maybe if you tell me you're going to be here on a certain night, I'll put it on the program for you. See, I got my program wrote out here."

186 Let--let Brother Capps or ever who is leading songs... And have a song leader, no matter who it is. And don't let them stand up and say... or carry on a lot, they're a preacher, see. Let them stand up there and lead songs, that's their business.

187 It's the pastor's business to preach, see, not lead songs. He ain't to lead songs, the song leader leads songs. He's responsible, and should come out freshly under the anointing of the Holy Ghost, from the office in there, somewhere, when it's come time. He don't even have to be on the platform when this is going on. Let him stay in

the office back there, see, or back in here, or wherever it is, and the intercoms here will bring it in, see, when it's time. When he hears that last... if there is a special, like a solo, duet, or something, for your third song. See?

188 That you've had two congregational songs, prayer, your offering if you're going to take it. And let every man be at his post of duty. Say, "All right, while we're singing this last song now, if the ushers will, let them come forward for the evening offering." See? And while they finish singing that song, here's the ushers standing here. Say, "All right, now we're going to have prayer," and they offered prayer, "We want to remember So-and-so here, and So-and-so," and read that off, you know, like that, like that. "All right, everyone stand. Brother, will you lead us in prayer?" Then it's all over.

189 Then while they're singing this second song, or whatever you're singing, you're... take your offering if you're going to take your offering. Leave it... I'd take your first song, and then have your evening offering, and then go on with your second song, and then on through. Then let your last song here... Let your last song, see, be the pastor's call. And as soon as that last hymn is sang, let the organ start with your--your prelude, your pastor walks out. See, everything is in order. Everybody is quiet. Nothing else to be said. Every deacon at his post of duty. The pastor standing there.

190 He come out, greet his audience, turn to his book and say, "Tonight, we're reading from the Bible." See, after he makes it up, "We're reading from the Bible." And it is a good thing sometimes if you say, "In respect to the Word of God, let's stand to our feet while we read the Word." See, then read, "Tonight, I'm reading from the Book of Psalms," or whatever it is. Or either let somebody else read it, the song leader, or associate, somebody there with you, let him read it, whatever; but it'd be best if you read it yourself, if you can. Then read it like that, and then take your text. See? And that much time, you've spent about thirty minutes, it's right then about eight o'clock.

191 And from eight to about a quarter till nine, somewhere between thirty and forty-five minutes, lay that Word in there just as the Holy Ghost gives it to you, see, just like that, just place it right in there the way He says do it, see, under the anointing.

192 Then take your altar call, say, "If anyone here in this church that would like to accept Christ as Saviour, we're asking you, inviting you to the altar right now, just stand to your feet." See?

193 And if--and if no one stands, say, "Is there anyone here that's a candidate for baptism, that's already has repented, and wants to be baptized in water for the remission of sins? If they wish to come, we're giving you the opportunity now. Will

you come while the organ is still playing?" See?

194 Nobody comes, say then, "Is there anybody here that would... that has never received the Baptism of the Holy Ghost and would want to do so tonight, would want us to pray for you?" Well, maybe somebody comes up, then let two or three lay hands on them, pray for them. Send them right back in one of them rooms, somebody in there with them, instruct them somewhere how to come through with the baptism of the Holy Ghost. The congregation is all away from them.

195 If anybody comes to be... wants to accept Christ and standing there at the altar to be prayed for, make your... let them pray. And when they do, just say, "Bow your heads now, we're going to pray." And say, "Do you believe?"

196 If any little thing that would delay the congregation in anyway at all, send them right into the prayer room, and go in there with them, or send somebody in there with them. And let the congregation go right on, see, like that, you haven't held them nowhere then. See?

197 And then while... before... In a--in a few minutes, you say... If nobody comes, then say, "Would there be somebody that would like to be anointed with oil tonight, for sickness? We pray for the sick here."

198 "Well, I'd like to see you privately, Brother Neville." "Well, you see me in the office. See one of the deacons, they'll take it up, see." "And I've got something I'd like to say to you, Brother." "Well, one of the deacons here will see you to the office, and we'll... I'll see you immediately after the service."

199 "Now, we'll stand now for dismissing." See, and you haven't been over about a hour and forty-five minutes in the whole thing. See? See, a hour and thirty minutes, your service is over. You've had the little, quick punch; you--you give it what it's done; you've done it and everybody's satisfied, and go home feeling good. See? If you don't, then, you see, if you let... See, you--you--you mean well, see, but see...

200 You know, this is about thirty-three years in this platform for me, thirty-three years, and the world around. You learn a little something in that much time, surely. See? If you don't, you better quit. So then, see, I find out this. Now, if you're dealing with just Saints altogether, man, you could just stay all night if you wanted to. But you're... See, you're not dealing with them exactly, you're trying to catch these out here. Here's the ones you're catching, you got to work on their field. See? And don't... Bring them in here and then let the Word come, and then, see, there's nothing can be complained. If there's anything they wants to see you about, well, fine, take them right on into the office like that, but don't hold the congregation.

201 Then, you know, people will get up and say, "Well, I tell you, let's have a good testimony meeting." See? I don't mean any critics on this, I just mean to tell you the Truth. I mean to tell you the Truth. See? I've found testimony meetings of more...

they-

-they do more harm sometimes than good. See, they really do.

202 Now, if somebody would have a red-hot testimony in time of a revival, you know, you're having a revival on, you know, a meeting, and somebody got saved and just wanting to say a word, well, bless God, let him unload his soul. And see if he... If he wants to--if he wants to do that, see, just in time of revival, say, "I just want to say, 'Thank the Lord for what He's done for me.' He saved me last week, and my heart's a-burning up with the glory of God. Thanks be to God," set down. Amen! That's fine, go on. See, that's all right.

203 But when you say, "Now come on. Who's next? Who's next? Now let us hear a word, let us hear a word of testimony." Now, if you got a meeting set aside, a certain night for that, see, you're going to. "Tonight... next Wednesday night, instead of prayer meeting, it's going to be a testimony meeting. We want everybody to come in, and it's going to be testimonial meeting." And then when they come to--to the place to give testimonies, read the Word, have prayer, and then say, "Now, we have announced this is testimony night." So let people testify for that hour or forty-five minutes, or thirty minutes, or whatever it is, and then--then go ahead like that. See what I mean? And I think it will help your congregation, it'll help everything, altogether, if you do it that way.

204 Now, as I'm getting late, so... Brother, brethren, these are the best of my knowledge. I see what's on your heart, this is the best of my knowledge the questions that you have asked. Now, from now on you know. And if it's ever in your mind, come to the tape. Ask that... Listen to the tape. If it's for deacons, trustees, or whatever it is, let the tape be played. Let it be played to the congregation out there if they want to hear it. All right. And that's--that is the best of my knowledge to the will of God for this tabernacle here at Eighth and Penn Street, and that's the way I'm commissioning you brothers to carry this out under the leadership of the Holy Spirit, with all kindness and love, showing your grace before people that you are Christians. And Christian don't mean a baby that can be pushed around anywhere, that means "a man that's full of love, but just--just as full of love for God as he is for the congregation." See what I mean?

205 Is there a question? The tape's about to run out here, and I got somebody waiting for me over there. What time was he supposed to be there? [Billy Paul answers, "Right now."--Ed.] Right now. He's coming over himself? [Billy Paul answers, "I'll go get him."] All right. All right, sir.

206 Now, I know we're going out now if there's no--no further any word. Huh? Now, if not, let's dismiss. Yeah. Yes, Brother Collins? [Brother Collins says, "Might be

better if the tape was turned off."--Ed.] All right. [Blank.spot.on.tape.]

207 Well, brethren, I've appreciated being here with you tonight, and Brother Neville, and to the deacons, and trustees, and Sunday school superintendent, all of you. We trust that the Lord will help you now to carry out these orders for the Kingdom of God. The reason I have said this is because that I think you have grown from children to adults. When you was a child, you talked like a child, and you understood as a child. But now you're a man, so let's act as adults in the house of God, behaving ourself, and honoring our offices, and honoring every office. Every gift that the Lord has given us, let's put it in order, and honor God with our gifts and our offices. Let us pray.

208 Heavenly Father, we thank Thee tonight for this gathering together of man that's put in the offices here to carry out the work of the Lord that's being carried on here in Jeffersonville in this church. God, may Your hand be upon them, may You help them and bless them. May the congregation and the people understand and know that this is to in-better the Kingdom of God, that we might become men of understanding and know the Spirit of God, and know what to do. Grant it, Father. Dismiss us now with Thy blessings, and may the Holy Spirit watch over us and guide us, and protect us, and may we be ever found faithful at the post of duty. In Jesus Christ's Name, I pray. Amen.

GUIDELINES FOR DEACON DEPARTMENT POSITIONS

These guidelines are an overview of the basic items needed to perform a reasonable ministry service. These guidelines could not possibly address every situation or event that may unexpectedly arise. Exceptions will have to be made at times. There are also some things that will be learned in the process of serving, or as part of “on the job training”.

Every person serving God’s people within the department needs to:

1. Dress with slacks, dress shirt, tie, dress shoes, with hair that is neatly groomed, and no facial hair (*Recommendation is to wear a suit*)
2. Understand the application of the Deacon Manual especially pages 1-4, 76-83

And must carry the following items:

- Two Way Radio with ear piece (*Recommendation: Motorola Talkabouts*).
- Name Tag.
- Three Tithing envelopes.
- Three Offering envelopes.
- Three Visitor Cards
- Two Elder Prayer Request Cards.
- Two Prayer Petition Cards.
- Three no chewing gum notes.
- A Pen and notepad.
- Breath mints (Life savers, Altoids, etc.).

TEAM LEADER POSITIONS:

Position #12—Sanctuary Leader:

Position # 12 stands at the north side of the French doors. This individual ensures that all assistants within the sanctuary are executing their position according to the guidelines set forth in the Deacon Manual and teachings and that everything is under control be it in the sanctuary or in the service. Position 12 is responsible for ensuring

that all chairs are setup before service and removed after service. It is also your duty that everything displayed on the projection screens is accurate and on time. This position must also maintain the temperature by regulating the thermostats accordingly and change the filters once a month. Lights that are not working must be fixed or replaced. Everything within the sanctuary must be in proper working order. This position must work closely with Position 17 when dealing with the program. During an altar call this position must be at the forefront guiding other team members to be in position. This position must be aware where each Deaconess is sitting in the event their help is needed at the altar. Another important role of this position is to improve our “customer service” and maintain quality in our ministry of service. This may include training of other team members within the sanctuary; may require addressing serious issues within the sanctuary, and lead the team in creating an atmosphere of worship. **This position should never leave the sanctuary unless they are on the program and someone is covering for them during their absence.** This position must be manned at all times.

Position #17—Program Leader:

This position is the liaison between the back offices, vestibule, and the sanctuary. He is permitted to enter the sanctuary and back offices to make sure the program is executed correctly. This person is also responsible for completing the attendance worksheets for each service and checking that everyone is in their designated position. Position 17 will also be responsible for assigning deacons and ushers to positions when a certain deacon position was not scheduled for a particular service.

Position #18— Parking Leader:

This position is responsible for the safe keeping of the cones, flags, vest and flashlights. He is also required to assemble a team to guide traffic efficiently without any bottlenecking or traffic jams during exiting times. This position must also ensure that someone is directing traffic in the parking lot and at the parsonage. In addition, parking helpers are also security guards and must be vigilant of everything taking place in the sanctuary’s outer courts. Anyone serving in the parking areas must be familiar with the reserved parking spaces and know who has access to these spaces. They are to enforce that there are no left turns (turning west) on to Baseline and ensure that cones are set-up in a way to prevent cars from turning left. In situations where there is overflow parking onto 12th and 13th streets, a team member must make periodic patrols of these remote areas to deter theft and vandalism.

Position #22—Vestibule Leader:

The vestibule area includes the foyer, restrooms, and the canopy area outside. This position ensures that everything in the sanctuary, restrooms, and vestibule is in place before the doors are opened. This includes checking that the lights in the entrance, restrooms and vestibule area are on (and working), and the translating system and headsets are ready; ensuring that headsets are returned and placed in their charging system and accounted for after service; that offering baskets are ready for use; that letters, flyers, calendars, tithing & offering envelopes, etc. are handed out at the designated time. The position is responsible for delivering all petitions and requests (elder's prayer requests, child presentations, etc.) to the back office. **All requests including petitions, thanksgiving, elder's prayer requests and other miscellaneous requests must be timed and dated when the usher or deacon receives it. Do not send these requests to the back office unless you have put the time it was received.** It also monitors the restrooms and makes sure they are operational, clean, and stocked with supplies throughout the service. This individual should periodically examine the restrooms for cleanliness and supplies. The vestibule leader must make sure visitors are welcomed either verbally before service or after service. Each visitor or visiting family should be given a visitor information card. The person in this position should be friendly and approachable. In addition, they should be vigilant of the parking lot and help those who need assistance into the sanctuary. They should go out and greet people in the parking lot who are visiting. We ultimately want to make visitors and non-visitors feel welcome by noticing and speaking to them with a warm, positive spirit.

Position #23—Back Office & Program Coordinator:

This position assumes many different responsibilities. It ensures that the original program remains unchanged unless the Pastor has approved a change beforehand. In taking this role, one must remember that changes should be judged as being either the perfect will or the permissive will of the pastor. An example of an unauthorized change occurs when a service does not start on time because the program has not been confirmed or is not ready. The only reason a service may start late is if the pastor is not yet present or if the pastor has given special instructions that the service can be delayed. Position 23 is also responsible for executing the program during the service. This may require him to enter the sanctuary repeatedly during a service in order to monitor strict adherence to the program. The main responsibility of this position is to ensure that the service program does not deviate from the original plan,

unless there are changes approved by the Pastor. Everyone on the program must be notified verbally before service and understand exactly what the Pastor expects of them. It is the responsibility of this individual to instruct everyone on the program of their responsibilities and time limitations. Any deviations from the original program will be addressed and corrected by Position 23 as it is his responsibility to speak to any individual who changes the program or address issues arising in the back offices.

Items such as elder's prayer, interpreters and such must be included on the program before it is distributed. This individual must make sure programs are up-to date and ready to be delivered on time. He then must deliver them no later than 15 minutes before service starts. He must also control or limit traffic in the back offices and exit doors. In addition, this position is responsible for the many facets of the Video and Audio Department and all back offices and rooms during service. Temperature regulation for the platform is another responsibility required of this position. This position oversees the work of Positions 1, 24, 25, and 26 and also communicates any changes in the program to the sound technician. Another responsibility is to take Elder's attendance, gather submit Elders' petitions and submit them to Brother Paul G. Garcia Jr.

Position #1— Backdoor:

This position is the gatekeeper to the back offices of the church. No one is permitted in the back offices unless they are on the program. Before you assume this post of duty, make sure that Position #23 gives you a program of the service. Individuals on the program are allowed to enter the back offices to get what they need but should leave the back offices unless they are next on the program. For example, the person that is going to pray to open the service will be permitted to stay in the back office closest to the platform door. However, the songleader who follows after the minister's sermon should enter the back office before service to submit his songs and not linger in the back. Half way into the sermon he may then return to prepare himself to take the worship once the sermon is done. This is one of the main duties of Position 23 but Position 1 must help ensure that unauthorized individuals do not enter the back offices. As the gatekeeper to the back offices, you are not to open the door to gaze outdoors. The door must remain closed at all time unless you are given special instructions. Position 1 must also ensure that the sanctuary's south doors (platform door and sanctuary door next to the organ) are closed at all times.

NOTE

Positions 1A-17, and 22 must understand how to enforce and apply church order to

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each situation while in their positions. A good example is using wisdom and discernment in a situation where there is a disturbance (visitor talking loudly, child running or crying, person chewing gum, etc.) while a deacon or usher is serving. Naturally the Word has preeminence and the disturbance must be addressed first, then the deacon may proceed with his routine duties.

Positions 1A & 1B – Platform Area:

These two positions keep things at the platform running smoothly. Their main responsibility is to assist those on the platform or at the altar. They are also responsible for the ceiling fans (checking that the bulbs and fans are operating), monitors, lighting, proper location of video cameras, and proper chair order on the platform. The area behind the pulpit should be free of chairs. There should be an open aisle from behind the pulpit all the way to the baptistery. These two individuals are also responsible for correcting obvious mistakes a songleader or minister makes such as guiding the people to take their seats if the song leader walked off the platform without seating the congregation. It is also the responsibility of these positions to go to the pulpit and ask the people to be seated. If the Minister takes his jacket off or requests his notes or Bible from the back office, it is their responsibility to help him out. These positions must also know the purpose and the proper use of each microphone.

Purpose of Mics:

- Tie Mic – used by the minister and the Pastor.
- Lectern Mic – used by songleaders and by minister who request it. This mic is also used for the person baptizing. It can be disconnected from the pulpit and connected to the inside wall of the baptistery on the northern side, **but not without informing the sound technician first.**
- Cordless Mic – used by special songs, songleaders, and ministers (used only when requested and in special situations such as baptism, child presentations, elder's prayer, engagements, renewal of vows, presentations, and testimonies).
- Interpreter's Mic – is similar to the lectern mic (long black skinny mic) but it has its own stand. This is used solely for interpreters.
- Mics with cords – are used for special songs where there are a group of singers and more than one mic is required. They are also used as a back-up when any of the other mics are not working properly.

- Piano Mic – is used for special singers which will be singing and playing the piano.
- **Remember that every mic has a position and function. We must first check with the sound technician to avoid problems with the sound. If you are going to disconnect a mic from the system (such as the lectern mic on the pulpit) YOU MUST TELL THE SOUND TECH because the popping noise ruins the very delicate microphones.**
- Position 23 is responsible for communicating any changes that arise to the sound technician.

Special Situations:

- When we have a group of individuals singing such as the Choir, Rondalla, and children/youth, all mics will need to be used and set-up accordingly.
- Always check with the Sound System Technician regarding the mics that can be used and where they should be positioned during the service (especially for special songs).

Position 2 & 3 – Altar Deacons:

Position 2 is the lead deacon and Position 3 is the assistant. These two positions play a vital role in eliminating any gaps in the program, which may result from delays in transition from one section of the program to another. They must be aware of their surroundings and attentive to the voice of the pastor. If something is out of order, the pastor will usually mention it verbally. It is very critical that these two positions receive a program at least 15 minutes before the service starts so they can prepare the mics for the songleaders, special songs, ministers and for anyone else on the program (missionary offering, child presentations, baptisms, family presentations, special prayers, and children department presentations). These positions need to work very closely with Positions 23 and 17 in executing the program and must be listening to the pastor's voice to ensure they do exactly what he is requesting. Both positions are responsible for mic set-up and speaker monitor positions during the service. They are to ensure that the pulpit is in order by testing the pulpit lights, removing any papers from previous services, and making sure there are at least two bottles of water (for the songleader and minister) under the pulpit. If the bottled water is unopened it is then returned to the office for future use. These positions also maintain order when there is activity at the altar. The altar area includes the platform and everything east of them. For example, during the Elders' prayer they are to have the mic and anointing oil ready. The mic must be hand-delivered to Brother Paul G. Garcia Jr. In

his absence, the mic is delivered to one of the two assistant pastors. If all three brothers are absent, the mic is given to the Administrator. During an altar call these two men must ensure that the ladies go to the north side of the altar and the men to the south side of the altar. When anyone comes to the altar it is preferred that they stand instead of kneel because of limited space. When the altar is full and people start to crowd the middle aisle, then it is the responsibility of Positions 2, 3, and 12 to ensure that the people form a line so the ministers, elders, deacons, and believers can pray for them. They also ensure that the instruments are ready to be played (organ is not closed, piano is open, chairs are available for guitarists, trumpeters, etc).

These positions are stressful because they are performed openly before the people. Each mistake is magnified a hundred percent while correct decisions and actions are often overlooked. Unfortunately there is a very low tolerance for mistakes from these two positions. They must commend themselves to God and constantly be on their toes, strategizing and anticipating what their next step is. A word of caution: you can never be lax while serving in these positions. Refer to Mic uses above.

Position 4 – Middle Aisle:

This position is the mastermind of the seating arrangements. He is the quarterback of the team and oversees all the seating in the sanctuary. This position understands Positions 1A through 11, 13, 27 and 28. This position is the director of seating and requires the ability to multi-task, anticipate and strategize. Position 4 is directly responsible for seating people in rows 1 through 14 on the north and south side inner aisle for half of the pews. This position also helps out during any altar activities, assists in offering collection, and dismisses the people at the end of each service. The person in the middle aisle knows all the open spots in positions five through ten. This position should be familiar where each Deaconess is sitting during the service should they be needed during altar activities.

Position 5 – Brother Paul's Section: There are three reserved areas in this section: Brother Paul's bench, Brother Johnny Alvarado & Family, and Sister Nati Alvarado (third row south-end of the bench). Be very careful who you give permission to sit in these reserved seats because there are more individuals than there is room. Someone will always be left out. This position must know who is permitted to seat in these reserved areas. Brother Paul's immediate family has first priority to his bench. Others have traditionally sat in Brother Paul's bench but this has never been officially

mandated by the Pastor. No one is allowed to sit in Brother Paul's or Sister Mary's seats when they are absent. Position 5 is responsible for the south east seating section of the altar, platform, half of the seating for rows one through four, and to guard the south door to the back offices. When Position 8 is not manned, then Position 5 assumes rows five and six.

Position 6 – Brother Bernie's Section:

There are two reservations in this section: Brother Bernie's bench and Brother Joshua O'Campo & family. Be very careful who you give permission to sit in these reserved seats because there are more individuals permitted to sit in these places than there is room. This position must know who is permitted to seat in these reserve areas. Brother Bernie's family (sons and daughters) have first priority to his bench. Others are permitted to sit in Brother Bernie's bench but it has never been officially mandated by the Pastor. No one is allowed to sit in Brother Bernie's or Sister Lily's seats when they are absent unless it is one of their sons. Position 6 is responsible for the North east seating section of the altar, platform, half of the seating for rows one through four, and guard the south door to the back offices. When Position 7 is not manned, then Position 6 assumes rows five and six.

Position 7 – Mid Section – Pastor's Side:

This position is responsible for seating people in rows five, six, seven, and eight. They are only responsible for half of the rows. The other half corresponds to Position 4. This position takes an active part in collecting offering baskets.

Position 8 – Mid Section – Bro. Paul's Side:

This position is responsible for seating people rows five, six, seven, and eight. They are only responsible for half of the rows. The other half corresponds to Position 4. This position also takes an active part in collecting offering baskets.

Position 9 – North Side Exit:

This position is responsible for seating people in rows nine, ten, eleven, twelve, and thirteen. They are only responsible for half of the rows. The other half corresponds to Position 4. This area has one reserved spot for Brother Lalo Ruiz and family on the last pew on the north-west corner. This position is responsible for manning the north side exit door and dismissing the people starting with Brother Lalo's pew, then

the additional seating, followed by rows eleven through six or until all the rows are dismissed. We dismiss the rows from a countdown position. Anytime we are asked to distribute literature after service, it is this person's responsibility that everyone that walks through your door gets a copy.

Position 10 – South Side Exit:

This position is responsible for seating people in rows nine, ten, eleven, twelve, and thirteen. They are only responsible for half of the rows. The other half corresponds to Position 4. This position is responsible for manning the south side exit door and dismissing the people starting from row thirteen, followed by rows twelve through six or until all the rows are dismissed. We dismiss the rows from a countdown position. Anytime we are asked to distribute literature after service, it is this individual's responsibility to distribute it as people exit.

Position 11 – Additional Seating Section:

This position is responsible for the entire row in the additional seating area. In a dual service format, the chairs will be set-up so there are two walk ways: on the north side and the south side of the additional seating area. The south side walk way allows individuals to use the side door to the vestibule. In a Sunday one-service format, there is only one walkway which is on the north side. The south side walkway will need to be filled with chairs and the door to the vestibule area will be inoperable. This position will play an active part in collecting the offering. Remember, we use the north wall for storing the folding chairs but during a service we use that storage space as an aisle which means that all the chairs that are not being used must be placed outside before we open the doors to the public.

Position 13 - Gatekeeper to Sanctuary:

This is a key position within the sanctuary. This person must eliminate long lines of people waiting to be seated which is not always easy since he depends on those in the sanctuary. He must work very closely with Positions 6 through 12. He must be able to multi-task and use Position 4 as his point of reference in seating everyone that comes through the doors. He must understand where each person can and cannot be seated. For example, this position should not send a sister to sit in the row of folding chairs in front of row one. It is also very critical that this person treat everyone that comes through the doors as a guest. He must be very careful to not send people when the other position is not expecting them or not ready to receive them. He must

always be making contact with all positions within the sanctuary and scanning the rows for open seats. He must wear a genuine smile and treat people kindly as he tries to accommodate their needs. This position requires constant communication with the ushers, deacons, and everyone that comes through the door. For example, if he detains someone at the doors because there is no seat available, he must kindly communicate this to the individuals he is detaining.

Positions 14 – 16 – Vestibule Section:

These positions will assist the Team Leader in Position 22. They are responsible for delivering any verbal or written request to the back office. **All requests including petitions, thanksgiving, elder's prayer requests and other miscellaneous requests must be timed and dated when the usher or deacon receives it. Do not send these requests to the back office unless you have put the time it was received.** They are not permitted to enter the back office unless they are under orders either by Brother Bernie, Brother Paul or the administrator. This position must guard against anyone parking in Brother Paul's space, the Handicap space next his parking spot, and/or anyone parking near that area. Please ensure a cone is put in the handicap parking spot. This handicap parking spot is used only as a drop-off. They must also ensure that the exterior lights to the church are working. They are to assist Position 22 with the following vestibule duties:

Position 22 - This position ensures that everything in the sanctuary, restrooms, and vestibule is in place before the doors are opened. This includes checking the translating system and headsets and making sure they are ready, that they are returned and placed in their charging system and accounted for after service; that offering baskets are ready for use; that letters, flyers, calendars, tithing & offering envelopes, etc. are handed out at the designated time. The position is responsible for delivering all petitions and requests (elder's prayer requests, child presentations, etc.) to the back office. It also monitors the restrooms and makes sure they are operational, clean, and stocked throughout the service. This individual should periodically examine the restrooms for cleanliness and supplies. The vestibule area includes the foyer, restrooms, and the canopy area outside. The vestibule leader must make sure visitors are welcomed either verbally before service or after service. Each visitor or visiting family should be given a visitor information card. The person in this position should be friendly and approachable. In addition, they should be vigilant of the parking lot and help those who need assistance into the sanctuary. They should go out and greet people in the parking lot who are visiting. We ultimately want to make

them feel very welcome by noticing and speaking to them positively. After each service, we must pick up the trash in the restrooms and flush all toilets.

Positions 19 – 21 – Parking Assistants:

These positions will assist the Team Leader in Position 18. Please read Position 18's responsibilities.

Positions 24 – Liaison Between Back Office and Sanctuary:

The major responsibility is to strengthen the lines of communications between the sanctuary and the back office functions. The first step in improving this link is to ensure every team leader has the most updated program. The next step is to communicate any program changes (or needs) to the sanctuary from the back offices and visa versa. This means that this individual must make sure petitions, elder's prayer and announcement requests are submitted to the back office in a timely manner. This position is also responsible for ensuring that the tie mic is on before the minister leaves the back offices. This position will assume Position 23's responsibilities and authority in his absence.

Positions 25 & 26 – Back Office Assistants:

These positions will assist the Team Leader in Position 23. Please read Position 23's responsibilities.

Program Confirmation the day of service – Positions 23, 24, 25, 26:

1. All songleader songs will be confirmed by Position 24 no matter where they are fall on the program
2. All prayers (opening, prayer for petitions/offering, elder's prayer, food court, special prayers, dismissal and etc.) will be confirmed by Position 25. This position will also confirm the person giving the announcements. Knowing who is going to perform is not enough. **YOU must ensure that the person is in position to perform his duty.**
3. All special singers will be confirmed by Position 26. This responsibility includes **every need relating to the singer or poet/orator**. For example, how many are singing in each special? How many songs? How many mics are needed? Is a stand needed or a chair? Are they singing with church musicians or do they have their

own band and what needs do they have? Are they singing with a CD? Is the CD approved by Position 23? If the CD is approved, have you delivered it to the sound system? If the CD was not approved what is the next step? Do the deacons in the sanctuary know about each singer's need in order to sing their song?

4. All presentations and baptisms will be confirmed by Position 25. The presentations include children, families, couples, engagements, ministers, dedication of ministers, Pastor's presentations. This also includes confirming if the couple brought their rings when they are renewing vows or being engaged. In addition, your responsibility is to have a hard copy of the vows and child presentation scriptures in Spanish and English ready for the minister. It is your duty to confirm the needs of the minister too. This position is responsible for all aspects of the baptismal service which includes confirming with the deacons, notifying the deaconess for female baptisms, assigning changing areas for men and for women, getting robes and towels ready, filling the baptistery with water, filling the baptism form out, and finding out who the Baptist and interpreter will be, and for laundering the baptismal linens and returning them to the church. Position 23 is the back up to ensure that everything is confirmed and ready to go.
5. All interpreters will be confirmed by Position 26 (Position 25 will provide back-up). Segments of the program that may need an interpreter may include prayers, presentations, baptisms, elder's prayer, welcomes, petitions, offerings, Children Department's Report, Announcements, Pastor's presentations and Pastor's Last Words, etc. These positions will also confirm that the translating system is working properly.
6. All offerings (regular, missionary, love, and special) will be confirmed by Position 24.
7. Welcomes, thanksgiving, petitions, and announcement sheets will be confirmed by Position 25 and reconfirmed by Position 26. This means you are responsible for getting them typed correctly, submitting them for approval and giving the final copy to those on the program.
8. Children's Department report will be confirmed by Position 26.
9. Minister multimedia presentations will be reviewed and confirmed by Position 23. A deck will be delivered to the Pastor, Bro. Paul G. Garcia Jr., and the administrator.
10. Position 23 will ensure that the introduction for the interpreted message

- is recorded according to the preformatted standard. This will be followed up by Position 24.
11. Offering baskets are in the hands of the deacons in the sanctuary, minister is being attended will be confirmed by Position 24.
 12. Position 25 will confirm the sound system prelude, live prelude, and the musicians available to play the instruments.
 13. Pulpit lights are to be confirmed as operational by Position 24. Position 23 will administer the turning on of pulpit lights.
 14. It is everyone's responsibility (Positions 23-26) to ensure that steps 1 through 12 are confirmed.
 15. It does not matter how many other men are with our pastor, each position must still do their assigned duty even if another person accompanying our pastor may have already done it. (Example: Our pastor's assistant places the tie mic on him. The pastor then passes 4 men in position (23, 24, 25, 26) and reaches the pulpit with his mic off. What went wrong?) You must verify that your post is fulfilled. Do not assume someone else has done your job without confirming this is so. It is your commission to ensure all the steps are confirmed. **It is everyone's responsibility to ensure that the mic is on before our Pastor reaches the platform.**
 16. At the Pastor's request, during the preaching of the Word, all office personnel are to exit the back offices and enter the sanctuary to hear the message. The only exception is made for those in the Video & Audio Department and Position 23. It is preferred that the office personnel sit on the platform but this requires our deacons and ushers to reserve them a seat before service. Position 23 is responsible that everyone in the back offices adheres to the pastor's request.
 17. Positions 1, 23, 24, 25 and 26 must communicate among themselves things which have and have not been confirmed or any new changes made to the program. This will eliminate double work/redundancy—two people working on the same thing. For example, the pastor will often make a request and then there will be two men working on the same request creating double work for the secretary (printing/copying, etc.) and then to produce two of the same thing twice for no reason. **Please communicate to avoid this misuse of scarce resources!**
 18. **Always ensure that all information that is submitted to be typed is verified with the original request.**

PLEASE NOTE: Confirmation means you have the person or items on the program ready to go to serve their function. For example, if a certain interpreter is on the program but not ready to go up with the songleader, then the interpreter has not be confirmed.

Position 27 – BGG’s Assistant:

This position will assist Brother Bernie with whatever he needs before, during and after service. This position requires the person to have a radio and to communicate any concerns, and movements of BGG so we can serve him better.

Position 28 – PGG Jr.’s Assistant:

This position will assist Brother Paul with whatever he needs before, during and after service. This position requires the person to have a radio and to communicate any concerns, and movements of PGG Jr. so we can serve him better.

Position 29 – Video & Audio Assistant:

This position will assist the team leader (TL) of the audio & video (A&V) department. This position will learn how to use all equipment in this department. His job responsibility will be assigned by the team leader of the A&V department. The TL will work very closely with the Administrator to ensure that deacons and ushers are receiving proper training. Each deacon must be trained to run this department. At a later time, they will also be trained to run the sound system.

POINTS TO CONSIDER:

- Always remember that only eleven adults fit on a pew.
- When we are faced with extreme weather, no one should be standing outside waiting for the doors to be opened. Please ask all these individuals to enter the sanctuary quietly.
- Once you have allowed a person to be seated in your area, **do not** ask them to move to another place unless you receive orders to do so.
- Do not seat anyone on the platform or in the first three rows during the sermon.
- Positions four through thirteen are required to pick up the translating headsets

before service is dismissed.

- Remember that the radios can be a blessing and a curse depending on how we use them.
- When there are not enough elders to lay hands on the people, then it is the deacon department's responsibility to help lay hands on them.
- The logistics in seating should be as follows:
 - All folding chairs in front of row number one should be filled by single men that are neatly groomed and dressed appropriately.
 - Rows two and four should be reserved for single ladies and ministers' wives.
 - Rows five and six should be reserved for single men and/or couples.
 - Rows seven through nine should be reserved for families with teenage children.
 - Rows ten and on should be reserved for families with small children and babies that may need to exit the sanctuary frequently.

OFFERING FORMAT:

When we pick up an offering there must be two brothers positioned on the platform (Positions 1A & 1B) to gather the offering. One passes the offering baskets down the row while the other receives them on the other end. There will be two brothers (Positions 4 and 13) in the middle aisle in front of the pulpit to pass out offering baskets starting with all the rows of folding chairs in front of row one through rows six. Starting at row seven there will be another two brothers (Position 12 and 14) ready to pass out the offering baskets to rows seven through thirteen. Position 11 will pick up the offering for the additional seating area. Position 15 will pick up the offering in the vestibule area. A deacon outside of Position 12 must walk all the offering baskets to the office. The deacon must use the south side aisle of the sanctuary when taking the offering to the office. He should never deliver the offering to the back office by using the outer courts. If the offering has to be delivered using the outer-courts then Positions 14 and 15 will escort (bodyguard) the deacon to the back office. Remember it is also the responsibility of the deacons to collect the offering from the back offices.

BAPTISM FORMAT:

When a baptism is performed we need to understand each position:

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- The baptistery must be filled up before service starts and then drained immediately. We cannot leave water in the baptistery overnight. This poses a huge liability issue.
- Baptism forms must be filled out and name tags made for each person being baptized. The name tag is posted right under the mic in the baptistery so the minister can read it as the next candidate is ready to be baptized.
- Position 3 should open and close the curtain. Curtains should only be opened when the Program Coordinator (Position 23) gives the sign. Curtains should be closed immediately after a person has been baptized.
- Position 2 should set the mic in the baptistery (mic comes from the pulpit) and

ensure that the songleader, interpreter have mics too. This position must ensure that the curtains close properly. Under no circumstances should a person peek through the curtains once they are closed.

- The pulpit should never be moved unless direct orders are given by the pastor(s) or the administrator.
- The camera must be positioned in front of the baptistery and behind the pulpit so the baptism can be projected on the screens.
- If elders need to be moved, have them stand on the platform or along the south wall. They should not exit the platform to the back offices.
- Position 24 shall stand in the baptistery ensuring the person baptized is completely submerged under water. He will also radio a message to Position 23 when to open the curtains.
- Position 25 will be standing in the northeast corner of the walkway of the back offices. He will control the traffic and relay any signs to Position 1. Position 1 will directly report to Position 23 any signs he receives.
- The church has baptismal robes and towels for those who do not have a set of clothes to change into. Positions 23-26 will help allocate the robes and towels. If sisters are being baptized it is always recommended that we get an elder's wife or deaconess to help us out with the sister's needs during this time.
- Normally we allow the sisters to change in the interpreter's room. The restroom and the pastor's office are also available for changing.
- When sisters are baptized and need to walk to the restroom to change, the walkway should be clear of men as she is passing by.
- A minister should always speak to the person to be baptized before the event so the person knows the key elements of baptism and how to be properly

baptized. The person(s) should know what the Baptist is going to do while he is in the water. (The person being baptized should put their hands together and bring them to their face. Then with their two thumbs they should gently squeeze their nose to prevent water from entering as they are submerged. They should relax and allow the minister to submerge them. Then on their way up out of the water they can help the Baptist by standing up so all the weight is not placed on the minister.)

- The correct format for baptizing is to make a group prayer for all those that will be baptized. When the person is in the water the Baptist should say, "I baptize John Doe (person's name) in the name of the Father, Son and the Holy Ghost which we know is the name of the Lord Jesus Christ for the remission of sins and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost" **or** he can say, "I baptize John Doe (person's name) in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ for the remission of sins and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost." At this point, their whole body should be submerged in water.
- The scriptures we use for baptism is based upon Matthew 28:19 and Acts 2:38

MATTHEW 28:19 Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost:

ACTS 2:38 Then Peter said unto them, Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.

ELDER'S PRAYER:

HEALING WHAT SICKNESS IS

CLEVELAND OH 50-0808

E-10 Divine healing's in reach of every person, and every person that is a Christian has a right to pray for the sick. That's right. **If there's any among you sick, call the elders. That's the deacons in your church. See?** And then if they confess their faults one to another, and pray one for the other... Right there you are. And ask any man, any person... You don't have to wait till some Divine healing service comes into the city. That's not God's program. If you're sick, get some good Christian to help you pray, till you have faith in that prayer. That's it. And that's all. Call your pastor. That's what he's for, to come and pray with you. And if he's a godly man...'Course I believe that all true ministers are godly men. That's right. They're all

born again Christians. They're godly people. That's true. And every one of them has a perfect right...

E-11 Now, there may be things that God has added to the church, which stimulate faith. But now, when I'm gone, healing isn't gone. Healing ought to be more than it was 'fore we come here. See, see? That's the purpose, is to get the people in their mind in the spirit of the latter days... We're in the latter day. You believe that? We are. The world is in the spirit of the latter days. But the church is not in the latter day Spirit yet. See? In other words, we may be in a...?... But God wants His church so in the Spirit, till they'll fit in just anywhere God were to lead them to. The latter days or rending of the world... My, my. Look at the places: eating, drinking, marrying, giving in marriage, and all the immorals there is in the world. The devil sent down his troops in the latter day spirit. But we ministers haven't got the church yet in that Spirit. And we must be in that condition in order to be caught away in the rapture when He come back...?... [Blank.spot.on.tape--Ed.]

EXPECTATIONS

LA CA 51-0507

E-11 And you don't have to wait till somebody's got a healing campaign in town to be healed, because your pastor or your neighbor that's a Christian, anybody's got a right to pray for you. The Bible said, "Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another that you might be healed. **If there's any sick among you let them call the elders.**" Now, we call them in our groups, we call them the deacons. See? The... "Let them call the elders of the church, let them anoint them in oil." It's not call the "elder" but "the elders," plural, two or three. Where two or three are gathered together and agree and pray (See?), that's the way to do it. And after all, we're here to glorify our Lord Jesus Christ, His mercy and His goodness to us. And we're thankful for Him.

Usher Position Schedule

<u>Position #</u>	<u>Position Description</u>
1	Backdoor
1A	Platform South Side
1B	Platform North Side
2	Altar area - lead position
3	<i>Altar area - assistant</i>
4	Middle Isle
5	Bro Paul's Section
6	Bro Bernie's Section
7	<i>Mid Section - Pastor side</i>
8	<i>Mid Section - Bro Paul side</i>
9	North Side Exit
10	South Side Exit
11	Additional Seating Section
12	Team Leader for Sanctuary
13	Gatekeeper to Sanctuary
14	Vestibule
15	<i>Vestibule</i>
16	<i>Vestibule</i>
17	Team Leader for Program
18	Team Leader for Parking Area
19	Parking area
20	<i>Parking area</i>
21	<i>Parking area</i>
22	Team Leader for Vestibule
23	Program Coordinator - Back Office
24	Liaison Back Office
25	Back Office
26	Back Office
27	BGG
28	PGG Jr
29	Video Assistant
30+	Substitute

Deacon Department Positions

23 & 24, 25, 26		29	1
6	1B	1A	5
	2	3	
	BGG 27	28 PGG Jr	
	JO		
	EGB		
7			8
9			10
	AGBJr		
	ER		
11			12
		12	13
		14	Men
		15	Restroom
		16	22 Women
		17	

Rows

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12
13

Parking Area : 18 & 19-21

Substitutes: 30 - 34

RESERVE SITTING:

BGG = Bernie G. Garcia

EGB = Ernie G. Borunda

JO = Joshua O'Campo Sr.

AGBJr. = Alex G. Borunda Jr.

PGG Jr. = Paul Garcia Jr.

JGA = John G. Alvarado

ER = Lalo Ruiz

SERVICE PROGRAM PROCEDURAL CHECKLIST

The procedural checklist is a guide to ensure that everyone that is taking part and those that are a integral part of the service program are informed of the events during the service. This is a procedural checklist that is constantly changing.

1. The key to good administration is prayer, planning, organizing, and timing. The earlier you arrive to church the better prepared you will to be to handle all the opportunities that arise before, during, and after the service.
2. Stop by the office and get a update on the current events for the service. Get a service program. Know the original service program by memory.
3. No one is authorized to make any changes to the program and or to Phoenix Tabernacle unless the pastor approves of the changes before the changes are made. All changes (not limited to the program only) need to be questioned as to who authorized the change. If the Pastor did not authorize it, then speak to the Pastor or the Administrator about the unauthorized change(s).
4. In order to assure ourselves of a good service, we need to make sure that the personnel for each department are in their post of duty. Make the rounds to each department and speak to the person in charge to see if they are experiencing any difficulties. This can only be accomplished if number 1 is strictly adhered to.
5. Help set-up video equipment in the room and in the sanctuary. Make sure that the person(s) recording the audio test the translating system from the video room and the sanctuary to the translating room. Help troubleshoot the problem if they are having problems. Make sure everything is plugged in. Have the translator come to the room 5 minutes before the minister starts speaking so that we can do a final test of the system.
6. Brief the Pastor on the status of the service before the service starts. Then listen very closely for any changes, additions, instructions and or insights.
7. Make sure that any changes, additions and etc. from the Pastor is communicated to the Administrator, the assistants and the areas that are affected by the changes. This will eliminate getting gunned down by friendly fire.
8. Have everyone that is on the program come to the back to speak to Administrator and or the assistants to the Administrator so that we can inform them of their part and any changes in the service that affect them. Give them a copy of the program.

9. Service needs to start on time. Record the time duration of each part so that we know where we stand.
10. Make sure that everyone on the program is advised of their time limit. If they go over the allotted time set by the Pastor, bring it to their attention in a wise and subtle manner. Be very careful in your approach when you are dealing with the people especially elders or others that hold an office in the church.
11. On Sunday Morning, assist the Spanish, English ministers, and interpreters with making copies, transparencies, special song of introduction, water, tie-tac mic, mics, title of message, opening scriptures for the Video Department and etc. A copy of all transparencies should be made and given to the elders sitting on the platform. Make sure they are made aware of their time limit set by the Pastor.
12. All song directors need to bring in the songs that they are going to sing so that we can type them on the program. Try to get all the songs on the program before the programs are delivered to all the departments. Make sure a copy of all the songs that are used on the transparency machine are given to the Elders on the platform.
13. Copies of the program should be given to all the departments by the administration personnel, especially the Music (piano & organ) and Children Department.
14. A copy of the program, bulletin, transparencies and etc should be given to Bro. Bernie G. Garcia and Bro. Paul G. Garcia Jr.
15. There are several things we need to know from the special singers: (1) who is singing with them, (2) are they singing with a sound track or musicians and are the musicians sing with them (3) do they need help with a music stand and etc. If they are singing with a sound track make sure that it is approved by the Pastor before they are given permission to sing (see Administration Personnel guidelines). From this information, we can determine how many mics will be needed. The sound system personnel and the altar deacons need to know this information so that the confusion about mics are eliminated. The first special singer needs to know the last song that the song director will sing so that the singer(s) and the mic(s) are in position before the song leader finishes his last song. Remind the song leader to continue sing the song until the singers are ready to sing.
16. All petitions, elder prayers and announcements need to be typed in English and Spanish and **read in a uniform manner** according to the Administration Personnel guidelines. A copy of the petitions and the announcements need to be read by the Administration and given to the Pastor before the director reads

- them from the platform. Remember on the announcements, we are not to announce any kind of meeting after church service unless it is an emergency and the Pastor has authorized it. All regular meetings should be delegated thru and by the Pastor (note: Administration Personnel guidelines).
17. Before the minister's allotted time runs out open the door to the platform as a sign that he has 5 minutes left. If there are souls at the altar, make sure that the elders pray over them. One of the administrators needs to come out into the sanctuary and be ready to act at the Pastor's command. Administrators, please avoid walking north and south on the platform repeatedly. This causes distraction and appears on our video recording.
 18. Make sure that the worship director after the message understands his role, when, and what he needs to accomplish. For example, elders prayer, souls at the altar that have not been prayer for, baptisms, presentations, last words from the Pastor and etc. If a soul requested prayer from the elders but was prayed for at the altar during the worship, then we will not have the elders pray for that person again.
 19. The announcements are to be short and simple. Make sure that the person giving the announcements understands that it is not the time to give a short sermon, small stories, or recap the message that the minister spoke about, personal thoughts and etc. Just have them give the announcements.
 20. Things to plan for and add to the program if they are not there:
 - A. Child presentations & baptisms around the 15th of every month.
 - B. Missionary offering is gathered on the last Sunday of every month.
 - C. Special singers, video presentations, excerpts of cassette messages and etc.
 21. For child presentations, make sure that a form is filled out for every child. Let the director of the deacons know when the presentation will take place. Make sure that the child to be presented is in the sanctuary and not in the children department before the message finishes. The Pastor wants to eliminate the minister presenting the children from preaching a sermon. We must help him accomplish this task.
 22. Concerning the baptisms, a form must be filled out for each person. The filling of the baptism should be done before service starts. It is permitted to fill the baptistery during the worship service only but is not recommended. Call on brother and sister Carrillo to assist you with clothing, towels, preparing the individuals, cleaning & filling the baptistery and etc. The director of the deacons and the altar deacons need to know the number of baptisms and when they will take place on the program. 15 minutes before

- the minister finishes his message, have the minister baptizing, the individuals wanting Christian baptism come to the back to get prepared. We need to have a good relay from the back so that we can let the altar deacons know when to open the curtains. The Pastor wants to eliminate the minister baptizing from preaching a sermon. We must help him accomplish this task.
23. Never assume that the persons on the program know that they are on the program. ALWAYS confirm it in person by one of the administrators. Do not have someone else confirm our post of duty. Make sure that they understand their part.
 24. Remember that what you expect of others when they are on the program is expected of you when you are on the program. We must practice what we preach. We need to set the example.
 25. The monitors are a good indicator of viewing any unusual activity taking place in the sanctuary. Keep your eyes opened. Are the people fanning themselves? Could it be that the A/C are too high or too low? Are their people still at the altar? Is someone in need of assistance? Have the Video Department pan the audience. Remember you must be prepared to act.
 26. Never take any ill type of behavior, words spoken to you personal. Any contrary action that is manifested while performing your post of duty is a direct attack upon the Pastor. They are not coming against you. They are going against the Pastor. It is the Pastor that set up the program. We only try to abide by it. It is very easy to take things personal but refrain from doing so because it will drag you into a pit of mud.
 27. A service report should be completed and submitted to the Pastor no latter than Monday unless there are emergency issues that need to be communicated ASAP. Use Godly wisdom in determining the severity of the issue.
 28. All traffic to the back offices should come to a complete halt during the preaching of the Word of God unless it is an emergency.
 29. We must maintain order in the back offices at all times. The back offices are part of the sanctuary. We must be reverent in the back offices at all times.

Phoenix Tabernacle, Inc. Service

BACK-OFFICE POSITION RESPONSIBILITIES

Sound System Prelude (?? Minutes)
Live Prelude (?? Minutes)

Position: 25 / 23

Opening Prayer:
(Interpreter:???)

Position: 25

Position: 26

Worship Director and Songs: (?? Minutes)

Position: 24

Testimonies (?? Minutes Each) C/O Bro. ???

1. Sister: 2. Brother: 3. Sister:
(Interpreter: ???)

Position: 26

Position: 26

Position: 26

Special Songs: 1. (2 Song - Guitars) 4. Choir
 2. (Soundtrack) 5. Poems
 3. (Piano) 6. Out of town guests

Position: 26 & 23

Welcome, Thanksgivings, Petitions, Announcements, Sheet:
Song Director and Songs:
Interpreters: available interpreters for this section
(Prayer for Petitions & Offering:)
Child Or Family Presentations
Baptisms

Position: 25 / 26

Position: 24

Position: 26

Position: 25

Position: 25

Position: 25 / 23

Minister: (mic and special needs)
Recording of Interpretation:
Interpreters: (for this section)
Altar Call Special Prayers

Position: 23

Position: 23

Position: 26

Position: 25

Worship Director and Songs:
Elder's Attendance Sheet
Elder's Prayer

Position: 24

Position: 23

Position: 25

Missionary, Special, Love, All Offerings picked up in a Service
Special Presentations: Engagements, Ordinations, Pastor & etc.
(Interpreter for this section: ???)

Position: 24

Position: 25

Position: 26

Sunday School Report:
(Interpreter: ???)
Announcements & Dismiss:
(Interpreter: ???)
(Prayer for Dismissal:)
Director and Song to Dismiss:

Position: 26

Position: 26

Position: 25 / 26

Position: 26

Position: 25

Position: 24

Everything should be confirmed by Position 23

COMMUNION PROCEDURES

The following items below are to be used as a guideline for the deacons in serving communion at Phoenix Tabernacle.

If a deacon cannot attend the communion service and/or take communion, they must contact the Assistant Pastor of the Deacons / Administrator and give their reason(s). Remember that the office of a Deacon requires a high standard of living. For a deacon to have true communion with God, they need to: 1 service the sanctuary, 2 help serve communion and 3 then partake of the bread and wine. Holy Communion is a service that a deacon should never miss.

Communion is normally served within the sanctuary to all. Foot washing, however, is segregated into two groups: men and women. Foot-washing is performed in the sanctuary for ladies. Men perform it in the Voice of Restoration (VOR) building. The wine and bread are made ready for the service in the Pastor=s Office. Normally, this is where our Pastor has his foot- washing.

1. At least a couple of days before our Communion service, a deacon should contact Brother Eleazar Ruiz about obtaining access to the Voice of Restoration building a few hours before service so the basins can be filled with water and the chairs set-up. This is not Brother Ruiz's responsibility. We need to protect and help him by taking care of it.
2. Normally, Elder Joshua and Sister Margarita Ocampo bake the bread for communion and have the wine ready. A deacon should always confirm one week in advance that they will be baking the bread and have enough wine on hand to serve communion. Usually, the Secretary of Phoenix Tabernacle, will buy more wine if needed. The wine we use is made by the orthodox Jews and the label has a Jewish priest. This wine is made to celebrate the Passover and it can be purchased at Fry's grocery store.
3. Four deacons must arrive at the church at least 2 hours before service starts to prepare the foot-washing basins for service. This includes cleaning the basins, filling them up with water and setting up with chairs in the sanctuary and the Voice of Restoration. Normally, we use the extra seating room in the back of the church along with the last pew on the south-west part of the church for

foot-washing. Basins filled with water and placed underneath the pew. Within that extra room, the chairs and basins are set-up in a square formation allowing everyone seated in the chairs to see each other. In the Voice of Restoration building, the chair and basin arrangement can vary depending on what items are in Voice of Restoration building at that time.

4. The sanctuary should be set up so that there are no folding chairs in the isles, no chairs in the altar area and only one row of folding chairs on the platform. On the platform, there should be only twelve chairs centered behind the pulpit along the back wall. There should also be a small table with a table cloth to be used for the wine and bread trays.
5. The doors of the sanctuary should be opened 30 minutes before service starts. However, if there are individuals that come early and want to pray at the altar, they should be permitted to enter the sanctuary. Once the person finishes praying, they should find a seat in the pews and be reverent. If they are walking around, please have them sit or wait outside until we open the doors.
6. The deacons should ensure that the sanctuary is presentable and that all restrooms are clean and stocked with supplies. Our members should **never** have to tell the deacons that the restrooms are out of supplies (toilet paper, towels, and soap).
7. Every deacon should be assigned a post. The three doors to the back offices should especially be guarded. During communion service the two doors to the back offices should not be used outside of those brothers helping serve communion.
8. During the special songs, there must be no clapping by the audience. The service program should be reviewed for special songs and our Video Department should be notified that a multimedia announcement should be displayed stating there is no clapping after a singer sings their song (Please refrain from clapping after special songs).
9. The back office library is closed during the communion service since and no offering is picked up during this service. Therefore, no one should be entering the back unless they are part of the communion program. Outside of the those ministers, elders and deacons elected to help serve communion, everyone else

that is on the program should be attended to and then asked to enter the sanctuary. No one is to be loitering in the back offices.

10. The Administrator usually selects four elders to help serve the bread and the wine per our Senior Pastor's request. The ministers that will be taking part in the service along with the four elders should gather in the Pastor's Office to pray over the bread and wine before the service starts. Then they should break the bread to ensure that the pieces of bread are enough for the number of people in attendance. Normally, the Administrator will oversee this and ensure we have enough to cover those in attendance. When the service starts, our Senior Pastor prefers that all ministers, elders, songleaders, interpreters taking part in the program walk out onto the platform together and sit in the folding chairs. Once everyone is seated on the platform, the first one on the program walks to the pulpit.
11. A deacon should ensure that the Sound Technician has tested all the mics including the tie mic. Do not assume that he has done it. Please ask him and then report your findings to the Administrator. Please ensure that new batteries are used for the cordless mics.
12. The service program should be reviewed for possible areas that will need an interpreter. Then ensure that the program states who will be performing the interpretation. Please be on the lookout for new items on the program and make the adjustments.
13. To serve communion a total of four elders, four deacons are needed. Two elders serve the bread and two elders serve the wine. Two deacons hold trash bags for the empty wine cup discard, one deacon watches to see when the elders are running out of bread and wine and another deacon brings out more wine and bread from the Pastor's office.
14. Normally, when the Senior Pastor (or the one he puts in charge of the Communion service) performs communion and ushers it in, he contacts the Administrator before service starts as to how he will want communion served to him and when the deacons should start ushering the people to take communion. During the service, the Administrator is watching the Senior Pastor for the signal when to usher in communion. Then the Administrator radios the deacons in position to usher in communion. The deacons do not

make a move until the Administrator has given the OK. When the Senior Pastor puts one of our ministers in charge of communion, then this information needs to be gathered as to how and when communion will be ushered in. Will the minister in charge (assuming he will be at the pulpit), walk down and go through the line or will he want a deacon to come and serve him communion at the pulpit? Next we will need to know when the people will be ushered to take communion.

15. The Video Department should have all the scriptures in English and Spanish ready to project on the screen when they come due on the program. Any other items which need to be projected besides the scriptures and songs will need to be addressed as soon as possible before the deacons open the doors to the public.
16. Special request during communion service should be brought to the Administrator.
17. The standard format for ushering in communion will be the elders serving the bread stand one foot in front of the first step of the altar and at the beginning of the first pew. Then the elders serving the wine are suppose to be parallel and at least 4 to 5 feet away from the elder serving the bread. Next, the deacons holding the trash bags should be parallel and 3 to 4 feet away from the elder serving the wine. The goal is to keep the line moving and the deacons will ensure it takes place. As the people take their bread and eat it they continue forward and take the wine and drink it walking towards the deacon at the end with the trash bags to deposit their empty wine cup. The deacons in the end positions show the people back to their seat. Everyone that is taking communion and is in service should go through the line. No one is allowed to take communion in the Pastor's Office during our service.
18. The Administrator will give the order to dismiss the people to take communion. For communion, we dismiss the people the same way we would dismiss the congregation once a service has ended. The only difference is that for communion we dismiss towards the altar area and once they have taken part of the bread and wine they return to their seat by entering their pew from the opposite side that they exited.
19. No one is permitted in the Pastor's Office during communion service outside

of those ministers and elders serving communion. This is a problem do to the fact that we have different individuals entering this room at different times during the service. A deacon will need to stand guard to ensure that no one is permitted in the office outside of the ministry serving communion (Elders and Deacons).

20. When everyone has taken communion, then four deacons or elders will help serve the bread and wine to the four elders that served communion to the congregation.
21. Once everyone has taken the communion, the leftover bread and wine is returned to the Pastor's Office. The room is then vacated for the Senior Pastor and Elder Joshua Ocampo. The elders that served communion should exit the church and head towards the Voice of Restoration Building for the foot-washing. A deacon will need to stand guard at the Pastor's Office to ensure no one enters the room while foot-washing is taking place. Please ensure that the door is closed because we do not want the sisters or the young men coming out of the Video room to look in.
22. Before we dismiss the men for foot-washing, a deacon will need to ensure that the Sound Technician puts on instrumental music before he leaves the sanctuary and the deacon will need to notify the piano player so she is not playing throughout the foot-washing. What usually happens is the piano player stays playing the piano throughout foot-washing and by the time everyone is finished there is no one left to participate in the foot-washing with the piano player. Therefore, we need to ensure that prelude music is played during the foot-washing so everyone has the same opportunity to participate.
23. Once the men are dismissed for the foot-washing, the deacons will ensure that every man in the sanctuary leaves through the south-west door of the sanctuary. We do not want musicians exiting the doors to the back offices.
24. Once every man is out of the sanctuary, two to three deacons will need to stand guard outside the south-west and west-end double doors to ensure that no man re-enters the sanctuary while the sisters are foot-washing. Be very sober that the deacon at the south-east door (entrance to the back offices) does not let anyone through his door especially ministers that forgot something in the sanctuary.

25. After the foot-washing is completed, the deacons will empty the basins that are in the sanctuary and VOR. Then they will leave them outside to dry. The following day, a deacon will need to gather all the buckets and store them in the church Supply Room.

26. The Administrator will select two to three deacons to dispose of the leftover bread according to the scripture. The bread is usually burned toward the south end of the property away from the sight of the traffic that is on Baseline road.

COMMUNION BREAD RECIPE

Ingredients:

Water	have about 1 cup to work with
2 cups	Unleavened Whole wheat flour
1 tsp	Olive oil

Preheat oven to 300 degrees.

Place flour into a mixing bowl, begin adding water to moisten the flour. Add olive oil. Continue adding water to the mixture until the dough is not sticky and can be hand stretched. Add flour as needed if dough is sticky or water as needed to get the right consistency.

Place the dough onto a cookie sheet and stretch into a triangular shape. The dough should be about $\frac{3}{4}$ inch high. Bake for 15-25 minutes. Keep a close eye on dough as the bread should not be too dry or uncooked.

COMMUNION SERVICE

Brethren, to be able to help you in your duties as Deacons or Ushers, we have put together a list of items that should take place before the Communion Service. We trust that this will be a help to you in serving God's people.

1. In the Pastors office, there needs to be two Elders preparing the wine and bread for our Communion Service.
2. One deacon needs will need to observe wine trays in the sanctuary for replenishing when needed.
3. One Deacon to usher the rows, another Deacon standing in front, directing the people to the deacons standing at the side. Then when the brethren as a group are done taking the bread and wine, then the side deacons, will dismiss the brethren to their places.
4. A table needs to be placed on platform w/ tablecloth for bread and wine.
5. Front chairs need to be removed, also the guitar and amplifier.
6. Service will be recorded and videotape.
7. Former cry room, chairs need to be removed and placed accordingly with washtubs for foot washing for the sisters.
8. In the Ramada, chairs and tubs need to be in place for the brothers.
9. There needs to be two tubs and chairs in Pastors office.
- 10.No chairs down the middle aisle.
- 11.No offering will be picked up during the Communion Service.
- 12.Interpretation shall be done in side room or on platform.
- 13.There should be someone to stand in, for the minister and the musicians when they are partaking of the Lord's Supper.
- 14.Minister or Song Leader needs to communicate w/ video department on songs. Verses, chorus, ECT... They need to be in sync (together).
- 15.Deacons need to be at church, One hour before the doors are opened, to prepare for the service.

We trust that this has been a help to you. May God bless you for your faithfulness in serving His people.

Administrator

COMMUNION SIGN UP SHEET:

Please complete these forms 36 hours before the communion service:

Submit a copy to pastor, administrator, church office.

DEACONS

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12

DEACONS IN TRAINING

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2
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12

VIDEO DEPARTMENT

1
2
3
4

5
6
7

SOUND SYSTEM

1
2

MUSIC DEPARTMENT

1
2
3
4

5
6
7

FUNERAL PROCEDURES

ADMINISTRATION

- 1 The goal of Phoenix Tabernacle is to assist and comfort all the bereaved, especially during the funeral services. Although our established procedures must be adhered to, we should also seek the input of the family by means of their spokesman. The pastor desires to give the family priority during the funeral service especially with the order of the program. It is important to keep in mind that it is the family's funeral.
- 2 It is imperative, first of all, to find out who will be the family's spokesman. It will usually be someone in the family.
- 3 Changes can occur at the family's request with the pastor's written approval. Once the program is made we must diligently adhere to it.
- 4 Administrative assistants must be very careful to not assume anything. Assuming is usurping authority. Every procedure must be verified with the pastor but with the family's interest in mind. For example: Two elders or deacons should stand beside the coffin but they will not be assigned until the family's spokesman is asked whom they prefer. Once this information is obtained, it must be communicated to the Pastor for approval. If the family does not have anyone in mind, we should follow the standard procedure. Lastly, all parties' involved must be informed who will be the attendants near the coffin.
- 5 Upon notice of a funeral, a special group of 14 deacons must be selected to help during each funeral service (viewing, interment and burial). Verify who will be helping in the video, sound and music departments. Make a list of helpers for each service and fax a copy to the pastor, administrator and church office.
- 6 Each deacon assisting with the service is required to be at the sanctuary or funeral home one hour before the service starts.

- 7 It is very critical that all deacons, ushers, elders participating, sound system technicians, video & audio groups etc know the order of the service and what is needed from each group. It is the responsibility of the administration team to inform each group of their duties and ensure each department understands what is expected of them. Delivering a program to them will not suffice.
- 8 All services must be bilingual from beginning to end unless family specifically request one language. The interpreter's name should be written on the program before it is distributed. As a general rule, poems, songs, and multimedia presentations will not be interpreted.
- 9 Please study and memorize the program. Scrutinize it and look for anything out of the ordinary. There may be new things, which we normally do not do (playing a video, etc). If there is a question regarding any part of the program make sure it is answered before the service starts. Communicate and verify all items on the program with the pastor, administrator, administrative team, individuals on the program, family's spokesman, deacons, sound technicians & video department, etc.
- 10 Ask the funeral home attendant what time they need to take the coffin. Make sure the program allows sufficient time for this transition. Bring any concerns to the administrator and/or pastor.
- 11 All announcements and dismissal instructions shall be put in writing. This should then be submitted to the pastor for review before dismissal. Once the pastor approves it, nothing should be added or taken away unless the pastor re-approves it. We must ensure that we are all in one accord.
- 12 The administrative team helping inside the sanctuary will be assigned to a specific post inside sanctuary (not in the vestibule area). This will enable us to have quality control at all times while observing how each deacon performs at his post during the service.

- 13 There must be a meeting of the minds within the administration team to discuss the service format from top to bottom. We must be united and act as one. Communication must go both ways.
- 14 If you are assigned a task or a project (programming A/C, specials, etc), always make sure you communicate the status or progress of the task or project you were given.
- 15 Do not assume anything. Always “drill down” to the source of each issue / or program item. When you delegate a task or project make sure that you follow through and get feedback. Do not assume the task will get done. Follow up and follow through. Doing this will ensure that gaps are closed and mistakes are covered. Do not be afraid to ask that person to repeat the instructions you have given him. It helps to confirm they understood your request.
- 16 Many mistakes can be avoided if we give and provide feedback, follow through and “drill down.” Remember that the pastor suffers the reproach for our mistakes.

SANCTUARY

- 1 The altar area must be cleared of all chairs.
- 2 All chairs on the platform area must be removed with the exception of the last row next to the drapes unless other instructions have been given.
- 3 Deacons must know who the pal bearers are.
- 4 Two individuals will stand next to the coffin (one on each end of the coffin). Two individuals may be selected from the following groups: Elders, deacons, ministry or family members. Once the selection is complete submit it to the Pastor for approval. No one is to stand next to the coffin until the Pastor has approved the selection.

- 5 Reserved seating will be permitted for the bereaved family, the Pastor and his wife, and Mr. & Mrs. Paul G. Garcia Jr.
- 6 Find someone who knows the family and use them as a point of reference when seating the people. If we do not have a deacon who knows the family, ask one of the family members to help in the vestibule area to help us identify the family members.
- 7 If a deacon arrives late and still wishes to help, he will be assigned to a non-critical position, otherwise it will take too long to bring latecomers up to speed with the latest developments.
- 8 Musicians should be encouraged to play something softly during the reading of the obituary, poems, and prayers.
- 9 Deacons must ensure that the translating headsets are functioning and ready to be handed to the people before the doors open. Headsets should be given even if the program does not specifically state that earphone interpretation is needed.
- 10 The family should arrange flowers to their liking, however, in the event that the family does not do this, the deacons are responsible for arranging them. Keep in mind we do not want to block the walkways with flowers. Flowers are not permitted on top of any instruments. No exceptions.
- 11 Usually the Funeral Home director will ask us the following questions: Are the flowers to remain in the church after the memorial service or are they suppose to take them back to the funeral home? They prefer that that flowers stay in the church because they usually do not have room in the hearse to fit all the flowers. The flowers usually get smashed when they are put in the hearse. We need to know the family's desire regarding the flowers. If the flowers are to remain in the church overnight, then we need to ensure that the temperature in the church does not get any higher than 77 degrees.

- 12 Ensure that all the lights are working in the sanctuary, outside lights and that the whole church is clean and ready for service.
- 13 Ensure that the A/Cs' are set to cool the building 8 hours before service starts if they will be needed.
- 14 The signing of the guest book is on a 1st come basis. We strongly recommend that this be done outside near the entrance of the church before the service starts. The guest book will be closed once the line is very long (>30 persons) and/or 10 minutes before the service starts. As an option, the guest book attendant can ask for family names and quickly sign them in.
- 15 Everyone that attends the services should receive a funeral leaflet.
- 16 Usually chairs will not be used in the walkways except in the middle aisle unless it is stated beforehand. Chairs will be permitted in the vestibule area. We must remember we are conducting a funeral service and our goal is to not overcrowd the building. Do not be afraid to offer standing room once all seats are taken. We want it to be a comfortable experience for our guests.
- 17 Two deacons will be responsible for all platform and altar area needs. They will stand on the platform near the steps.
- 18 Three deacons will be positioned on either side of the church (3 on the north side and 3 on the south side).
- 19 Doors on the south and north side of the sanctuary should not to be opened except by the administration team or the pastor. For example, if a family member needs an escort to enter the church, the deacons must communicate this to the administration team so room is made for their entry. We prefer that people come through the front entrance. The elderly or individuals in wheelchair should be assisted into the sanctuary. If you have a question regarding this, ask the administration team before taking matters in your own hands.

- 20 Two deacons will be needed at the double doors, one in the vestibule and one outside. Deacons or deacons in training with the less than 6 months training should not be placed to serve in the sanctuary. Instead they should be assigned to the vestibule area or to stand with a deacon in the sanctuary. Only the administrator or the pastor will grant exceptions.
- 21 One deacon will be needed to guard the door in the back offices and one will help us in the middle aisle. A deacon at the French doors will help usher the people. One administration team/deacon will stand opposite the deacon at the French doors to monitor the deacons and observe the order in the sanctuary.
- 22 If a task has been assigned to someone else, please try to be helpful to that individual. Pitch in and help them accomplish it.
- 23 Deacons must ensure that every individual on the program is notified and sent to the back office upon arrival to the church.
- 24 Remember that the family is always given time and privacy at the end of the service to be with their loved one. This means that all non-family members are dismissed out of the church; doors are closed as deacons stand guard.
- 25 The order of dismissal is a very critical part of our service. The person performing the announcements and dismissal and the deacons must be in one accord with the pastor and the program. There is no room for assumptions (*see Administration section #15*). People will be permitted to view the body but not to offer their condolences to the family in the sanctuary. Use tact, wisdom and meekness to help guests understand the order. Standard procedures for dismissal are: (1) Deacons will dismiss the people using the outer passageways of the sanctuary starting on the south side of the church directing them east along the south side wall to the altar area. Then at the altar a deacon will direct them north towards the coffin. Another deacon on the north side of the sanctuary will direct them west along the north side- wall. Finally a deacon will exit them out of the sanctuary using the north side door. Keep in mind that no one is to sit in the empty seats once we have dismissed that row (2) no one is to be dismissed down the middle aisle of the sanctuary

(except the elderly who have a hard time walking). (3) two deacons are to be stationed in the middle aisle along side of the partition of the first pew. They are to ensure that no one is greeting or offering condolences to the family or wanting to exit using the middle aisle (4) Dismiss the people from the back first. Starting with the last pew on the south side of the sanctuary, this will open up the passageway, second the vestibule area, third anyone outside, then the north side seating addition (x-cry room), next the all the pews except the family, then the platform and personnel in the offices. The line must constantly be moving as if we were serving communion. No gaps are permitted in the line. It is the responsibility of every deacon to prevent them. As long as the casket is open we will follow the above dismissal format unless the Pastor has written order to change the dismissal format.

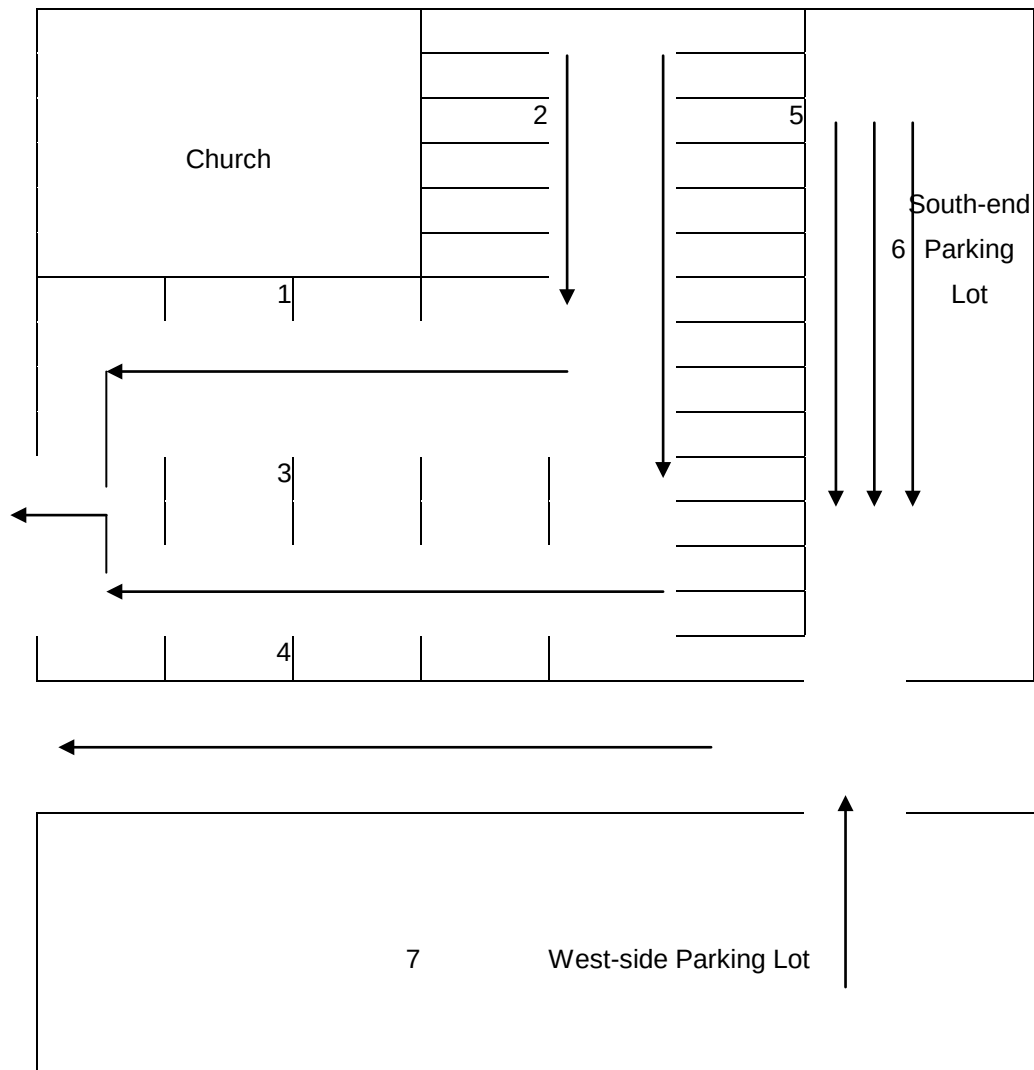
26 NOTICE, when we have a closed casket service the order of our dismissal changes. We will dismiss everyone from the sanctuary. We will use the north and south side door of the sanctuary to dismiss the people just as we do it for a regular service except dismissal will not be done through the middle aisle. Deacons will be stationed in the middle aisle to ensure that no one gets up and makes their way to the front. The vestibule will be dismissed at the same time that we dismissed the north and south side doors.

27 During the dismissal, the family is not to get up to view the body until everyone is dismissed. If the family makes their way to the body, one of the senior deacons will have ask them to remain seated until we exit everyone out of the sanctuary. Out of respect for the family, we must exit everyone out to the sanctuary and give the family time to view the body alone. The deacons are to keep order during this time. At that time the musicians may stop playing if they wish and the sound system technician should be ready to play soft instrumental sacred music. Make sure this is in place before service starts. If family members completely lose their composure, deacons should gently assist them in exiting the sanctuary before they faint. You may want to have family member help them too.

PARKING LOT

- 1 On the day of the Internment Service the administration team deacons will assign four to five men to help in the parking lot. This must all be discussed, planned and assigned **prior to** the Internment service.
- 2 These men will need to be at the church at least 1-½ hours before service starts or before individuals start parking their cars.
- 3 These same deacons will direct the people to park their cars correctly and to direct the order of dismissal from the parking lot after the hearse drives off.
- 4 The pastor's car must be parked in section #1 closest to the hearse but after family limousines. Reserve the parking spot with a red cone until the pastor's car is brought to the church parking lot. If the Pastor's car is not brought into church parking lot, please go to his house and offer your assistance.
- 5 It is very important that those ministers and individuals which will be taking part in the gravesite service be one of the first ones to leave the parking lot but only after the hearse, family, and the pastor.
- 6 We will need at least 6 red-cone flashlights and 6 parking cones.
- 7 These deacons will need to have 2 way radios.
- 8 All cars will be parked with the front end ready to exit. This means that the back end will be put into the parking space first. The parking spots in the center of the pavement parking will be facing west instead of east as they normally do for a regular service. In the south dirt parking lot (next to VOR building), all cars will face west and parked in rows facing west. In the west side parking lot, all cars should be parked so they can exit quickly and smoothly.

9 The order of dismissal from the parking lots is as follows:



GRAVESITE

- 1 Gravesite preparation must be done days in advance.
- 2 There should be a gravesite program. Most of the time it is not written but it would be to your benefit to write it. If it is not written then memorize all the steps in the gravesite section and plan for them.
- 3 Deacons must be assigned to direct cars on how to park at the gravesite and how to exit. This may require that the deacons go to the gravesite a day or so before the actual day of the internment service. They should devise a plan to park the cars and to allow an orderly exit. Communicate this plan to the Administrator.
- 4 Deacons will be assigned to direct the people where to stand at the gravesite. They must understand who will be sitting in the chairs reserved for the family. Most times there is not enough room for all the family to sit. Ask the spokesman who will be sitting in the family section at the gravesite.
- 5 Deacons will need to know the gravesite program, and be able to identify the pal bearers. Prepare them to bring the coffin out once the pastor has given the order. This should take place once all the immediate family, pal bearers and ministries are ready. Open up a passageway for them. We must ensure the pal bearers are on time. Usually the ministry will walk in front of the coffin as the pal bearers carry it to the gravesite. The ministry usually recites Psalms 23 as the coffin is brought out of the hearse and places at the gravesite. Deacons need to know which ministers will participate and make sure they are in their positions on time. The administration team must ensure with the pastor which ministers will be helping us. Then communicate this information to the deacons helping at the gravesite. Deacons need to know where the ministry will stand at the gravesite. We prefer they stand behind or next to the one officiating the service. The trio/Rondalla should have a place reserved close to the one directing the service too.
- 6 Deacons must ensure that children do not get near the coffin at the gravesite.

- 7 Deacons should have at least two 10-gallon water dispensers with water, disposable cups and two trashcans.
- 8 We must always have a trio or Rondalla of guitars at the gravesite ready to play as the people approach the gravesite and during the gravesite service.
- 9 Deacons must know who the gravesite songleader will be. If you do not know who that person is, get some songs ready because you just might be called upon to songlead.
- 10 A Deacon must be assigned to take at least 10-20 folding chairs to the gravesite for our elderly and for special needs that may arise.
- 11 We must have a video crew ready to record the gravesite services beginning with a view of the cemetery entrance, the hearse and people arriving at the gravesite. Views of the service and along with those attending should also be captured.
- 12 Make sure the video crew, deacons helping at the gravesite (with parking, the water, and seating) and trio/Rondalla are sent to the gravesite a minimum of one hour before the church service ends. Church deacons will have to communicate via the radios to inform the deacons at the gravesite the order of the ministry and pal bearers in the line of in-coming cars.
- 13 Deacons should have at least 10 umbrellas at the gravesite to provide protection for the needy. Do not forget to collect them after the service and return them to the church office.
- 14 Those helping at the gravesite must know where the nearest restroom is located.

FUNERAL CHECKLIST

	Who is the family's spokesman?
	Who is the point of contact helping the deacons sit the family?
	Do you know who the Pal bearers are?
	Does the program have interpreters?
	Are the deacons, administration, pastor, family and the people making the announcements informed about the order of dismissal?
	Have the special songs been confirmed with the pastor and details communicated to the singers, sound technician, video department, etc?
	Do you know the special needs of the family?
	Is there a guest book? Who is running it and what are their needs?
	Are all the lights working and A/C turned on at least 8 hours before?
	Are the earphones ready to go and the translating system tested?
	Has the parking lot dismissal been communicated and assigned?
	Have the gravesite details been taken care of: parking, video, music, ministry, water, umbrellas, songleader, and etc?
	Do you know which family members will be sitting in the chairs at the gravesite?
	Has a deacon been assigned to take extra chairs to the gravesite for our Elderly and those with special needs?
	Have the sign-in sheets for all services been submitted to the Pastor and the administrator?
	Have you communicated your checklist results with the Administrator and the administrative team?

PLANNING A FUNERAL

ANNOUNCEMENT OF DEATH

- The senior pastor will appoint a spokesman of the church to meet with the family upon the death of the loved one to gather all the details regarding the role the church will play in the funeral. This spokesman will determine what level of service will be provided by the church. The role the church plays depends on the needs of the love one's family. The role of the church can be on of financial assistance in funeral cost, providing the church building for services, handling service program arrangements and everything that is required to run a service, providing housing for out of town family and friends, providing transportation needs such as to the airport, providing food to help feed relatives and friends before and after the funeral services, spiritual support and counseling during and after the funeral and much more.
- Funerals require the planning of many details. In most cases, these details are so overwhelming to the family they seek the help of the church to plan these details out. There are times when the church is requested to handle the funeral arrangements with the funeral home.
- The following is a list of things one could ask (keep in mind: has the family already made arrangement with the funeral home before your visit?):
 - a. What role will the church play in the funeral?
 - b. How many services are requested?
 - c. Will the services take place at the church or the funeral home?
 - d. Where will be the gravesite?
 - e. Will housing or transportation be needed for out of town family members?
 - f. Who are the pal-bearers?

- g. Will the body stay overnight in the church or will it be returned to the funeral home. If the body stays in the church overnight, then who will be staying with the deceased?

PLANNING THE SERVICE PROGRAM

1. One of the most important aspects of a funeral is the planning of the services. Each part must include a time limit to ensure the church operates under the time constraints that the family has contracted with the funeral home. This is very important because fees are based upon certain time frames and going beyond those stated times could incur additional fees to the family.
2. The death of a love one is a very emotional time for the family of the deceased. Due to the grieving process the family member who is setting up the funeral arrangement might not realize all the details of the funeral contract and what effects it has on the role the church who is offering assistances. Many times these details are not communicated to the church spokesperson. These details usually have an impact of the service program.
3. When an interpreter is used in the services, each time section on the program is doubled. For example, when a person is given five minutes on reflection the time is now ten minutes if an interpreter is used.
4. In planning a service program, time buffers must be built into the program. Time buffers are gaps in the program such as the time it takes for one person to step down from the pulpit to the next person starting their part. Plus it also includes time overages where a person might go a few minutes beyond the time limit. A good service program accounts for these buffers. For every hour of service, ten minutes is needed as a time buffer.

5. Timing of different sections on the programs:

Sections of a Service	Time Limit without Interpreter	Time Limit with Interpreter
Prayers	2-3 minutes	4-6 minutes
Song (special or congregational)	5 minutes	
Poems	5 minutes	
Reflection (1)	3-5 minutes	6-10 minutes
Special Words	5 minutes	10 minutes
Multimedia Presentation	5 minutes	
Messages	15 minutes	30 minutes
Announcements	3-5 minutes	6-10 minutes
Time Buffer	10 minutes	10 minutes
TOTAL TIME:	58 minutes	86 minutes

6. The person must limit themselves to one memory when asked to perform the “Reflection” part of a service. This memory must be short enough to communicate within a three minute time frame which with an interpreter it would be a total of six minutes. If the goal is five minutes total time on a reflection with an interpreter, then a person should be given three minutes.

7. Usually there are three services: Memorial, Interment, and Gravesite.

MEMORIAL SERVICE

8. This service is usually set for the evening.

9. It is imperative that you know when the body will arrive at the church so the planning the service can be scheduled. To ensure a successful program the body should be arriving at the church around 6:00 to 6:30 PM and the service starting around 7 PM.

10. The length of time for this service should be planned around 45 to 50 minutes maximum with a ten minute buffer. This format will ensure a total service time will be around 60 minutes.
11. Memorial services usually last two hours: one hour service, 25 minutes to usher in the people and dismiss, 35 to 40 minutes of family time.
12. Normally, a funeral home expectations are the following:
 - a. If they are to take the body back, they like to have it back by 9:00 PM.
 - b. What are they suppose to do with the flowers after the service. They prefer that they stay in the church since they do not have room in the hearse.
 - c. The length of service and when will they will be called to take the body back.
13. Dismissal usually runs around 15 to 20 minutes during the memorial service. If the people in the line are stopping to offer their condolences then the time to dismiss will take two to three times as long. The family of the deceased must understand this before the service.
14. Family time usually runs around 15 to 30 minutes before and after the service when the services are held at the church. This all depends on when the funeral home was contracted to bring and take the body and when the service starts and ends. When the service is held at the funeral home they usually have around an hour with the deceased.
15. The person elected to give the announcements and dismiss must cover the following items:
 - a. Thank all individuals for their attendance on behalf of the family.
 - b. Announce times and locations of the interment and gravesite services.

- c. Order of viewing the deceased (dismissal order).
- d. Due to time constraints, request the people from offering their condolences to the family.
- e. Short prayer to close the service.

16. Pallbearers are needed to escort the body back to the hearse.

INTERMENT SERVICE

17. This service is usually set for 10 AM and should end before or at 11:00 AM.

18. A 35-45 minute service should be scheduled to ensure everyone is dismissed and in their cars by 11:00AM. Ten minutes is needed to dismiss and ten minutes for the family to view the deceased for the last time.

19. The body usually is delivered around 9:30AM. This type of format only allows 15 minutes of family time and 15 minutes to seat the general public.

20. If the family wants more time with the deceased then they need to set this up before the contract for services is signed.

21. Normally, the funeral home estimates one hour service and depending where the gravesite is at they estimate travel time. This is very critical since most funeral homes perform more than one funeral a day and the escort service (from the church to the gravesite) is an independent company from the funeral home. The escort service runs on a time schedule and will leave if the service extends beyond their contracted begin time which means we will be without the services of the escort.

22. The funeral home usually will estimate how long it will take to get to the gravesite from the church and will contract the escort service for a certain time period. For example, funeral homes estimate 25-35 minutes travel time to the Rest-haven gravesite located at 42nd street and Southern. For every mile figure around 5 to 7 minutes travel time.

23. The general public normally does not view the deceased. Upon dismissal they are exited out of the building and instructed to go to their cars to be part of the funeral procession. This process takes around 10 ten minutes.
24. The person elected to give the announcements and dismiss must cover the following items:
- a. Thank all individuals for their attendance on behalf of the family.
 - b. Announce the locations of the gravesite service.
 - c. Dismissal order in the church and out in the parking lot.
 - d. Short prayer to close the service.
25. Pallbearers are needed to escort the body back to the hearse.

GRAVESITE SERVICE

26. The gravesite service last around 15-30 minutes. The service includes a few songs, one or two speakers, a song and closing (dismissal order).
27. Pallbearers are needed to escort the body to the gravesite.
28. A list of ministers should be made to help walk the deceased from the hearse to the gravesite. They should be made aware of the scripture reference of Psalms 23.
29. All those individuals on the program should be walking along with the ministers in #26.
30. Video recording must be scheduled and communicated.
31. Music must be scheduled and communicated. Music should be playing from the time the hearse arrives to the end of the dismissal of the people.

32. In planning this service, one must consider the weather and make the necessary accommodations for the people. For example, Phoenix extreme summer temperatures require the set-up of water booths, umbrellas, and chairs for the elderly and handicap. Chairs are needed if the service runs on the long side.

HELPING ATTEND THE FAMILY

33. One of the best ways the church can show their support to the family is by organizing several families to bring food to the family of the deceased especially before the funeral service begins and throughout the funeral services. Normally family and relatives are in town for three days. Planning to have food delivered for three to four days would be ideal.
34. Appointing someone from the church to make contact with the family's spokesperson to see if they need help in anything.

FUNERALVIEWING SERVICE SIGN UP SHEET:

Please complete these forms 36 hours before the communion service:

Submit a copy to pastor, administrator, church office.

DEACONS

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DEACONS IN TRAINING

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VIDEO DEPARTMENT

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SOUND SYSTEM

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MUSIC DEPARTMENT

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FUNERAL INTERMENT SERVICE SIGN UP SHEET:

Please complete these forms 36 hours before the communion service:

Submit a copy to pastor, administrator, church office.

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DEACONS IN TRAINING

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VIDEO DEPARTMENT

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SOUND SYSTEM

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MUSIC DEPARTMENT

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FUNERAL GRAVESITE SERVICE SIGN UP SHEET:

Please complete these forms 36 hours before the communion service:

Submit a copy to pastor, administrator, church office.

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DEACONS IN TRAINING

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VIDEO DEPARTMENT

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SOUND SYSTEM

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MUSIC DEPARTMENT

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COUNSELING CODE OF CONDUCT

COUNSEL 7k / n\$!l8

n. *counsel* < L *consilium* (for base see CONSULT); confused in ME with COUNCIL⁶

- 1 a mutual exchange of ideas, opinions, etc.; discussion and deliberation
- 2 a) advice resulting from such an exchange b) any advice
- 3 a) a lawyer or group of lawyers giving advice about legal matters and representing clients in court b) anyone whose advice is sought; consultant
- 4 [Archaic] intention or resolution; purpose
- 5 [Archaic] wisdom or judgment
- 6 [Obs.] a confidential idea, plan, etc.; secret

vt. -seled or -selled, -sel[ing] or -sel[ling]

- 1 to give advice to; advise
- 2 to urge the acceptance of (an action, plan, etc.); recommend

vi. to give or take advice

—**SYN** ADVISE, LAWYER

keep one's own counsel to keep one's thoughts, plans, etc. to oneself

take counsel to discuss and deliberate; exchange advice, opinions, etc.

Webster's New World Dictionary

1. A Counseling Form will need to be filled out for each counseling session and submitted to Pastor Bernie G. Garcia, Brother Paul G. Garcia Jr. and the Administrator within 48 to 72 hours.
2. In filling out the Counseling form, please try to be brief and concise stating factual information only and not assumptions. Fill out the form from the perspective of an arbitrator.
3. Please be cognoscente during the counseling session of the day of week, time and your surroundings especially if counseling session is in the counselee's home. Only extreme emergencies should a counseling session go beyond 9:30 PM.

4. Counseling cases should not be transferred to another counselor unless the Pastor has approves it.
5. Every counselor of Phoenix Tabernacle is under oath of confidentiality of what the counselees share in their counseling session. These matters are not to be discussed amongst your peers, associates and families.
6. *And the pastor should never take sides in the meeting, by saying there is one group is this way and one that way. The pastor should stand between both of them, and go to them, and get them reconciled, immediately. And if he can't get them reconciled, let him take a deacon with him. And then if they're--they won't hear neither pastor nor deacon, then it should be told to the church, and, as Jesus said, "Let them be unto you as a heathen and a publican." "And whatever you bind on earth," said Jesus, "I will bind in Heaven, and what you loose on earth, I will loose in Heaven."* CHURCH ORDER JEFF. IN COD SUPPLEMENT 58-1006
7. The pastor has requested that submissions of your reports and miscellaneous communications should be sent to Brother Paul G. Garcia so that he can ensure that the work is being completed in the most effective and efficient manner. Then Bro. Paul will communicate all activity to the pastor.
8. As a counselor of Phoenix Tabernacle, we are intercessors in every case we counsel. We are not their judge nor do we seek to implant justice. We are intercessor interceding on behalf of the counselees to the Lord Jesus Christ. Our desire is to reconcile individuals back to the Father so they may be restored.
9. *They're sorry for their sins. And I am praying sincerely as a--as a intercessor, as one who loves them, as a minister of the Gospel, who would pray for those who are needy. I pray that You'll expel off of the--the book, every sin that they have committed. May it be gone, and may the great ink remover of the Blood of the Lord Jesus clean every page tonight.* BLIND BARTIMAEUS PHOENIX AZ 57-0301

10. *I'm your brother, standing as your brother, an intercessor, trying my best to hold you before God. And I'm standing here right before the white throne now, and is taking that--pointing my finger at that bloody Sacrifice there, and speaking through His Name that it's done. It has to happen, and it has to happen. You know it's happened. I know it's happened, so do you know it's happened, and it's so. That's right. Amen.* PERFECT FAITH JEFF. IN V-6 N-11 63-0825E

CONFLICT

1. The majority of the case we deal with at Phoenix Tabernacle deal with some type of conflict. Conflict is a fact of life. It is through conflict that God begins to work on us. Conflict is not the problem, but our reaction to them. If conflicts are left unresolved and buried, they will hinder our growth.
2. Below are some helpful tips to share with those going through conflict.
3. What causes conflicts? Power struggles, in effective communication, finances, In laws, children, different goals, selfness.
4. JAMES 4:1 ¶ *From whence come wars and fightings (conflicts) among you? come they not hence, even of your lusts that war in your members? 2 Ye lust, and have not: ye kill, and desire to have, and cannot obtain: ye fight and war, yet ye have not, because ye ask not. 3 Ye ask, and receive not, because ye ask amiss, that ye may consume it upon your lusts.*
5. ROMANS 12:10 *Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another;*
6. An individual has 5 choices in dealing with conflict.

Withdraw – **Physically and/or mentally removed**

Win – do everything to win the argument / conflict

Yield – give in for the sake of peace (not a good way to handle conflict).

Compromise – making deals – giving a little so a person can do what he/she wants.

Resolving – to find God's provided way in dealing with the current conflict.

7. When dealing with couples that have conflict each person must learn how to **listen**. If you transpose the word L-I-S-T-E-N, you will find it creates S-I-L-E-N-T. A person must learn how to listen by being silent.
8. JAMES 1:19 *Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath:*
9. PROVERBS 18:13 *He that answereth a matter before he heareth it, it is folly and shame unto him.*
10. E-52 *And then Moses just chucked full of church theology... He was to be the next pharaoh. And we find him still not knowing God. But one morning on the back side of the desert, an old man of eighty years old, his whiskers hanging way down low, he seen a burning bush, and he turned aside to see what was going on. And when he got near the bush he heard a voice. **God had to quieten him for forty years before He could ever speak to him.** And we won't stay quiet ten minutes so God could speak to us with all the rumble and bumble we have of this day. And yet, Moses after forty years stood there, and in the presence of that bush and that one voice that called him, He knew more about God in five minutes after that, than all the eighty years of training had taught him. It made a different man out of him. It'll make a different man and woman out of you if you'll just stand still long enough to hear His voice. E-53 *Like Samuel did, stand still. **Don't be excited. If you want something of God, ask Him, then stand still and listen to see what He's going say about it.** Just open up your heart, say, "What about it, Lord Jesus?" Just stay there. If He doesn't answer the first five hours, then wait another. If He doesn't answer today then He will answer tomorrow. If He doesn't answer this week, He will answer next week. Stay there till He answers. Hear His voice speak back in your heart, and say, "Yes, I'm the Lord that healeth thee."**

Then it's all over; you get settled then. See? "I'm the Lord Who forgives all thy sins. Now, go and sin no more. I don't condemn you." Then you can go free. You're all right. But you want to be sure that you hear that voice speak. Moses heard it. He was a changed man.

HEAR HIS VOICE JEFF. IN 58-1005M

11. Resolving a conflict once it has surfaced requires knowing when is the right time.

JOHN 5:19 Then answered Jesus and said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, The Son can do nothing of himself, but what he seeth the Father do: for what things soever he doeth, these also doeth the Son likewise.

PROVERBS 15:23 A man hath joy by the answer of his mouth: and a word spoken in due season, how good is it!

12. A conflict must be defined. (1) Both parties must refrain from using the you message (pointing the finger syndrome), and must use we or our in their message. (2) The use of always and never in conflicts sends both parties farther away from reconciliation. (3) Couples must learn to attack the conflict not the person. It is not doctrine that separates a person but the spirit. A minister is called to preach against sin not against a person.

Now, the Old Testament is a type of the new, while I was typing it together. Today, spiritual Israel done the very same mistake that natural Israel did. And when they come up to the real place... (you're past the school of theology out there)... just exactly like they did: Exodus 19. They can't accept it. If it does, the organization cuts them out. I have ministers before me today, fine men... The Assemblies of God is one of my great supporters. The Church of God support it. The Foursquare support it. The Oneness support it. The Twoness support it. The United Pentecostal support it. The Pentecostal Holiness support it. And some of the finest Christian ministers there is on the face of the earth is in them organizations. I don't pull any punches with those brothers. They're my brothers and they're men of God. But the system, not the men, not the people, but the systems, winds them around and separates them from other brothers. They cannot do this when the system that they're under won't permit them to do it. That's what I'm against brethren. I wouldn't want you to misunderstand. I know that that's God's truth, and I know the thing has to die. Every type, shadow, and even the Scripture itself proves it.

ABRAHAM'S GRACE COVENANT MIDDLETOWN.OH 61-0317

...Like, I was talking to a fellow over getting after me about hitting the denominations. I ain't got nothing against the people in them denominations. It's that system I'm hitting at...

RESUMING_ CLEVELAND TN 62-0408

But then when man begin to sin he separated himself from his fellowship with his Maker. **Sin is what separates him.** As that--that's the truth which we believe it is. The Bible only speaks the truth. And if that's the truth, then if there is some preparation made for sin, then man through that preparation can come back in perfect fellowship and harmony with his Maker again. You believe it? That's right. We can only find the way. That's... **We want to find the remedy.** FELLOWSHIP THROUGH RECONCILIATION
MACON GA 55-0605

But, brother, when you come to that place that you're dead and raised with Him in resurrection, you love your brother, your sister. There's no denomination can break that barrier. You are Christians, and you're one in Christ Jesus, whether you're Presbyterian, Methodist, Baptist, or whatever you may be; and see Him moving among us. That's right. Amen. **See what our denominations get us? A bunch of tommyrot. Separates our fellowship, breaks the barriers, puts the people under pressure, and everything, trying to fight for an organization.** It's going to die and perish. It don't have to die; it's already dead. It was dead to begin with. LETTING OFF
THE PRESSURE GREEN LAKE WI 62-0518

Now, instead of accepting the way that God vindicates to be truth, the way that God Himself moves upon the scene and saying, "This is it. These signs shall follow them that believe. I'll be with you, even in you. A little while, and the world won't see Me no more; yet you'll see Me, for I'll be with you even in you." See, the world, you... "The world won't see Me, but you will," See? "Cain won't see Me, but you will, Abel." You see? Because it's the--it's the same thing. And instead of coming and saying, "Well, wonderful. We see God in the midst of the people working. Let's do that." No, sir. With creed--the same thing, and--greed, rather, and with jealousy--the same thing that Cain has, he requires the blood of his brother. He tries to wipe him out of the way, get rid of him. "They're nothing but a bunch of holy-rollers. They're little..." See? You know what I mean. That's what starts the trouble. There's where trouble begins. That's where the broken vows... There's where broken fellowship separates. That's the thing that breaks up homes. That's the thing that starts the--the wheel a-moving towards divorces. That's the very thing that breaks the fellowship.
VICTORY DAY SIERRA VISTA AZ 63-0421

13. In a conflict, a person must understand what areas they agree and disagree. In addition, a person must be open to others opinions, feelings, observations and suggestions for the reconciliation process to be effective.
14. Some examples of conflict can be found in the following scriptures: Genesis 4, I Samuel 20:30-34, Matthew 15:10-20, Mark 11:11-19, Luke 23:18-49, John 8:1-11, John 11:11-19.

RULES TO FOLLOW TO HELP RESOLVE CONFLICT

[Couples should understand the following guidelines to help resolve conflict]

1. **Hear feelings**, not words...attempt to be empathetic. Formula: Feelings → Feedback → Rebuttal
2. **Be congruent** – in touch with our feelings and therefore responsible for them.
3. **Avoid “you” messages** which cause another to become defensive. Use “I” messages.
4. Be ready to **forgive** and to **ask for forgiveness** – real empathy will bring genuine apologies and repentance which will soften hearts and free us up from the slavery of bitterness, hostility and vindictiveness.
5. Be responsible for personal change – do not take another’s responsibility for change.
6. Stay with one issue at a time.
7. Call “time” when the discussion becomes destructive. The person who calls time is responsible for arranging a new time (preferably within 24 hours) for further discussion once feelings have been tempered.
8. Stay with the here and now. Avoid bringing up the past or referring to the future.

9. Never use the word “never” – always refrain from using the word “always” – in short, avoid generalizations.
10. Avoid “below the belt” remarks. These are remarks that have nothing to do with the issue; they are only designed to hurt and their confidence. Attack the problem, not the person.
11. Use the Biblical and Message approach. Approach the one (and only the one) we have conflict with. If they are unable to “hear / listen” meet with your pastor which both parties have confidence in.
12. Avoid blaming, placating, distracting and computing...attempt instead to be an adult (resolve, hear feelings, be rational, logical and wise).
13. Be loving – agape – accepting, supportive, caring – attempt to practice I Corinthians 13.
14. Couples must learn to admit their shortcomings, ask for forgiveness, renounce all bitterness and renew their commitment.

And my little boy, Joseph, he's just strictly a boy, and running out in school where he hears everything. One day when I come in, he said something another and sassed his mother. And--and then he run to me. Now, she knowed... He knowed he'd get a licking from her. So she said to me; she said, "Billy, give him a whipping." And he put his arms around me, said, "Daddy, I'm so sorry." He knowed my soft spot. And so, "Oh," I said, "honey, let's forget it. I can't..."

And for the... Wife and I, with this Bible before me, has never had a word in our life. But all at once, being in that nervous time of life, she slammed the door right in my face. And she said, "Then you should take care of him awhile," and slammed the door and went in.

I thought, "Poor little fellow. My, she has all that to go through herself."

I walked on out, and I said, "Joseph, come on," I said. Took him, I said, "Daddy should give you a licking. You know that." But I said, "Being that you repented. See? But, remember, my--my patience is going to run out one of these days. And that--that

repenting, you got to bring forth fruit meets for repentance and prove to me that you really mean it. See? If you love me, then you'll mind me."

91 And so I went on out, and I said, "I'll wash the dust off my windshield of my car." And I started out to wash that windshield.

And as I did, a Voice said, "Turn, and tell her to read II Chronicles 22."

I thought, "I--I just--just... I don't know how I ever thought that. I thought, "Well, I just imagined that," kept on washing.

And again It come real loud, "Go, tell her." Well, It scared me.

I went in and read it. You know what it is? It's when Miriam made fun of Moses about marrying an Ethiopian girl. And God said, "It was better that your father spit in your face, than to do that." See? And He called them in, said, "Go, get Miriam, she's struck with leprosy." Said, "Go, get Miriam." And Moses... And the Pillar of Fire came down into the tabernacle. And Moses stood there. And God talked to them. He said, "If there be one among you who's spiritual or a prophet, I, the Lord will make Myself known to him. I'll speak to him in visions, reveal dreams, and so forth." He said, "But My servant Moses, there's none like him in the land." He said, "Didn't you fear God?" And Miriam, being a prophetess, was stricken with leprosy. And Moses interceded for her, and she lived.

96 Then that scared me. I'd forgot. Me, I didn't--I didn't notice it, but He did. He was the One that noticed it. That was my wife; I'd die anytime for her. But God noticed it. Now, this is the truth, my Bible laying here in front of me.

And I went in. And she'd went into the room and shut the door, was sewing on the sewing machine. I knocked on the door, and I said, "Sweetheart, I want to talk to you a minute."

She said, "What do you want?"

I said, "Honey, open the door right away. I got a word from the Lord." That kind of sobered her up a little, so she opened the door. And we come in. I said, "Sweetheart, now you know, as much as I love you, I--I--I never thought nothing about that."

She said, "Well, Bill, if... I'm so nervous."

I said, "I know. But He didn't like that. That didn't please Him. He told me right there in the tree, that tree there, that little palm tree in front of the house there, come in here and read this Scripture to you." And I read It.

101 So help me, within a few days she took a pain in the left side. We had to go home. And it kept getting worse. I prayed for her: kept getting worse.

I took her over to my doctor friend in Louisville, Doctor Schoen, specialist. He examined her, said, "Mrs. Branham, tell Brother Branham I want to see him."

She said, "Doctor, what did you find?"

Said, "I'd rather tell him."

So Meda called me, and I come over. And he said, "Brother Branham, she's got a cyst on the left ovary about the size of a walnut."

And I went back home with her, and I said, "You remember?"

She said, "That happened with Brother Sharritt, if I'm not mistaken, over there in California. You told me that for sixteen years now."

I said, "That's right. Now, it's just showing up."

She said, "Billy, you think it's what I did that morning?"

I said, "I don't know, honey; I--I just can't say." Well, we put our arms around one another and started weeping before the Lord. I went in the room and I prayed for her with all my heart.

Doctor Schoen, I called him back; I said, "Doc, what should we do?"

He said, "Should come out of there."

And I said, "Just let it go a little bit."

He said, "I'll tell you, Brother Branham; maybe I better send you up to a female specialist with her, a good friend. He's a Christian too."

I said, "Well, what about you, doc?" He wanted to get it off his own hand. You see?

He said, "I'll send you up there." He loved me, and he respected my work for the Lord. And he told this other doctor about it. HIS UNFAILING WORDS OF PROMISE PHOENIX AZ 64-0120

Four years from then, Joseph came on the scene. Every time I'd pick her hand up, there it was again. And I said, "Check for a cyst on the left ovary."

Joseph was born, he said, "Nope. No cyst."

Well then, about two years ago, when we first come to here, I was all nervous and thinking I was going to be killed, and everything. So I--I went out there to the--was talking to Meda. And Joseph done something he oughtn't to have done. And he needed a licking. But...

And Meda. said, "Bill..." And Meda's right in the time of menopause now, you know, Lee, so it's just she's forty-five years old. So... and in real nervous.

So Joe done something. He really needed a licking. And so she said, "Bill, give him a licking for that."

And Joe come put his arms around me, and said, "Daddy, I'm sorry. Don't give me a licking, please." Said, "I'm sorry."

I said, "Oh, well. Okay, Joe, I'll take your word for it now. Don't do it no more."

And it made Meda's dandruff get up. She--she never did this before in her life. We'd never had a cross word. And it... She said, "Did you ever give him a whipping?"

I said, "Honey, him repenting like that, I couldn't do it."

And she was real nervous. And she slammed the door right in my face. And she said, "Then you ought to stay home some of the time and have to take care of them." Said, "You won't give them a licking or nothing when they come home, and when you come home. And they know they can get by with it for you. Oh, he tells me that too, but he goes right back and does it the same anyway." Whammy, she slammed the door right in my face.

Well, poor little fellow. I--I... You know, Lee, what she is. She's--she's to me the queen of the earth, as far as it is to me. So I thought, "Well, poor little fellow. She couldn't... She's just nervous." And I went on, and sent Joe on out to school. And I... And then I went out to wash my car. And when I started to wash my car, there come a voice right beside that bush, and said, "Go tell her to read..." I think it's Chronicles, II Chronicles. I don't know just the chapter. Anyhow, it's where Miriam made fun of Moses. "Go read that chapter."

Well, I thought it was just kinda... And again It spoke. Well, I thought, maybe...

You know how it is, Lee. I just... You can get imagination sometime. And we don't... That's what's the matter with people today. They get... take imagination instead of really be sure it's the Word of the Lord.

And then It spoke real plain the third time. Well, I went in. And I picked up the Bible and read it first. It's where Miriam was mocking Moses, you know. And Miriam, remember, was a prophetess. And she was the one who nurtured Moses and found Pharaoh's daughter, you know. So...?... And her a prophetess. And she was jawing him about marrying that--that Ethiopian girl.

And so it displeased God. And Miriam was stricken with leprosy. And said... told... said, "It would be better that her daddy would have spit in her face when she was born than to have done a thing like that."

So he called... they called... Moses called God down. The Pillar of Fire stood in the tabernacle. And God said to Moses, "Go call Miriam and Aaron, bring them in."

And there was... there was Miriam, white with leprosy. And said... And God said such, "If there be one among you who's spiritual or a prophet, I the Lord will make Myself known to him by a vision and will speak to him in dreams," or however it reads there. And said, "But for My servant, Moses, there's none like him in the land. (See?) Did not you fear God?" God said to--to Miriam.

Now, remember, that's her own brother, and her a prophetess. And Moses pleaded for her life, and she was healed. E-93 Now, I got scared then. And I went to Meda, and I said, "Meda, let me in." She had the door locked. She was setting at her sowing machine. I said, "Let me in, honey."

She said, "What do you want!"

And I said, "Sweetheart, let me in. I have a Word from the Lord for you." And so she let me in. Kindy sobered her up a little. And I said, "Meda, I was out there washing my car," and I told her the story. She got scared.

And I got down and took her by the hand. And I said, "Lord God, please, don't let nothing happen."

About two days after that, she took a severe hurting in her side, her left side. When we went for an examination at the doctor at home for it, he found out there was a cyst about the size of a lemon on the left ovary. See, I'd told him that fifteen, sixteen years before. It was there all the time. See? AUDIO LETTER TO LEE VAYLE TUCSON AZ 64-0500

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COUNSELING REPORT

DATE: ___/___/___ START TIME: ___:___ END TIME: ___:___

COUNSELORS:

COUNSELEES:

PLACE OF COUNSELING:

PURPOSE OF COUNSELING:

GIVE A BRIEF SYNOPSIS OF THE SESSION:

RECOMMENDATIONS GIVEN TO THE COUNSELEES:

[illegible]

This report was prepared by: _____

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